Piano Concerto

in C♯ minor

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for Piano and String Quintet

Daniel Shan

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2026

Duration: ca. 26 minutes

Program Note

This piano concerto was composed between 2025 and 2026. The idea behind it was simple. As a composer who spends much of my time at the piano, I have always been drawn to the piano concerto repertoire. Listening to and performing works by composers such as Rachmaninoff, Scriabin, Prokofiev, Schumann, and Ravel, I gradually felt the desire to write a concerto of my own.

Each movement explores a different musical language. The first movement reflects my long-standing interest in Romantic piano writing, with singing melodies and shifting tonal centers. The second movement continues in this direction, but with a stronger use of chromatic harmony and virtuosic piano textures. While still connected to the style of the first two movements, the third movement moves toward a more rhythmically unstable and harmonically ambiguous sound world, drawing inspiration from composers such as Ravel and Shostakovich. This is also the first piece in which I carefully considered the form of each movement before beginning to write.

The concerto was written during a particularly demanding academic year. For a long period of time, I found it difficult to sit at the piano and continue composing. Nevertheless, the work became the result of many musical ideas that developed alongside other responsibilities, and it reflects my personal character and emotions during that time.

Score

Piano Concerto No.1 : C ♯ minor
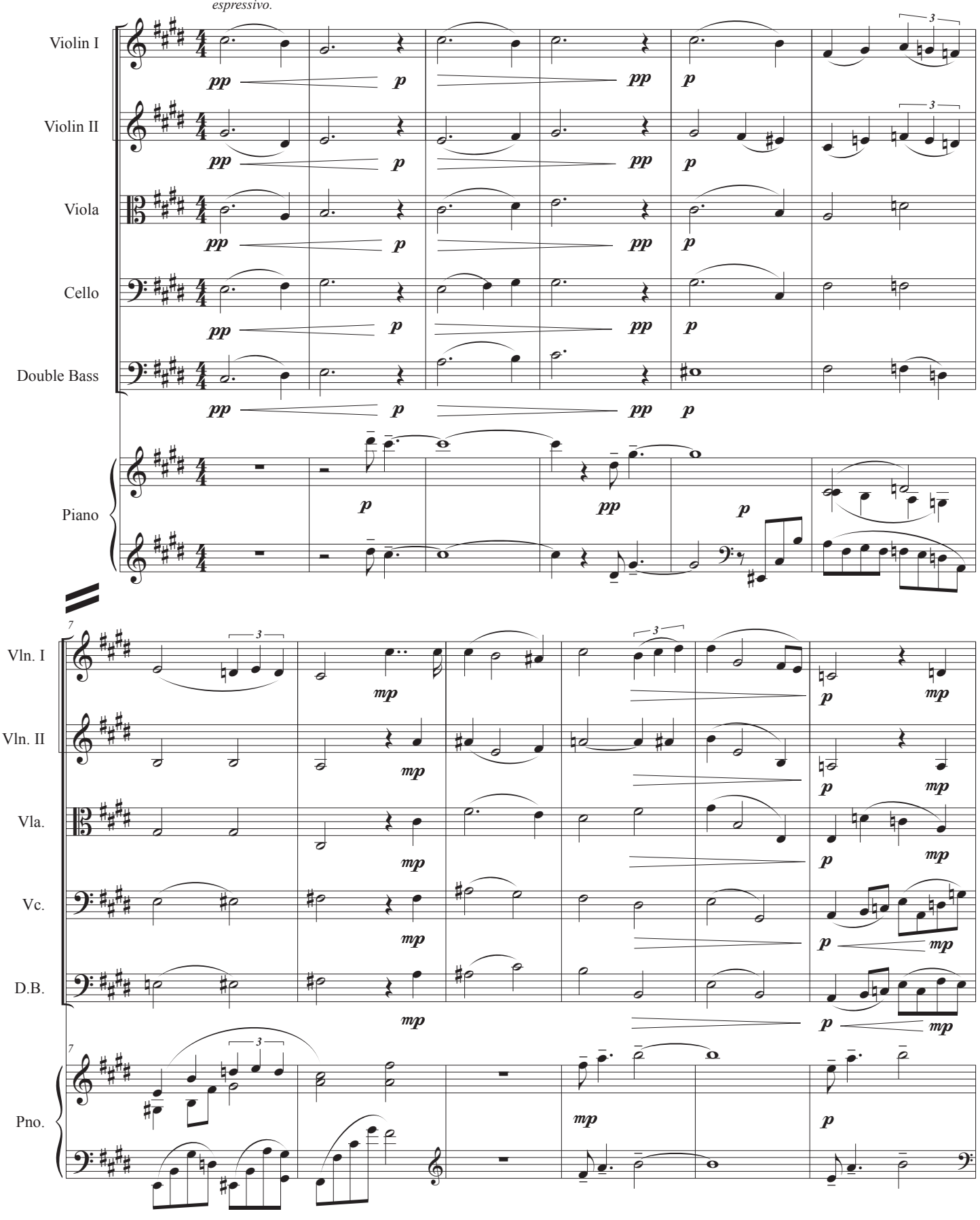
For Piano and String Quintet
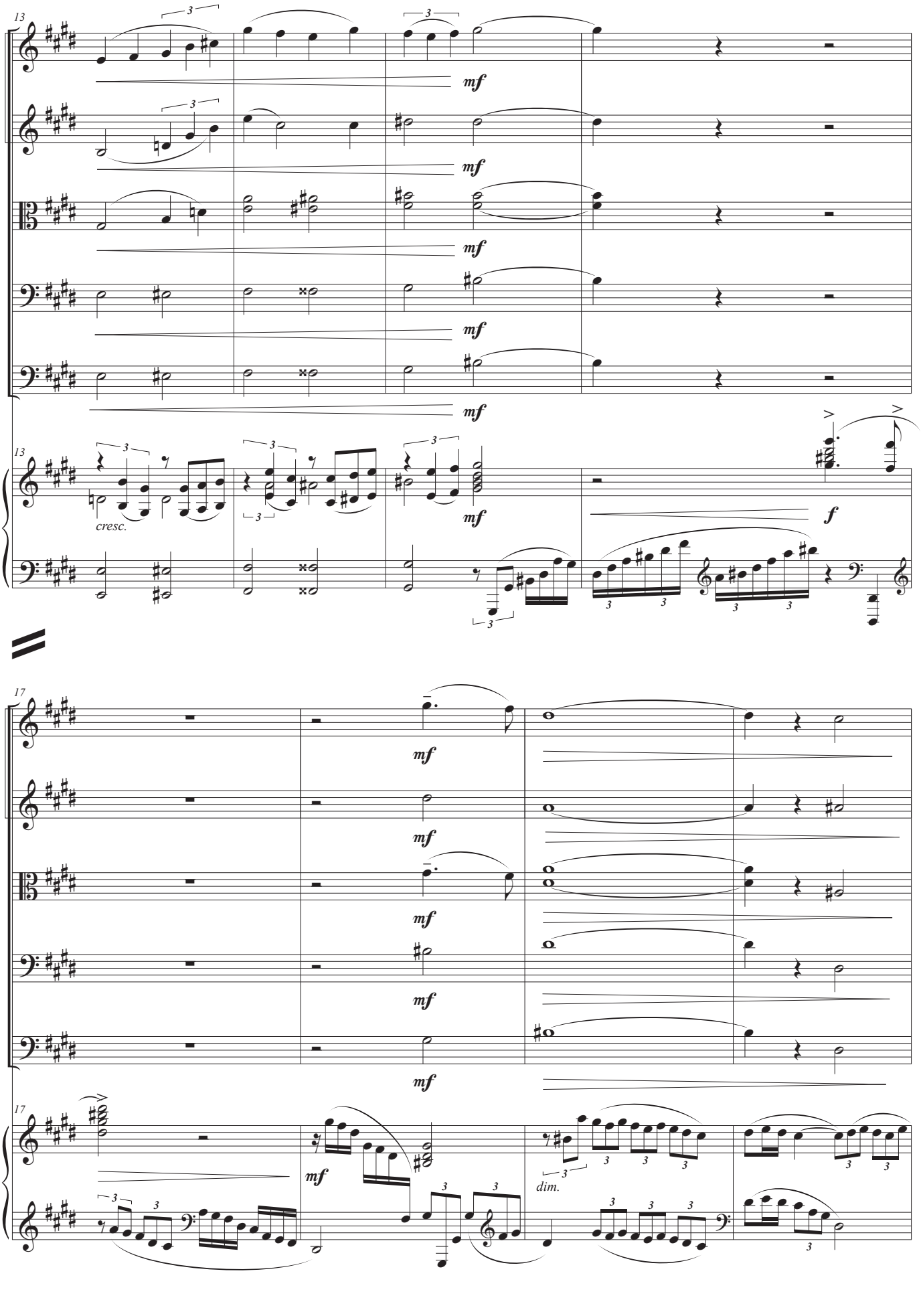
Daniel Shan
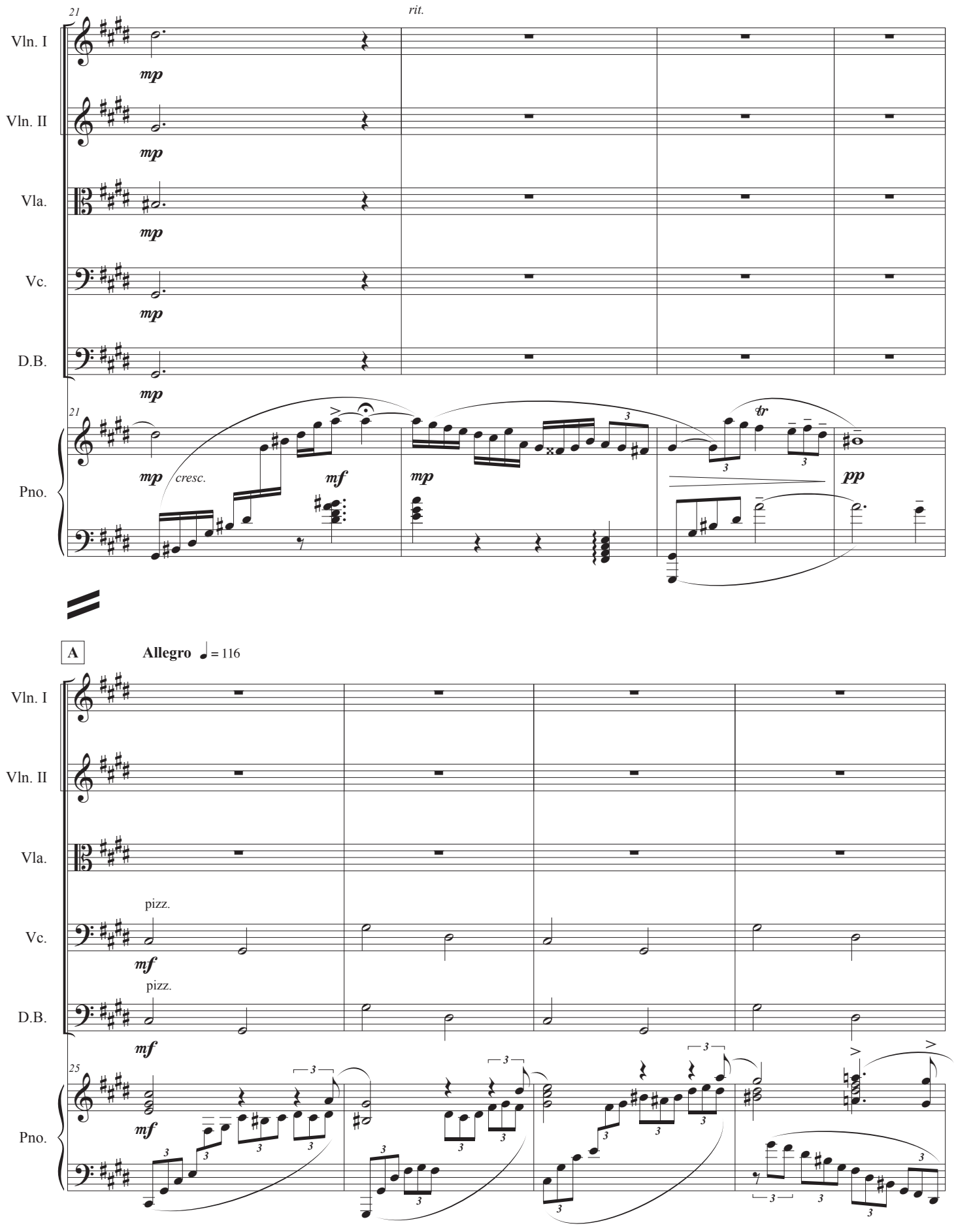
I
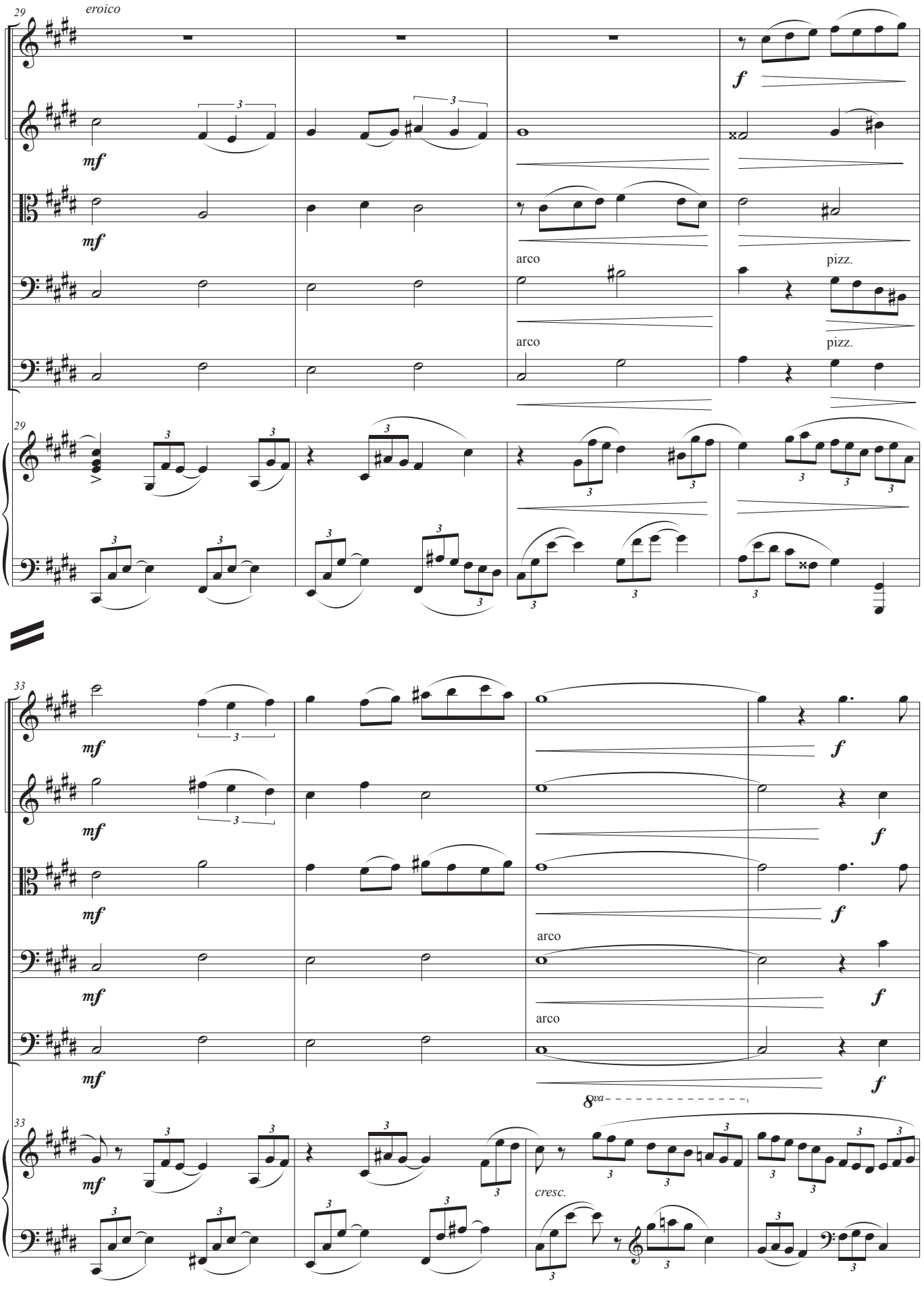
Andante Moderato ♩ = 85
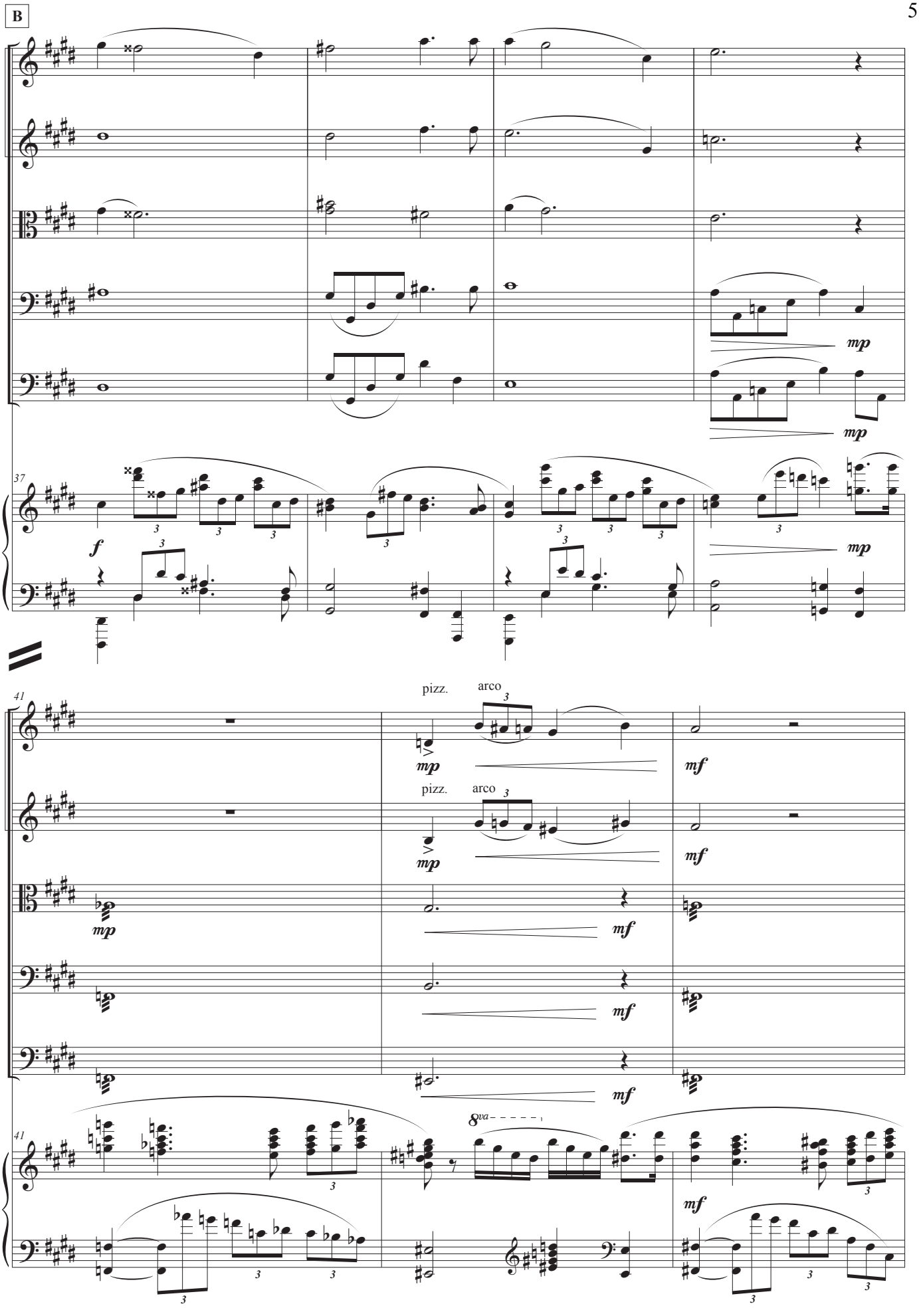
espressivo.
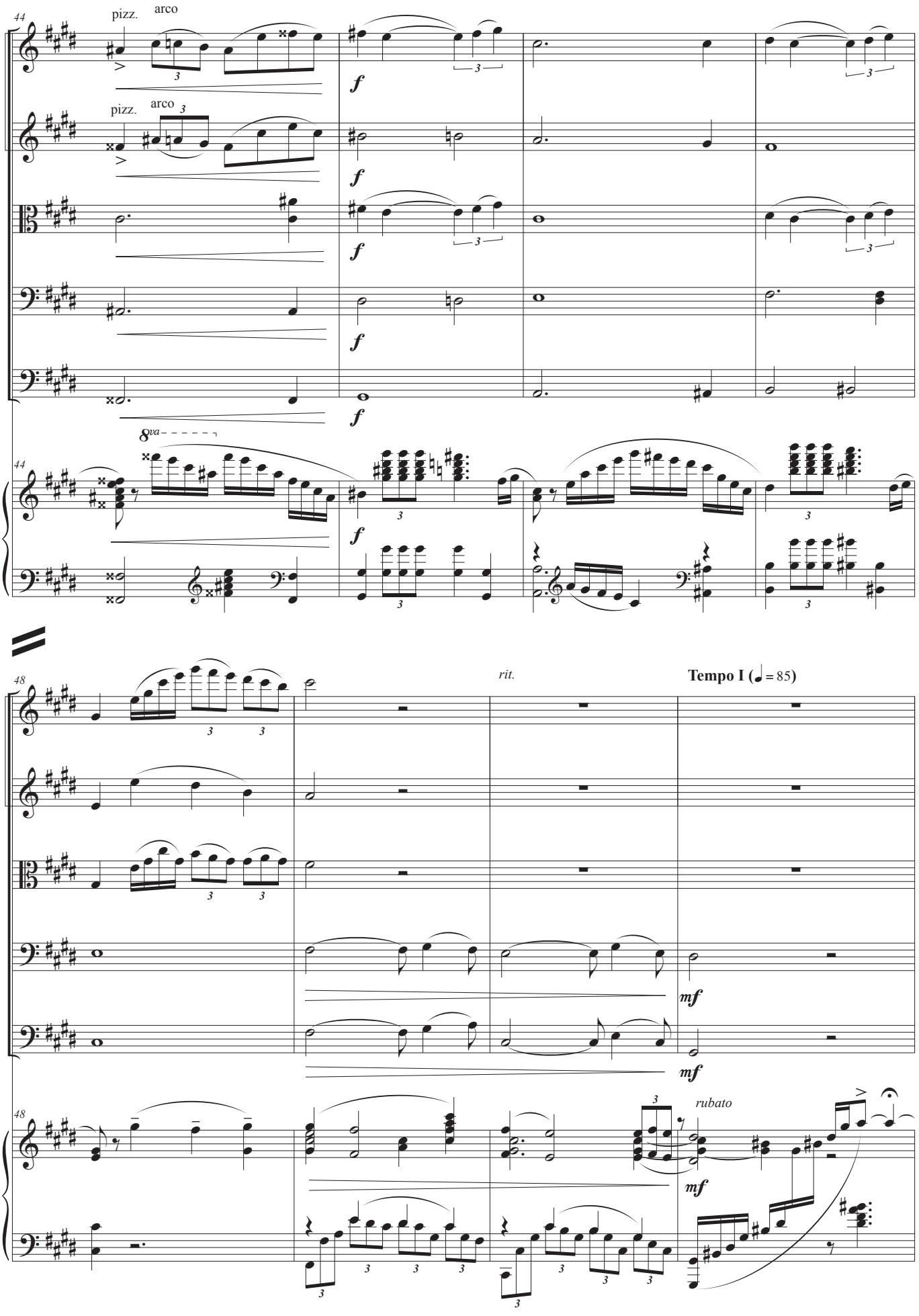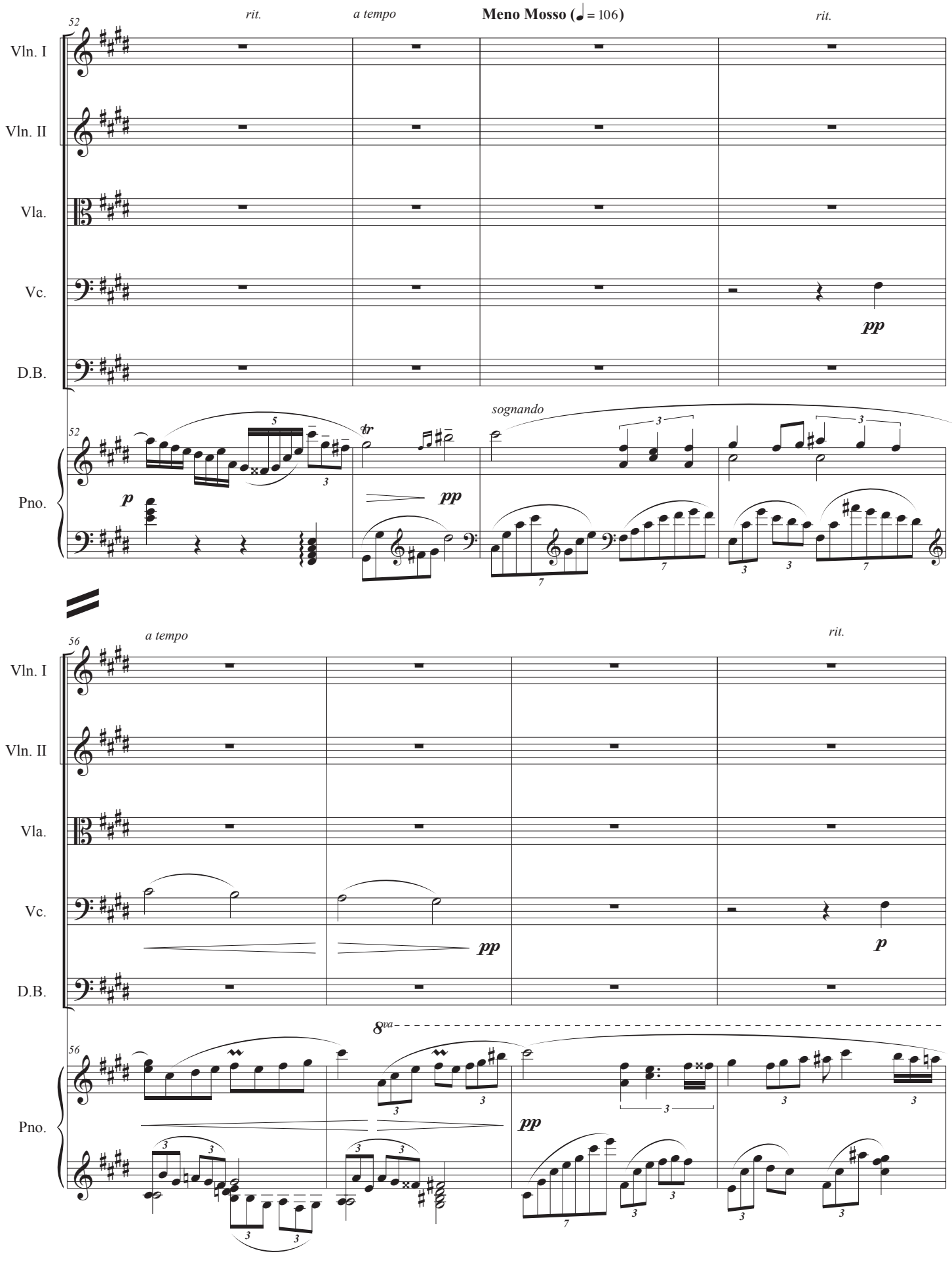



13
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
mf
cresc.
f
17
dim.
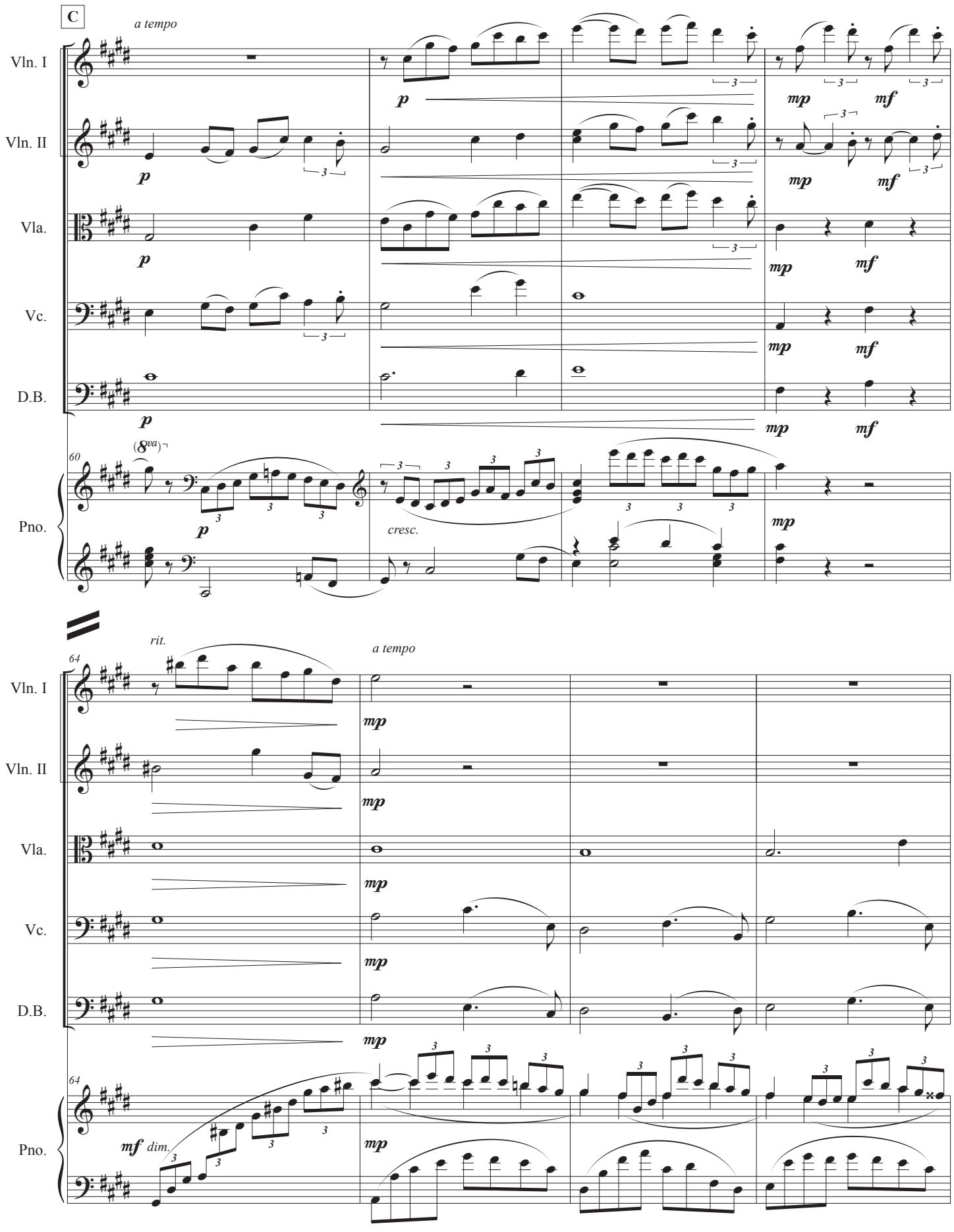

21
rit.
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
mp
cresc.
mf
pp
tr
A
Allegro ♩ = 116
pizz.
25
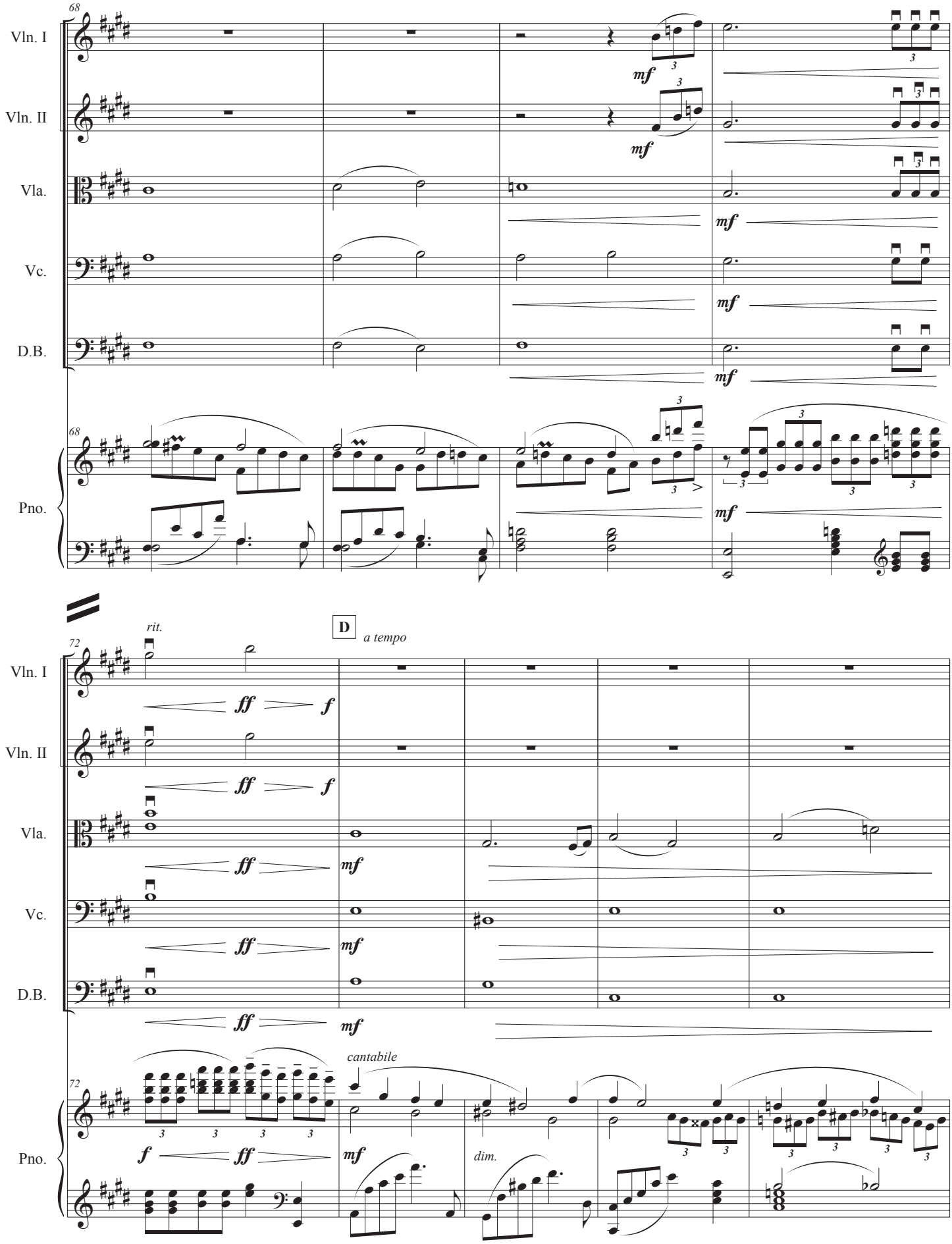

29
eroico
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
mf
f
arco
pizz.
33
8va
cresc.
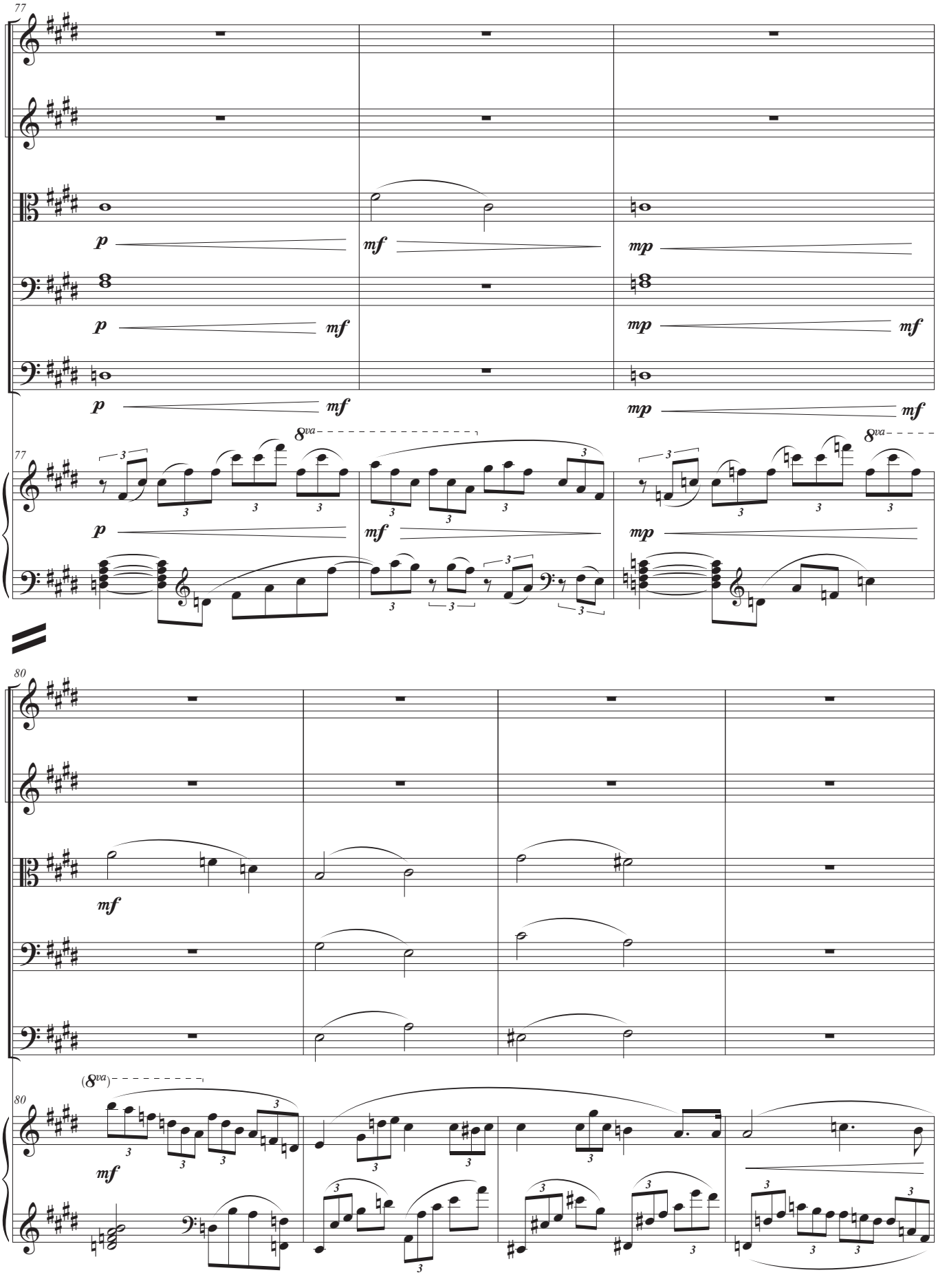

B
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
37
41
pizz.
arco
8va
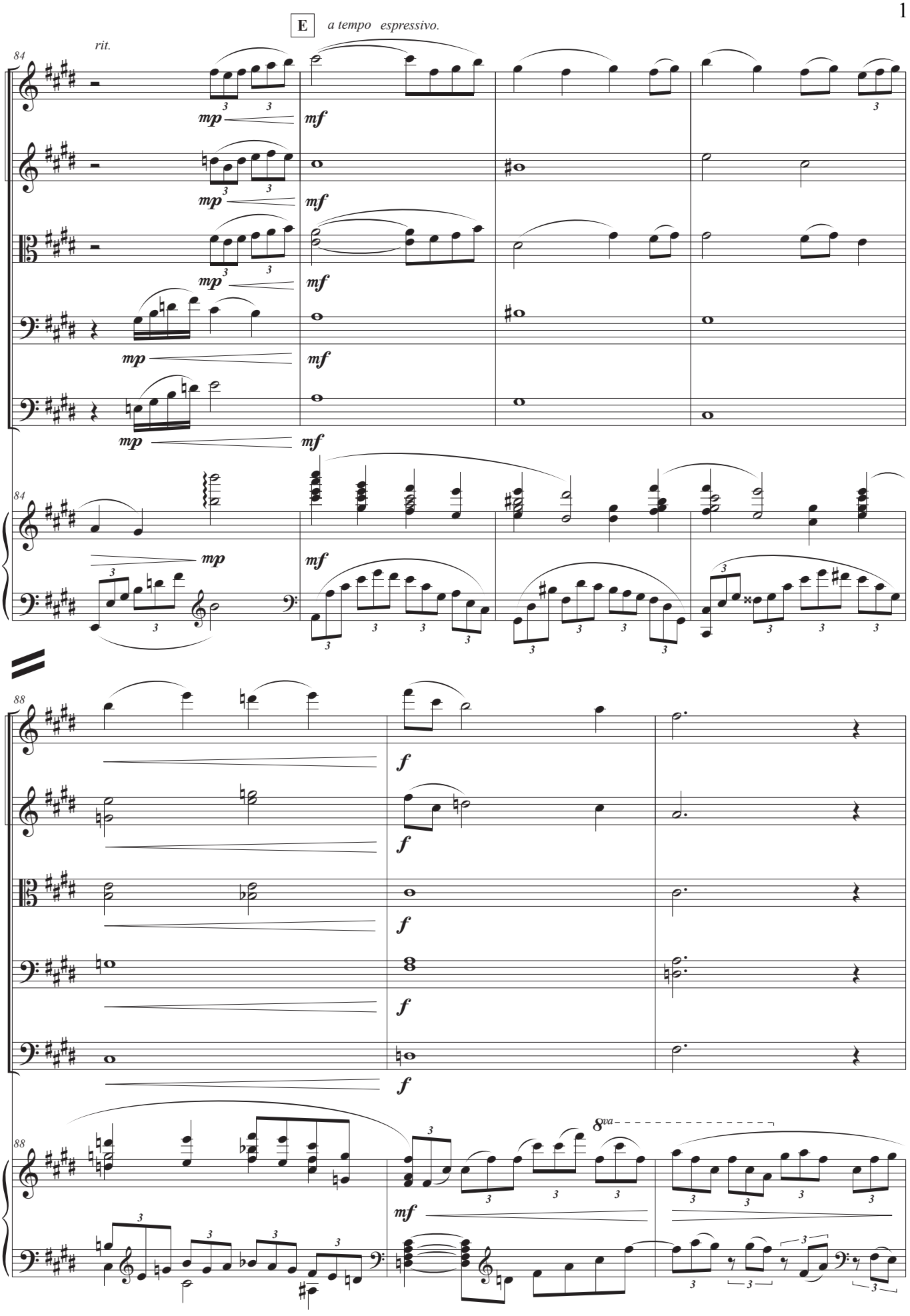

44
pizz.
arco
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
f
8va
48
rit.
Tempo I (♩= 85)
mf
rubato
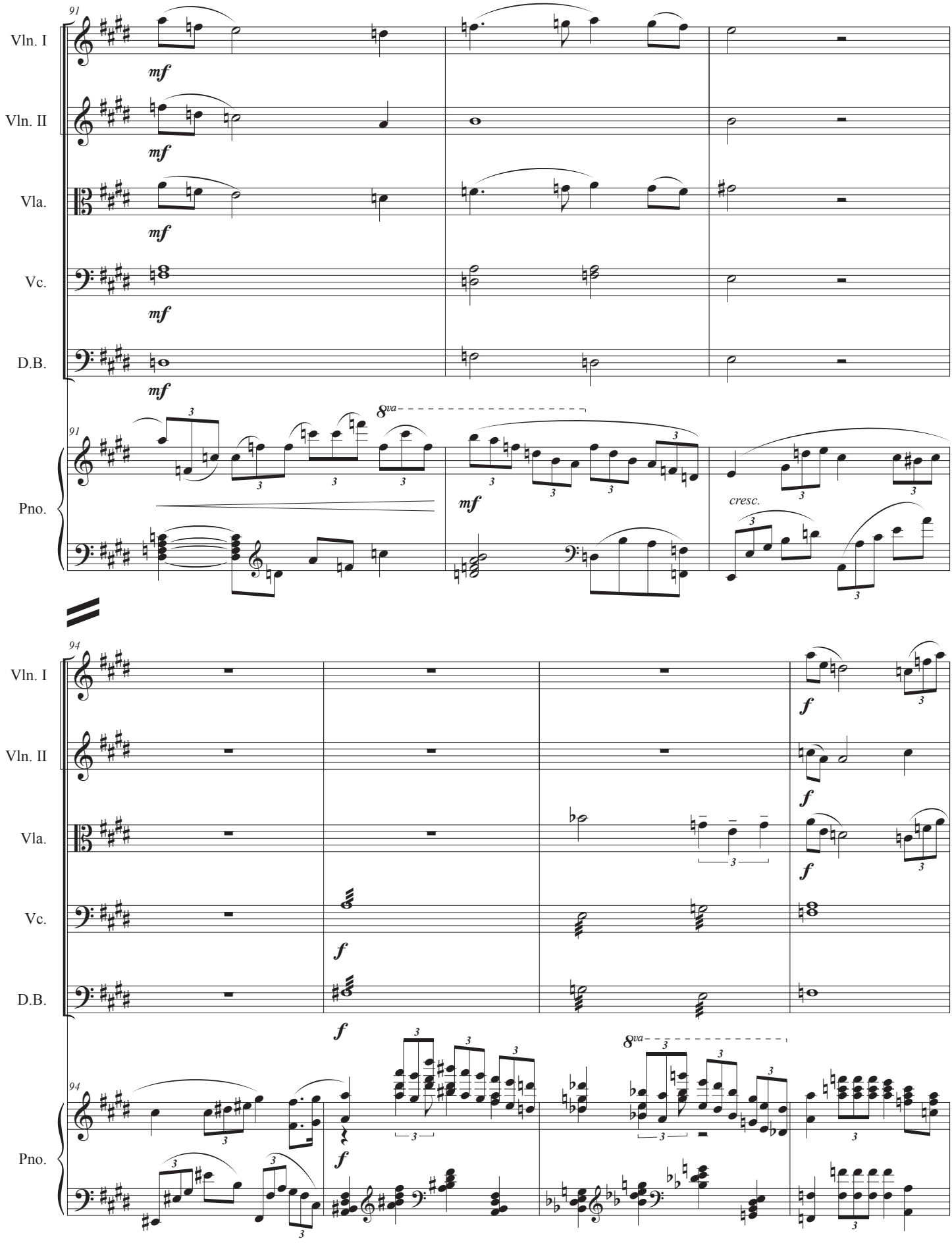

52
rit.
a tempo
Meno Mosso (♩= 106)
rit.
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
pp
Pno.
p
pp
sognando
56
a tempo
rit.
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
pp
p
8va
Pno.
pp
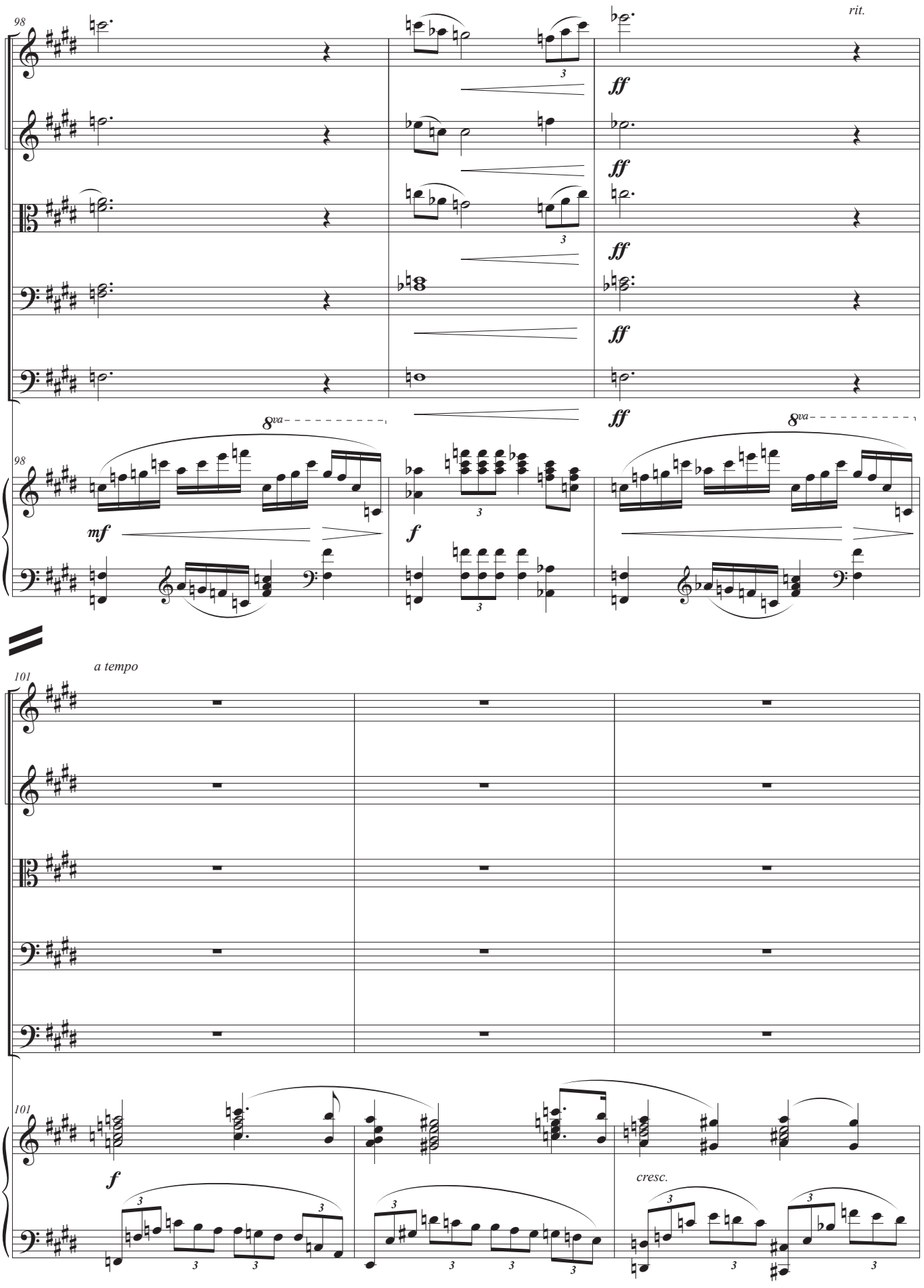

C
a tempo
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
60
(8va)
cresc.
64
rit.
a tempo
mf dim.
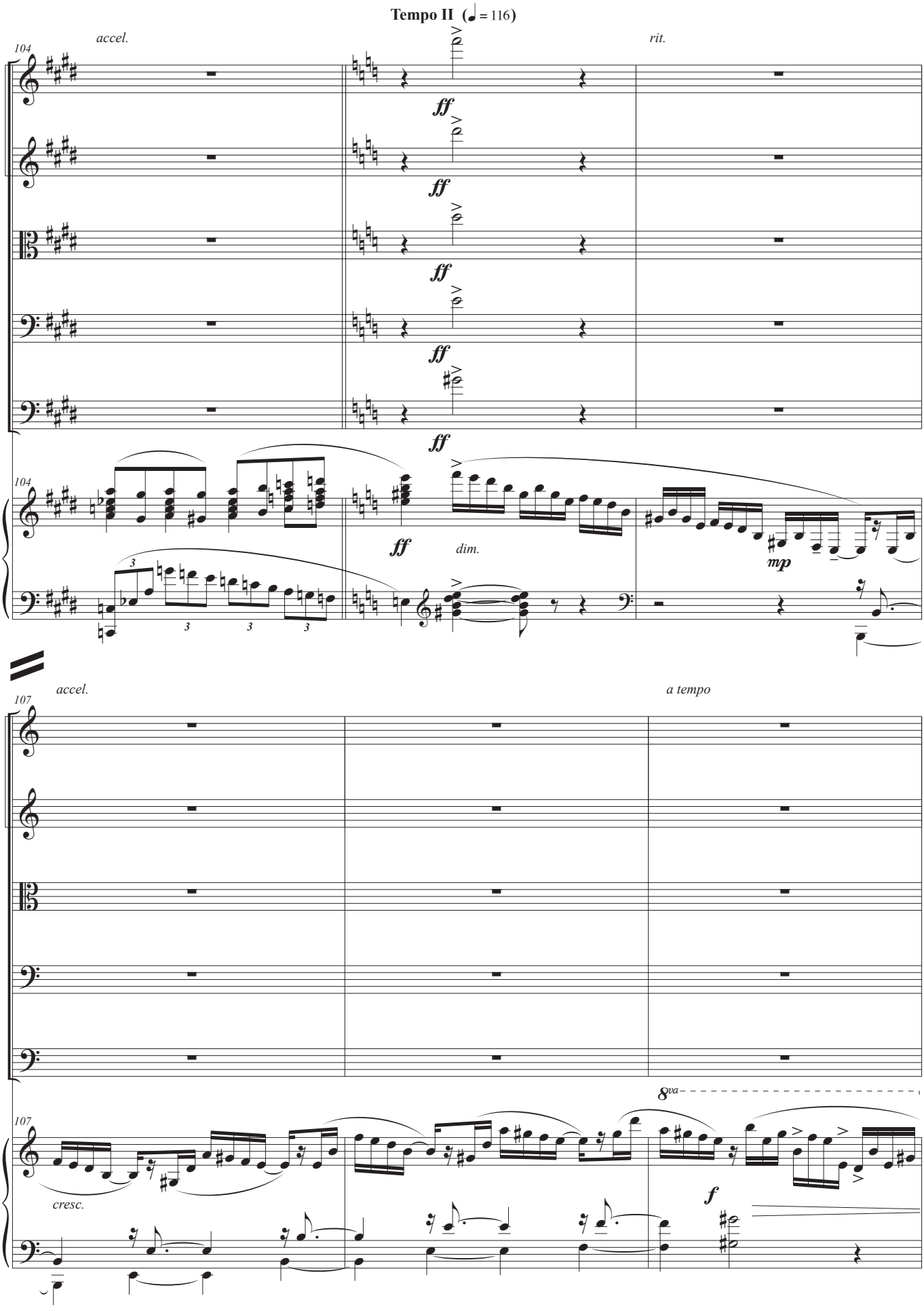

68
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
mf
rit.
D
a tempo
72
ff
f
cantabile
dim.
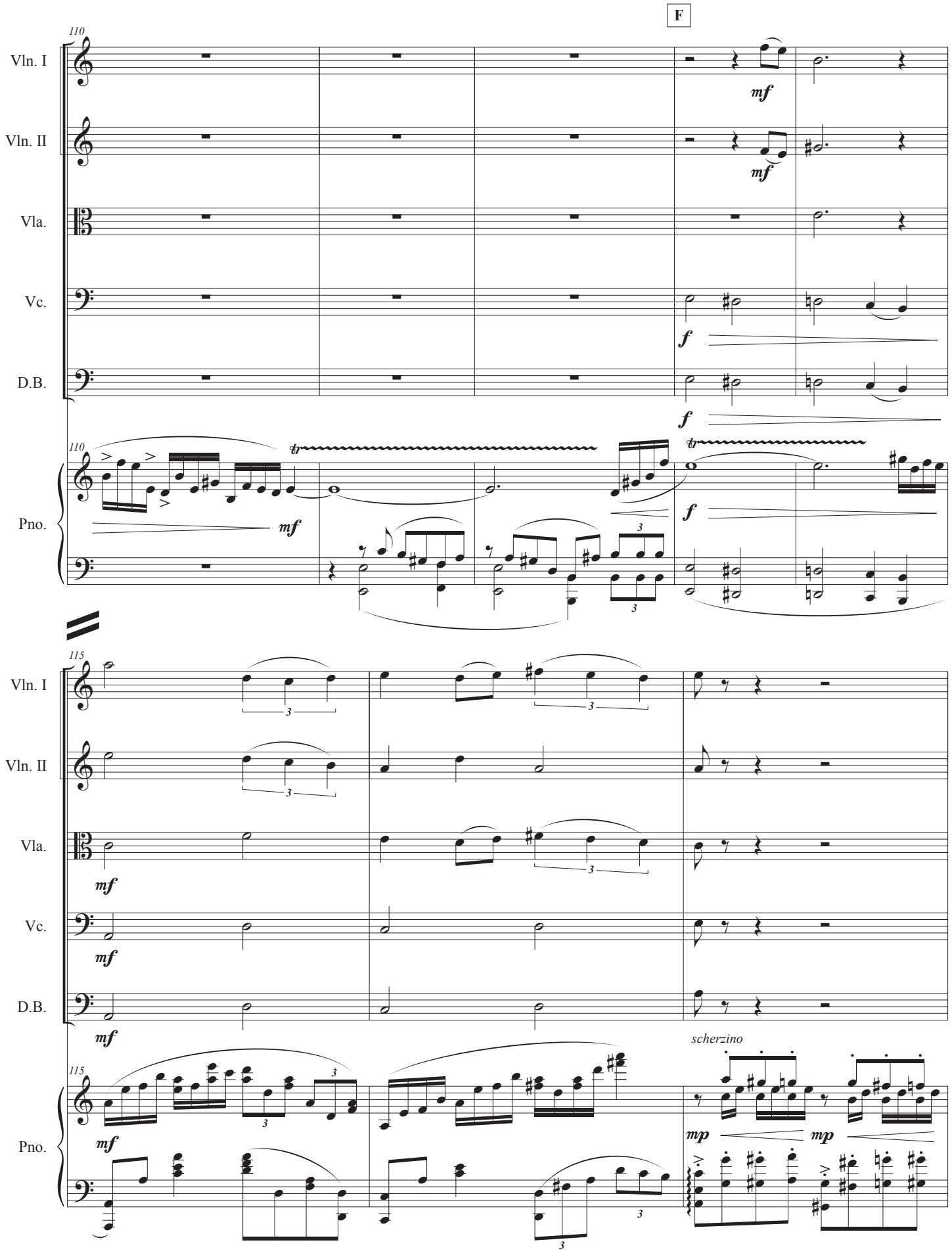

77
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
p
mf
mp
8va
80
(8va)
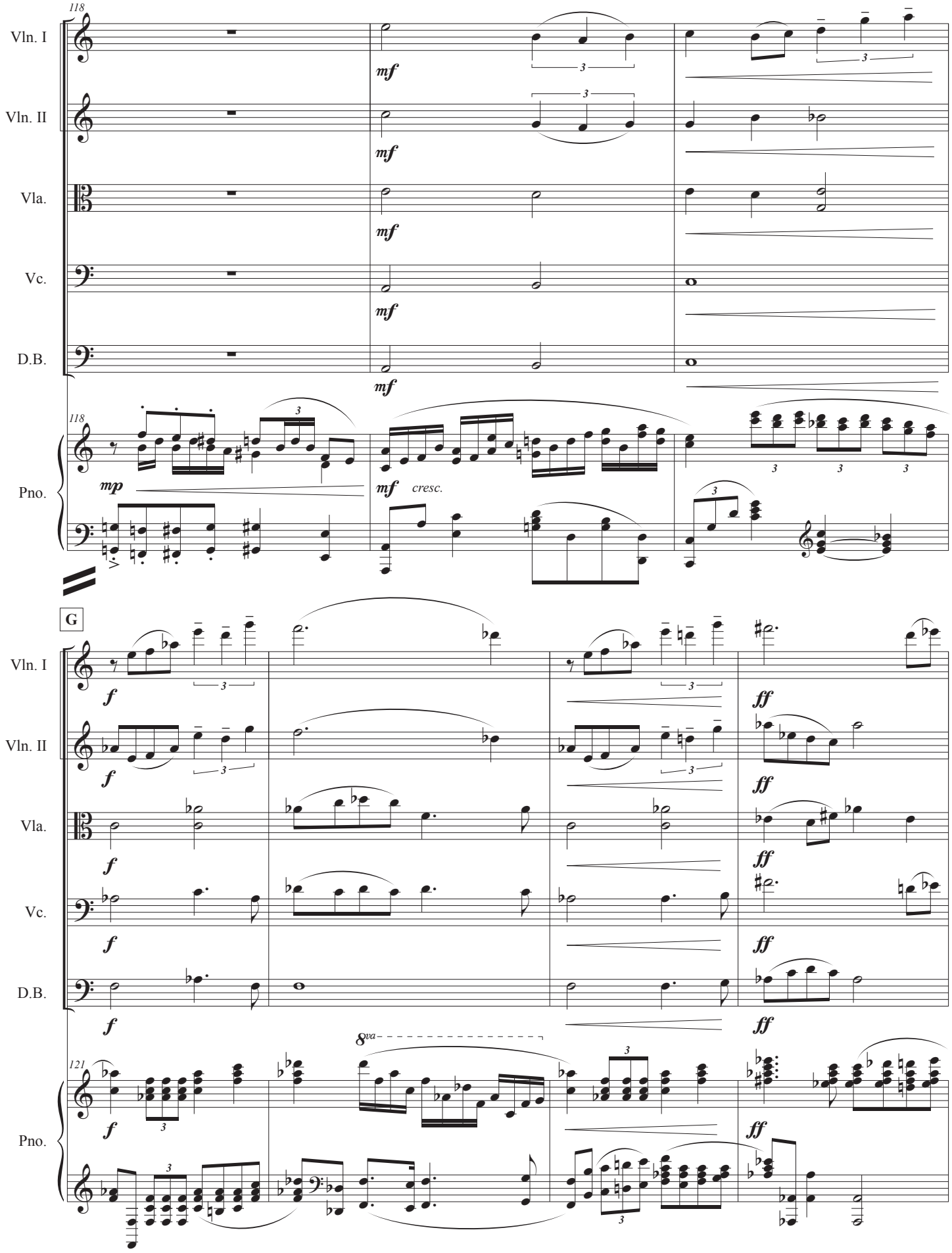

E
a tempo espressivo.
rit.
84
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
mp
mf
88
f
8va
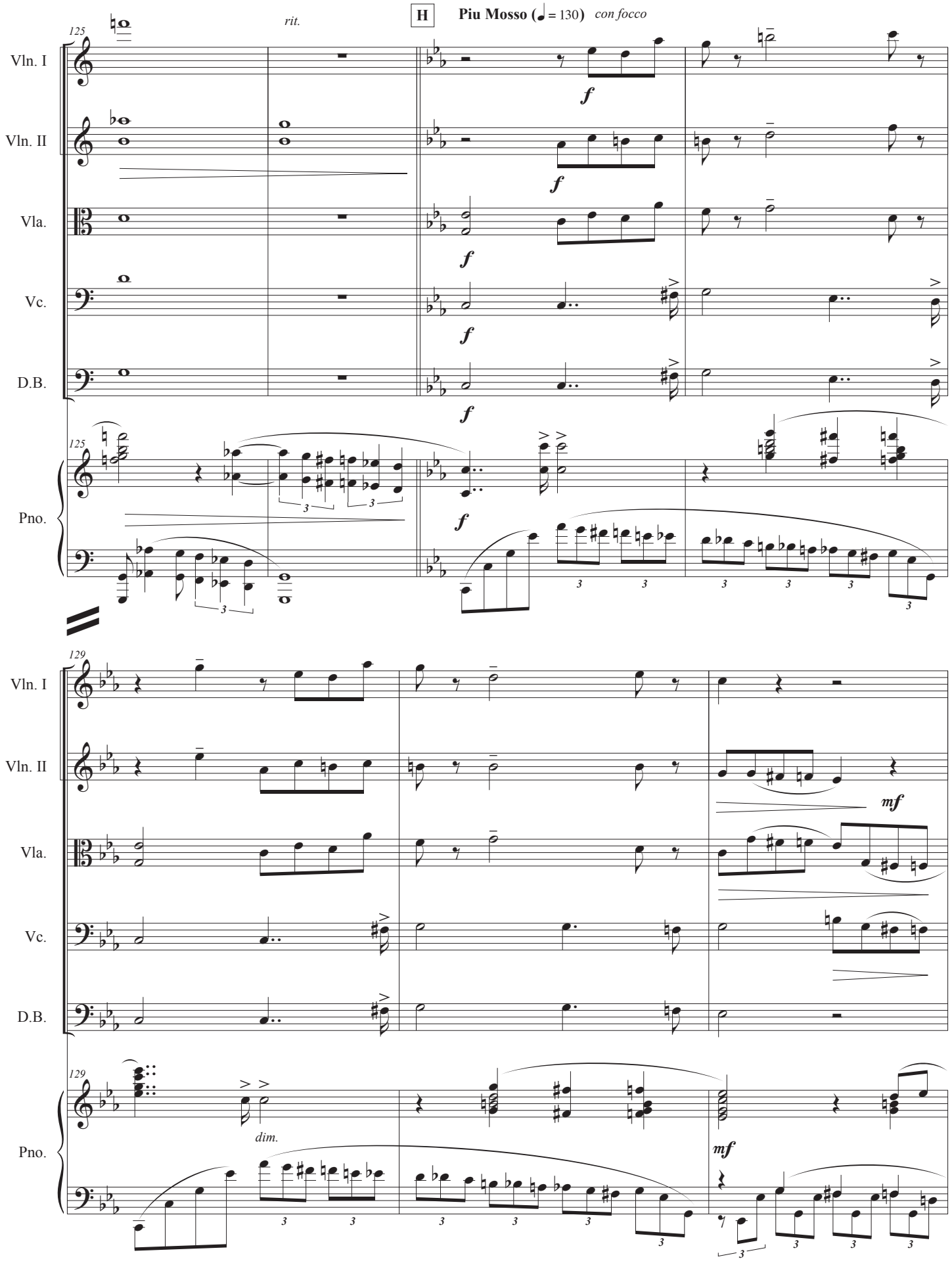

91
Vln. I
mf
Vln. II
mf
Vla.
mf
Vc.
mf
D.B.
mf
Pno.
8va
mf
cresc.
94
Vln. I
f
Vln. II
f
Vla.
f
Vc.
f
D.B.
f
Pno.
8va
f
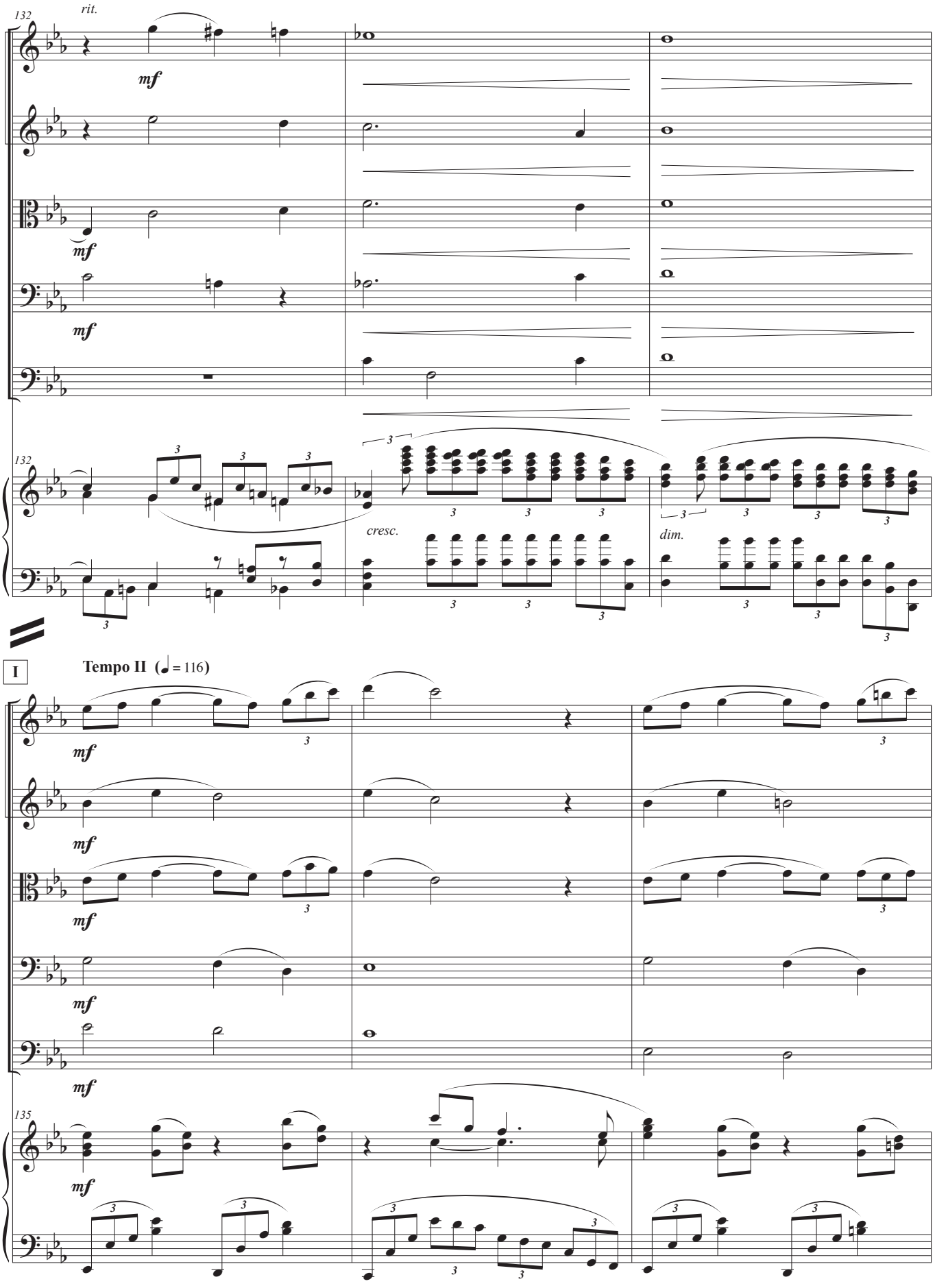

98
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
rit.
ff
8va
mf
f
101
a tempo
cresc.
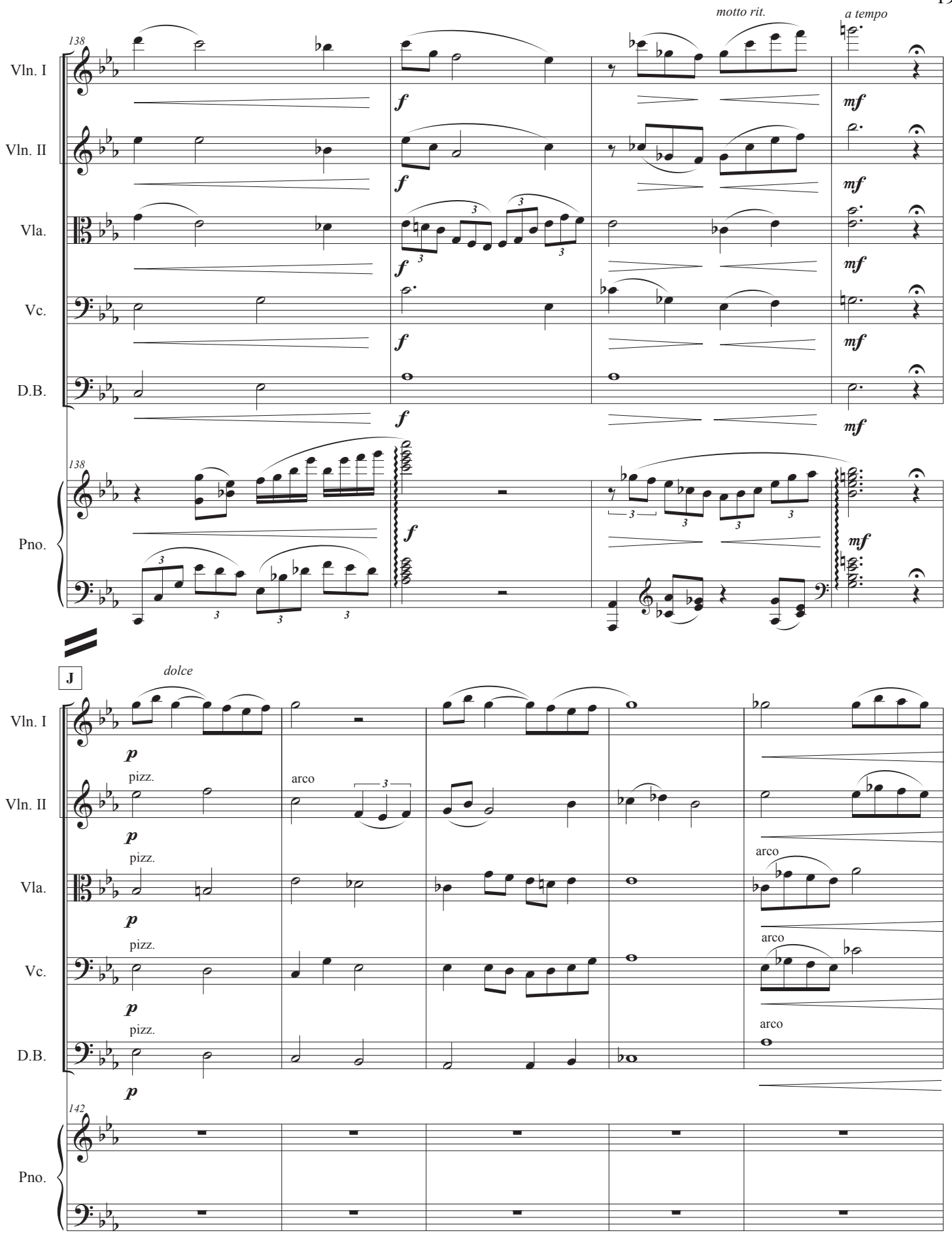

Tempo II (♩ = 116)
accel.
rit.
104
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
ff
dim.
mp
accel.
a tempo
107
cresc.
8va
f
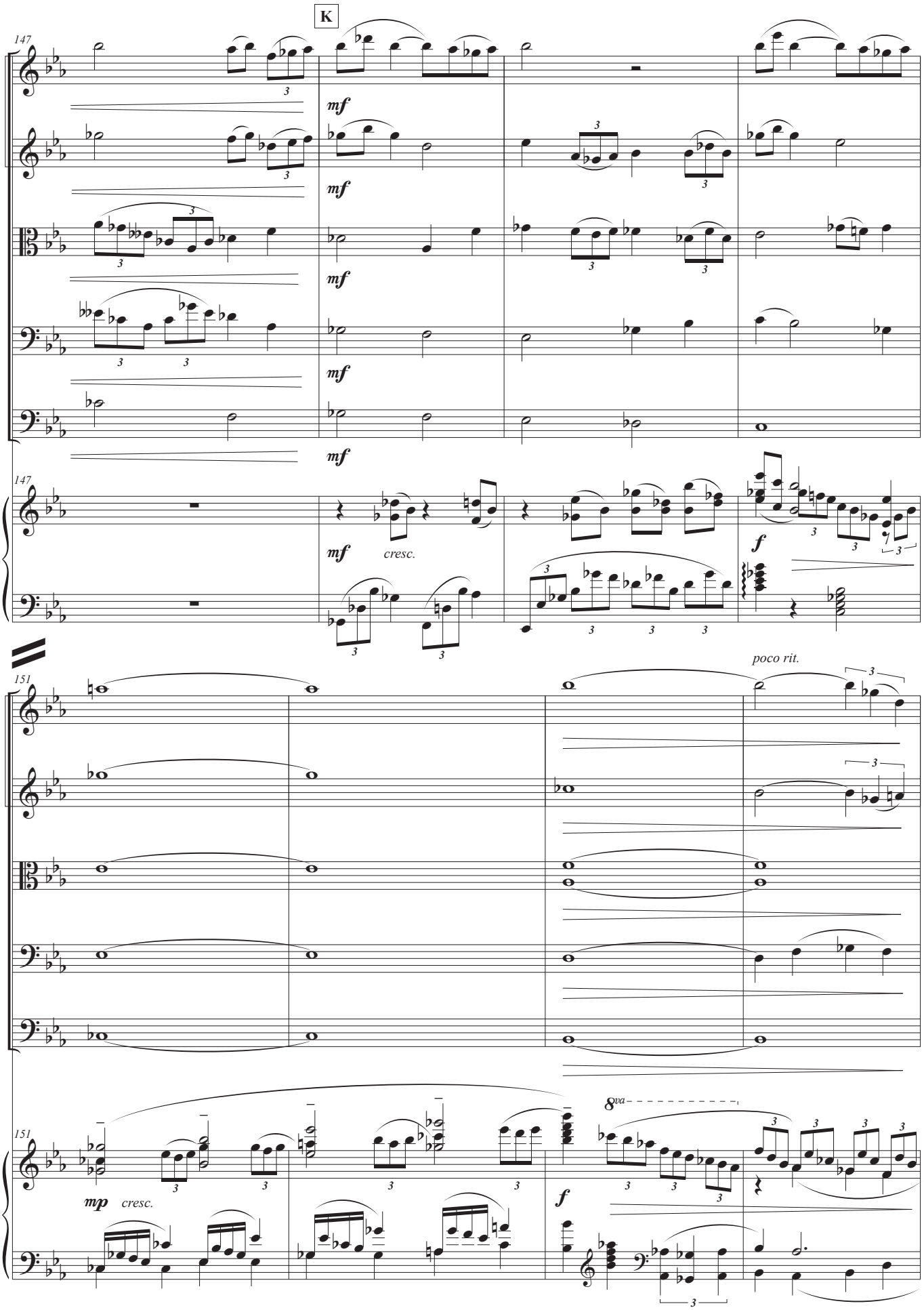

F
110
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
mf
f
tr
3
115
scherzino
mp
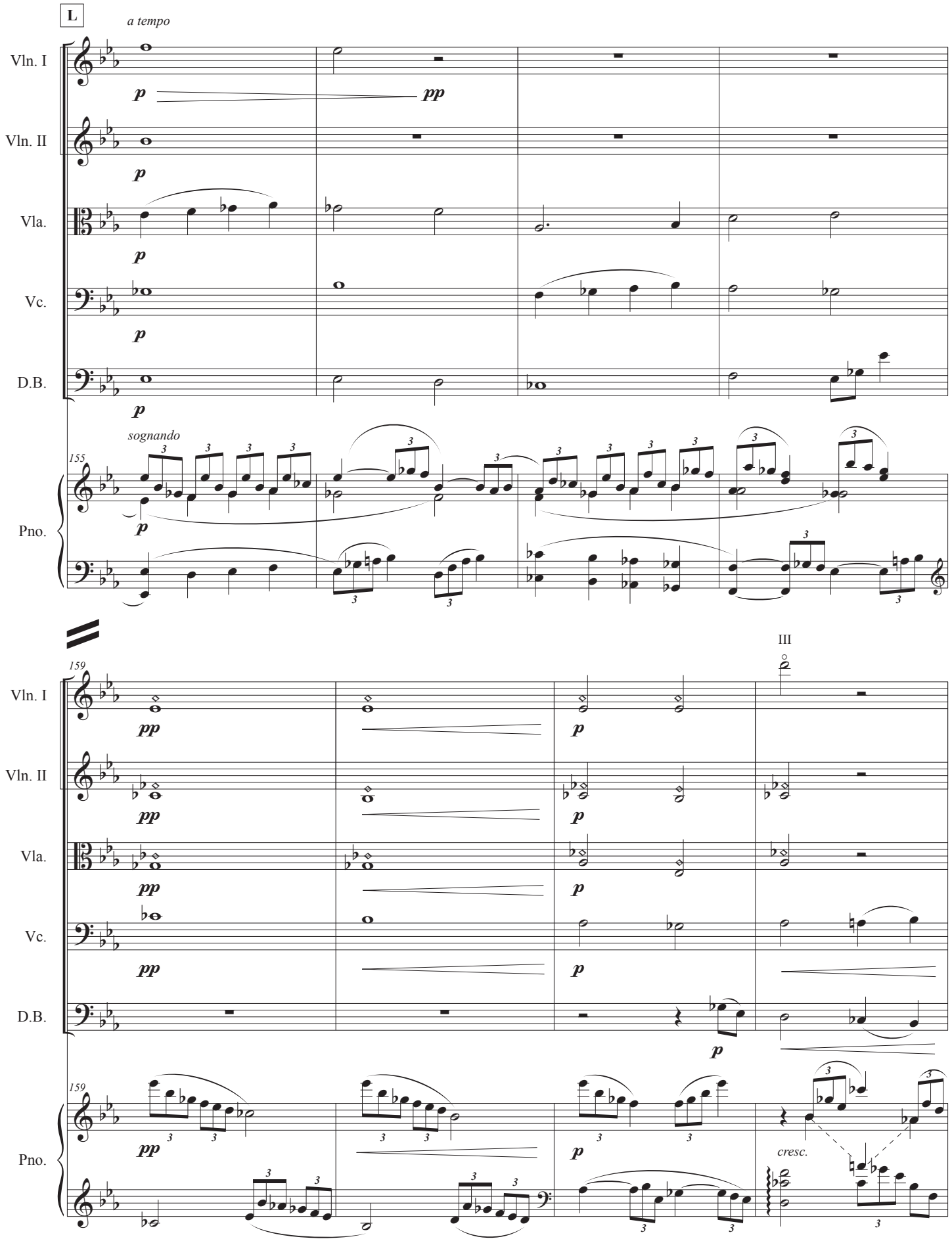

118
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
mf
mp
cresc.
G
f
ff
121
8va
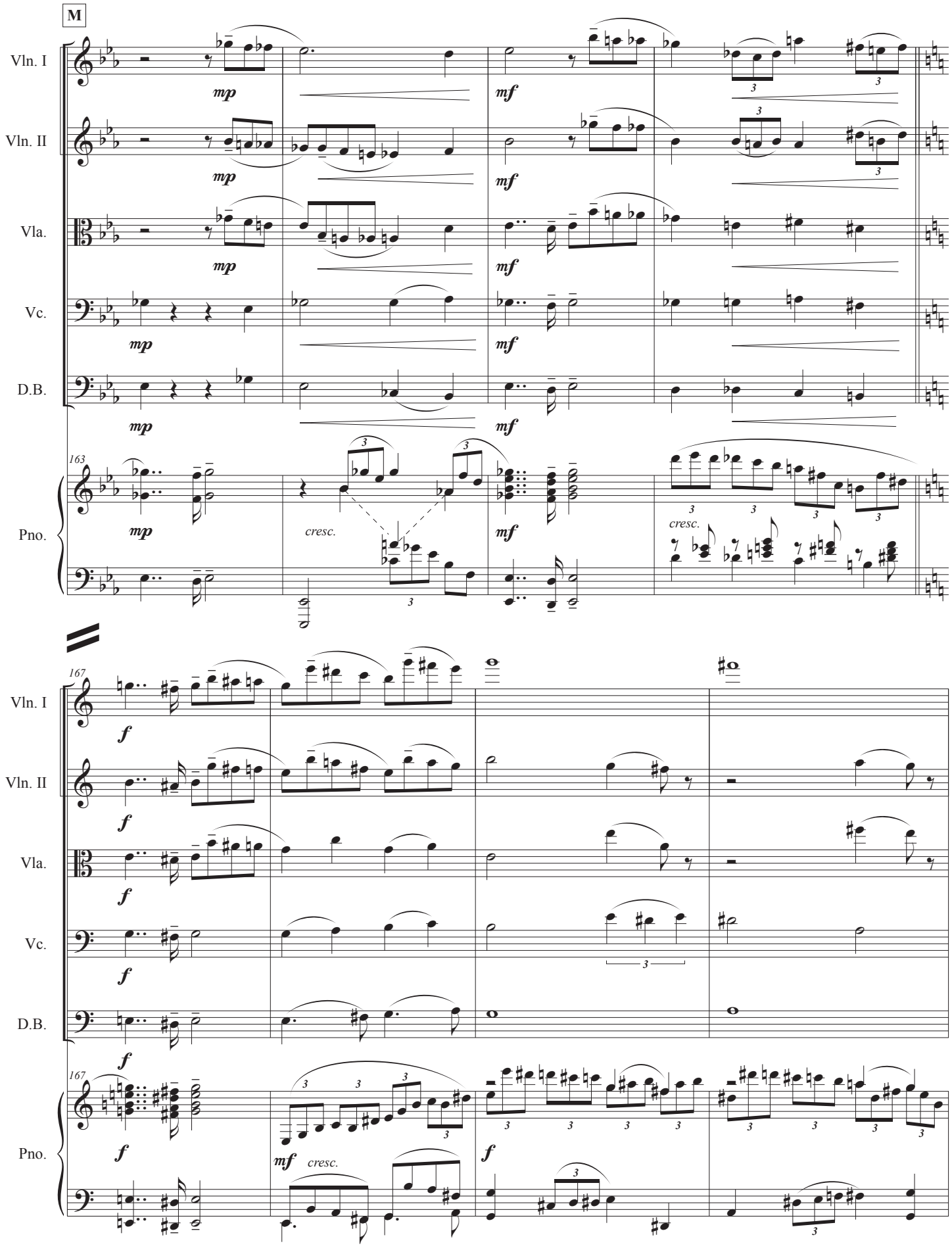

125
rit.
H
Piu Mosso (♩= 130) con focco
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
f
mf
dim.
129
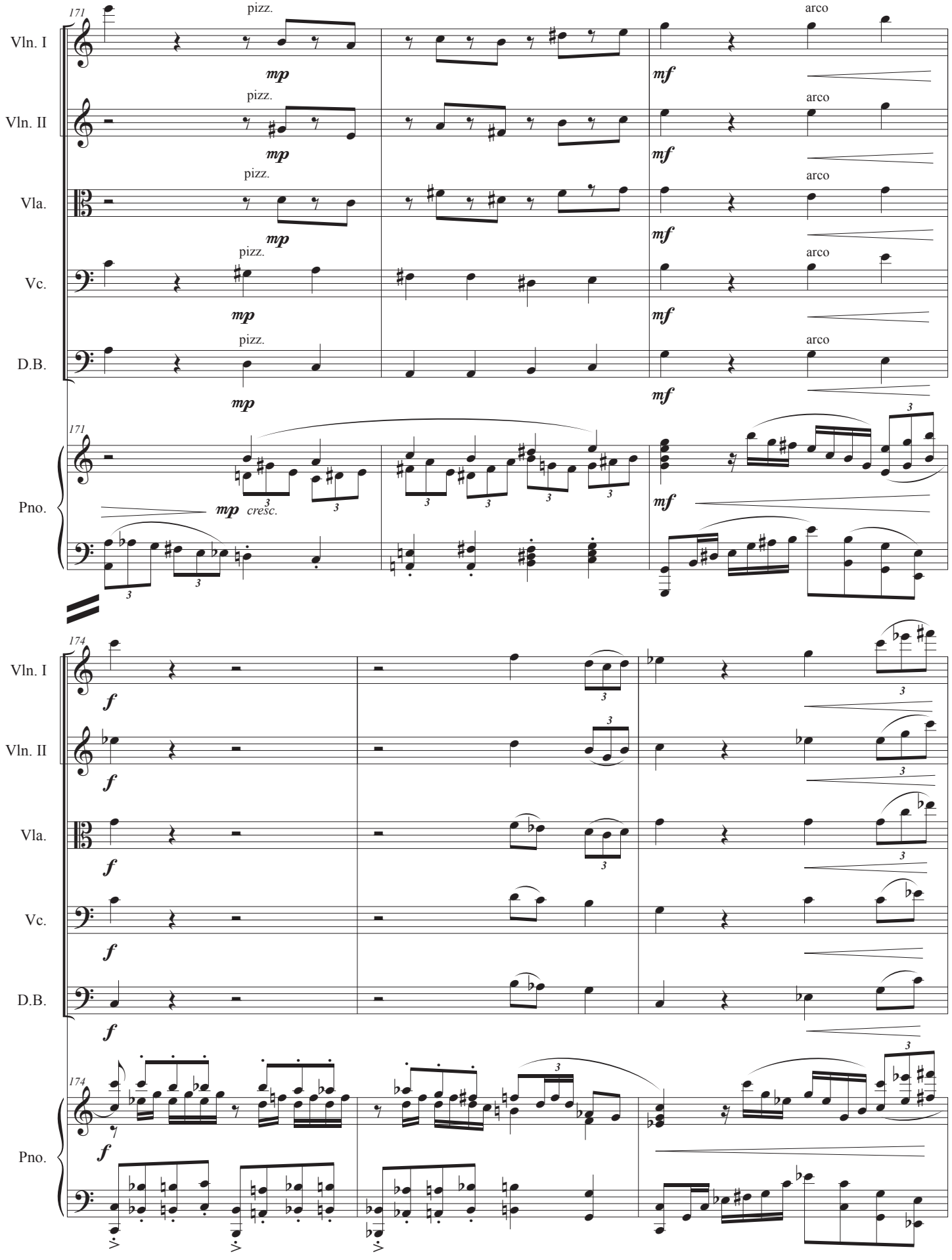

132
rit.
Vln. I
mf
Vln. II
Vla.
mf
Vc.
mf
D.B.
132
Pno.
cresc.
dim.
I
Tempo II (♩= 116)
Vln. I
mf
Vln. II
mf
Vla.
mf
Vc.
mf
D.B.
mf
135
Pno.
mf
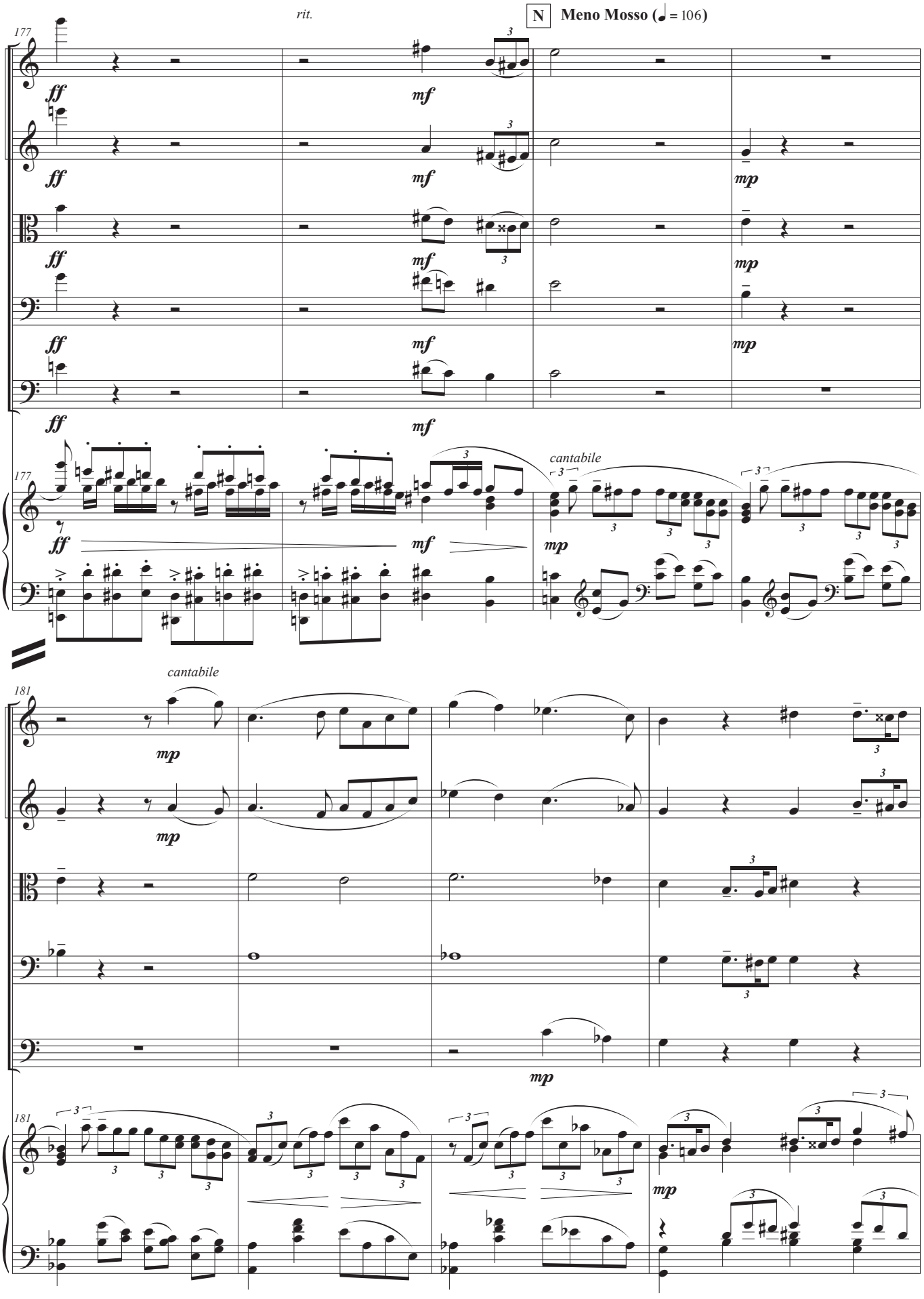

138
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
motto rit.
a tempo
f
mf
J
dolce
p
pizz.
arco
142
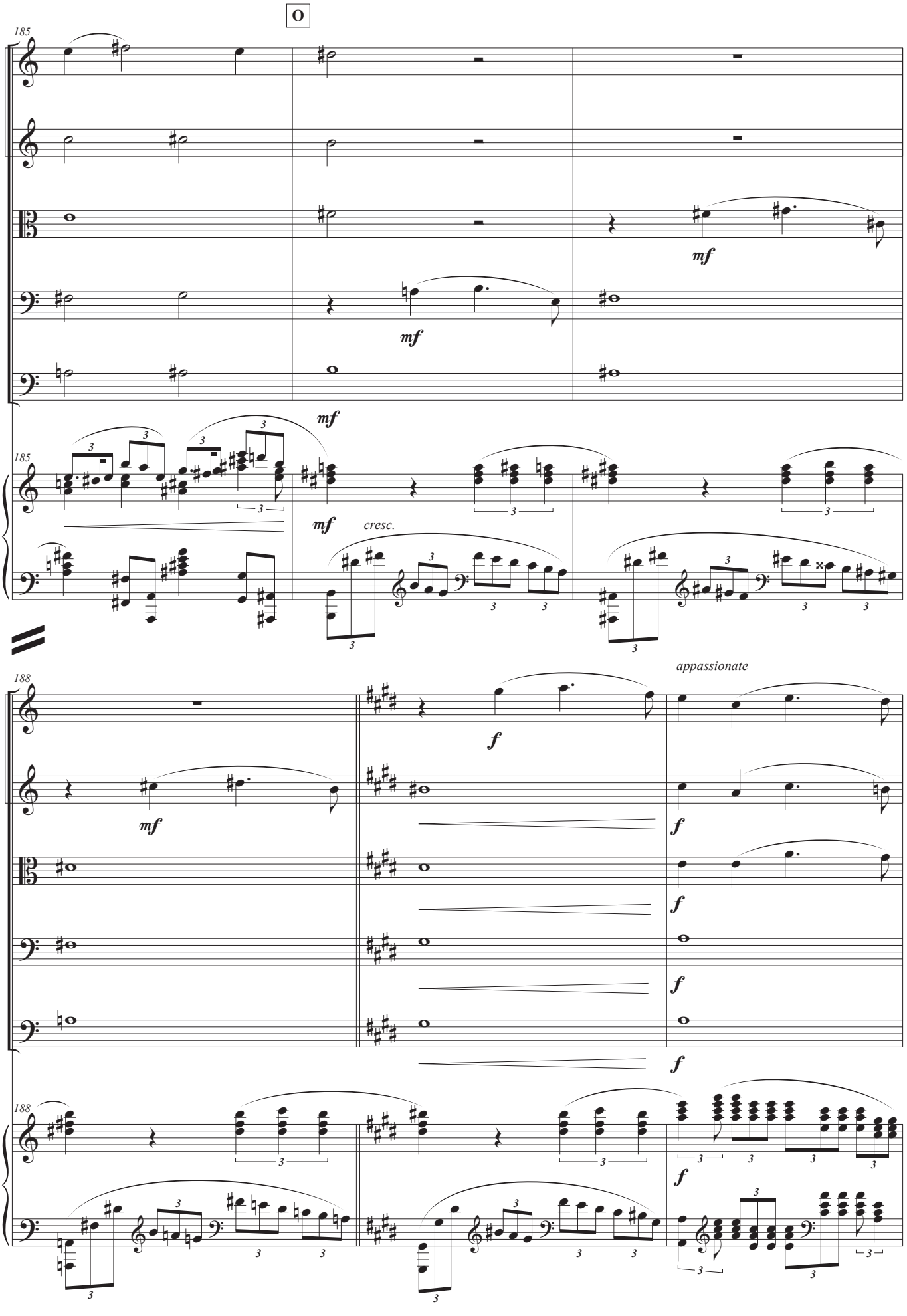

K
147
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
mf
cresc.
f
151
poco rit.
mp
8va
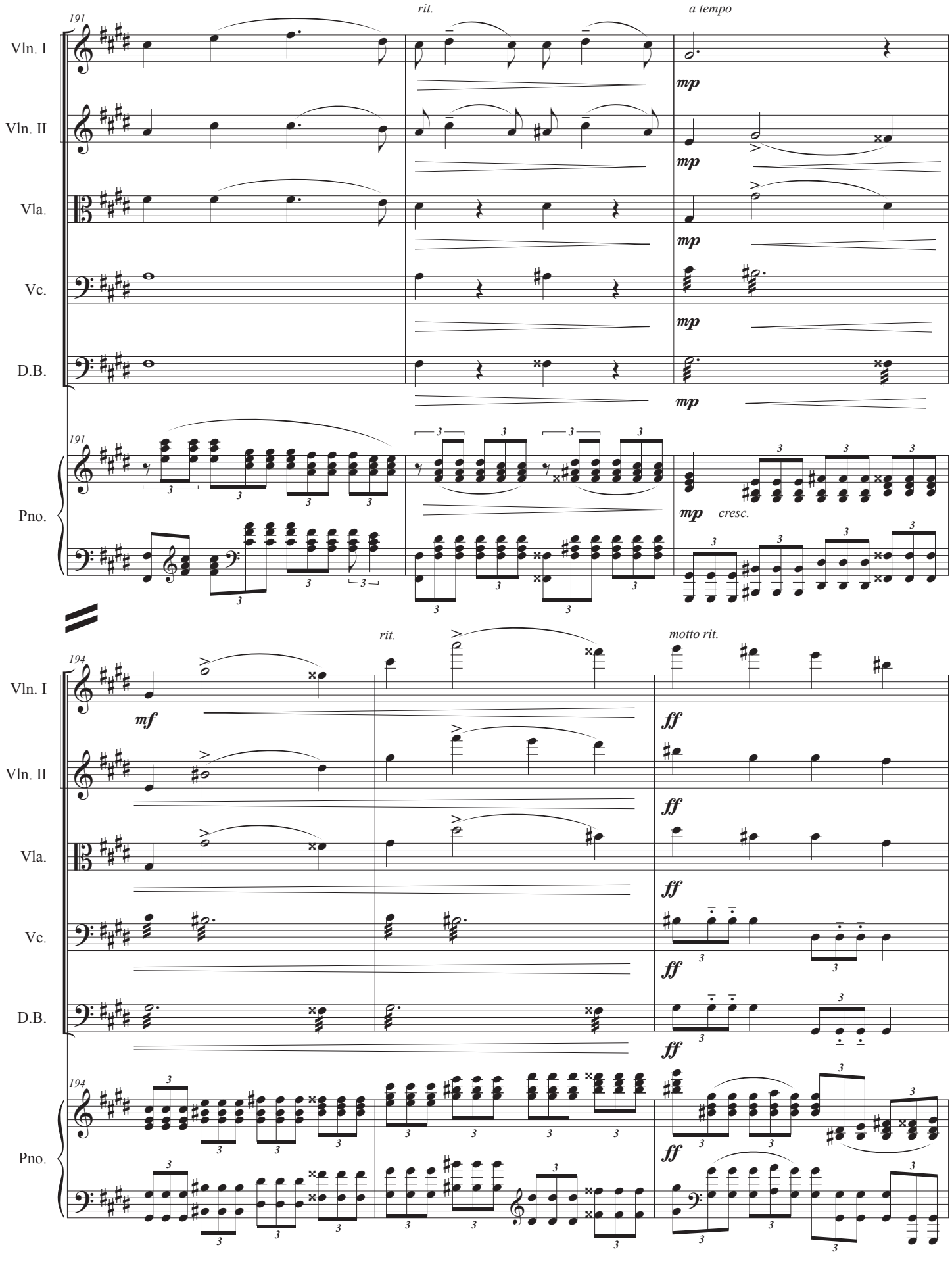

L
a tempo
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
sognando
155
159
III
cresc.
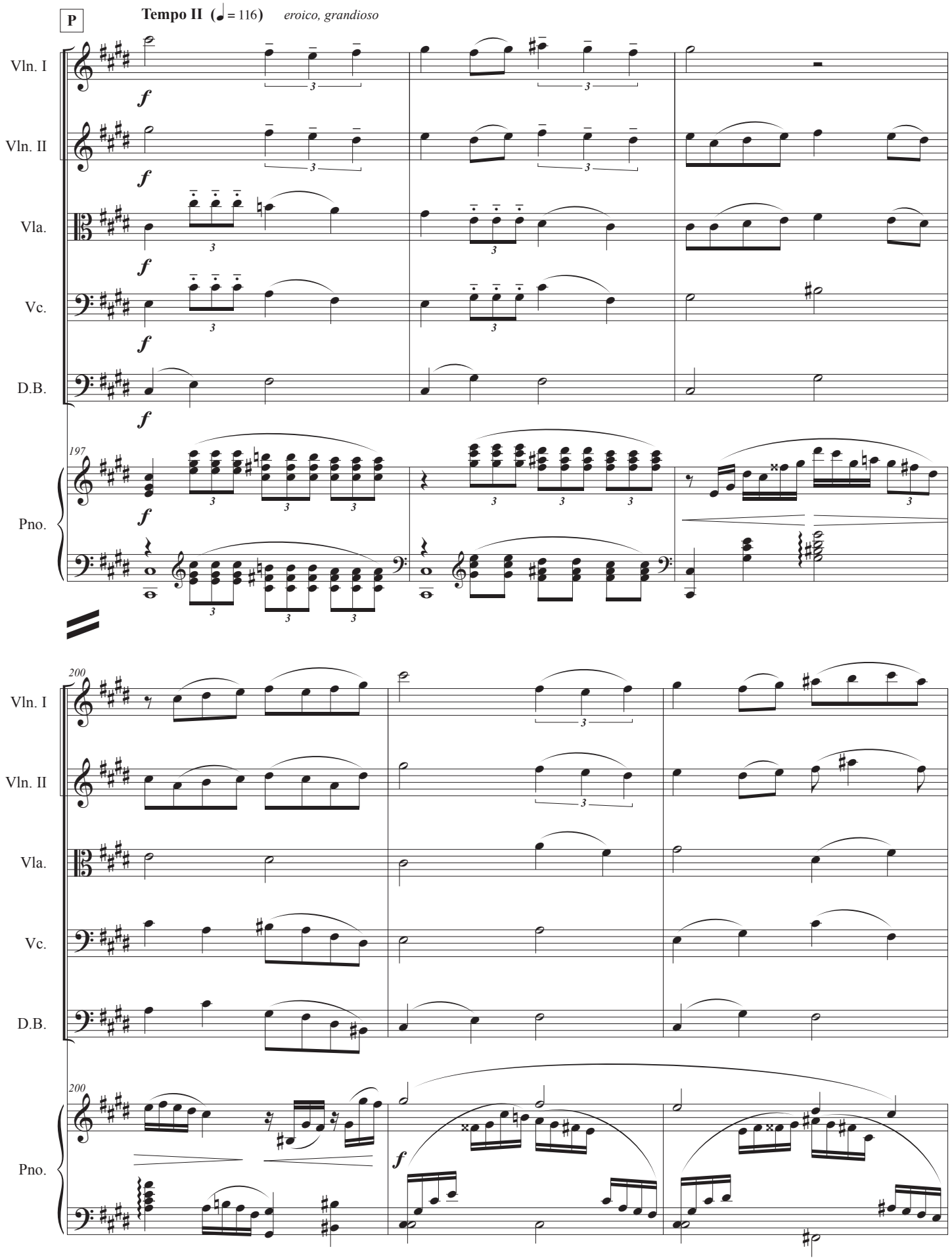

M
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
mp
mf
163
cresc.
167
f
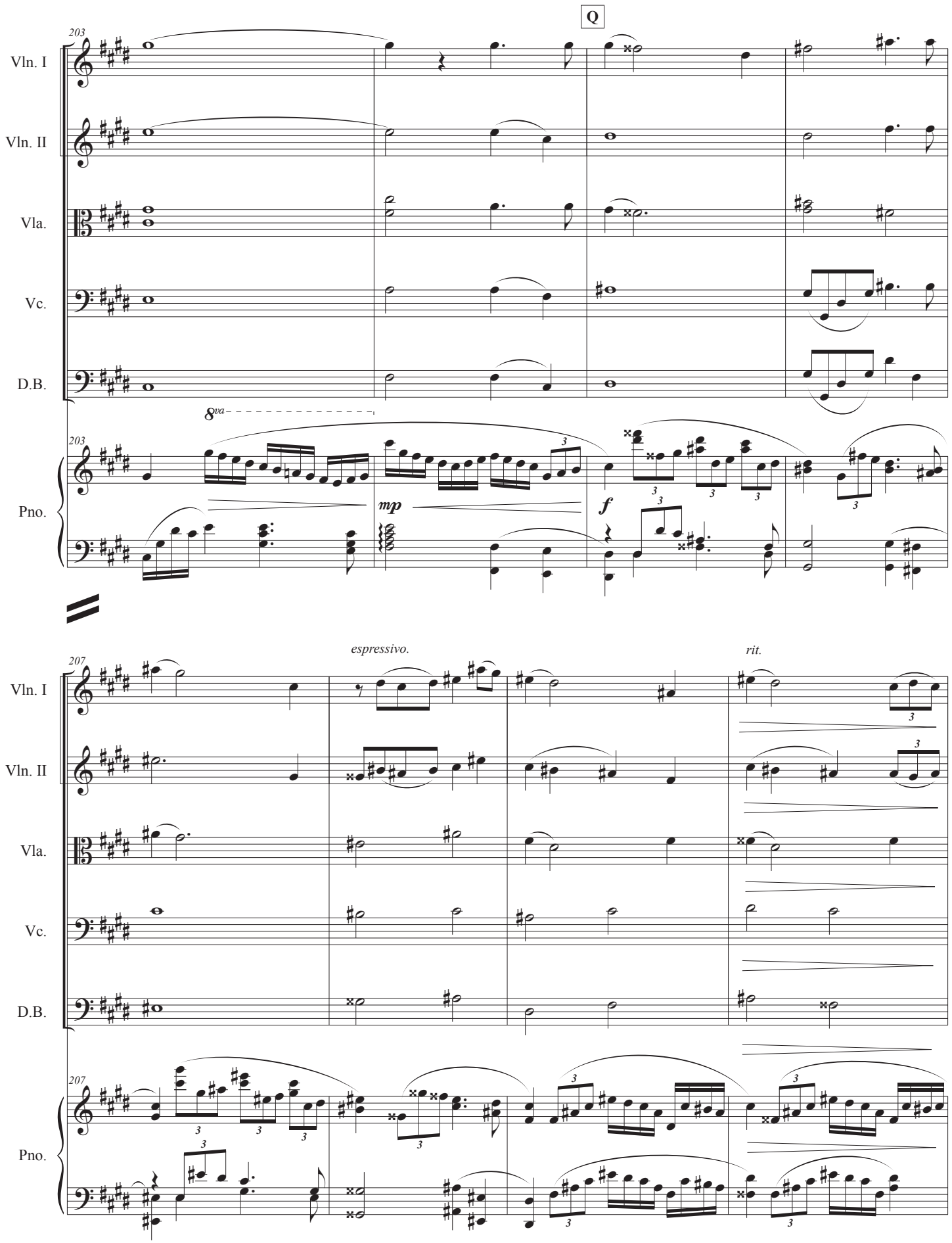

171
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
pizz.
arco
mp
mf
cresc.
174
f
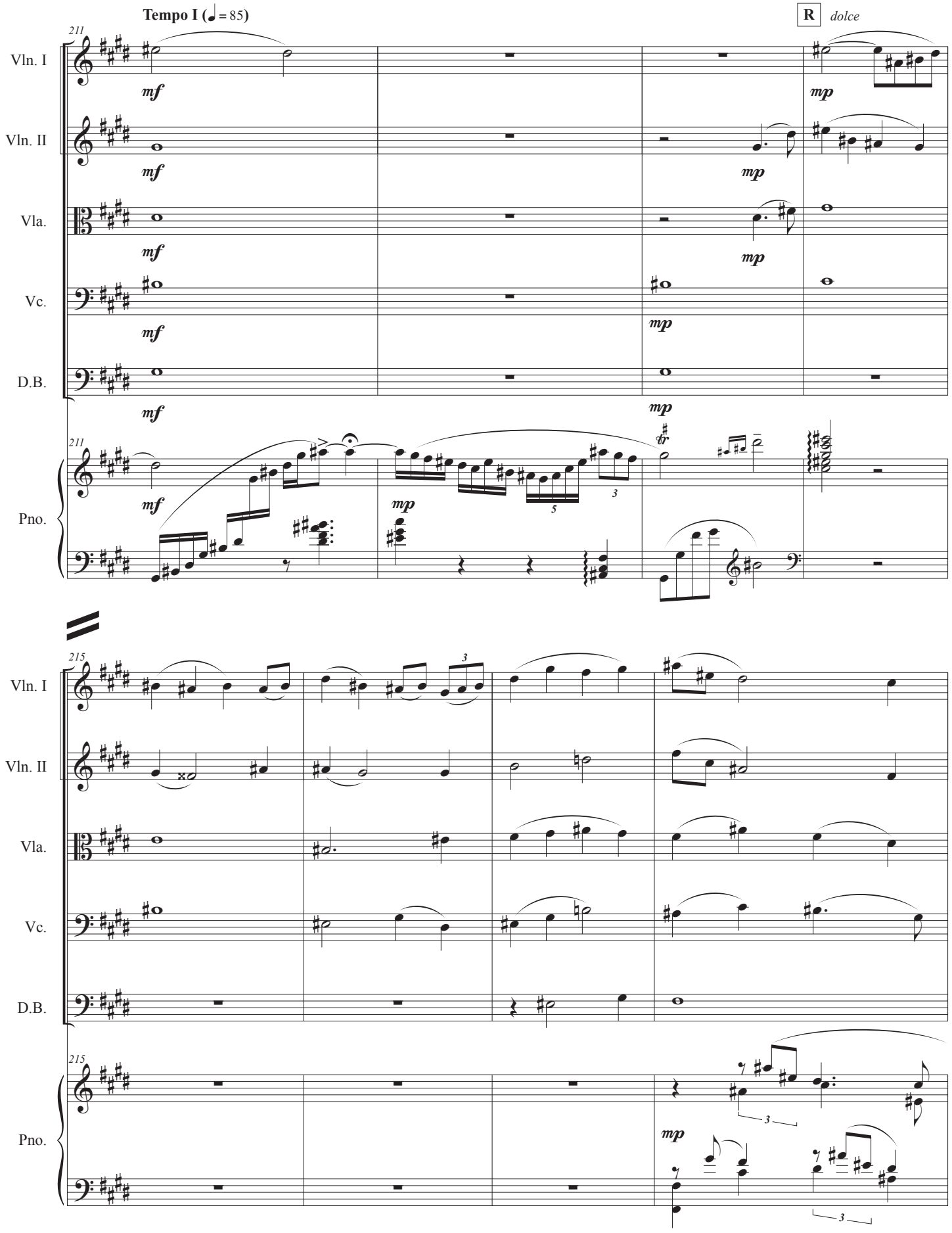

rit.
N
Meno Mosso (♩ = 106)
177
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
ff
mf
mp
cantabile
181
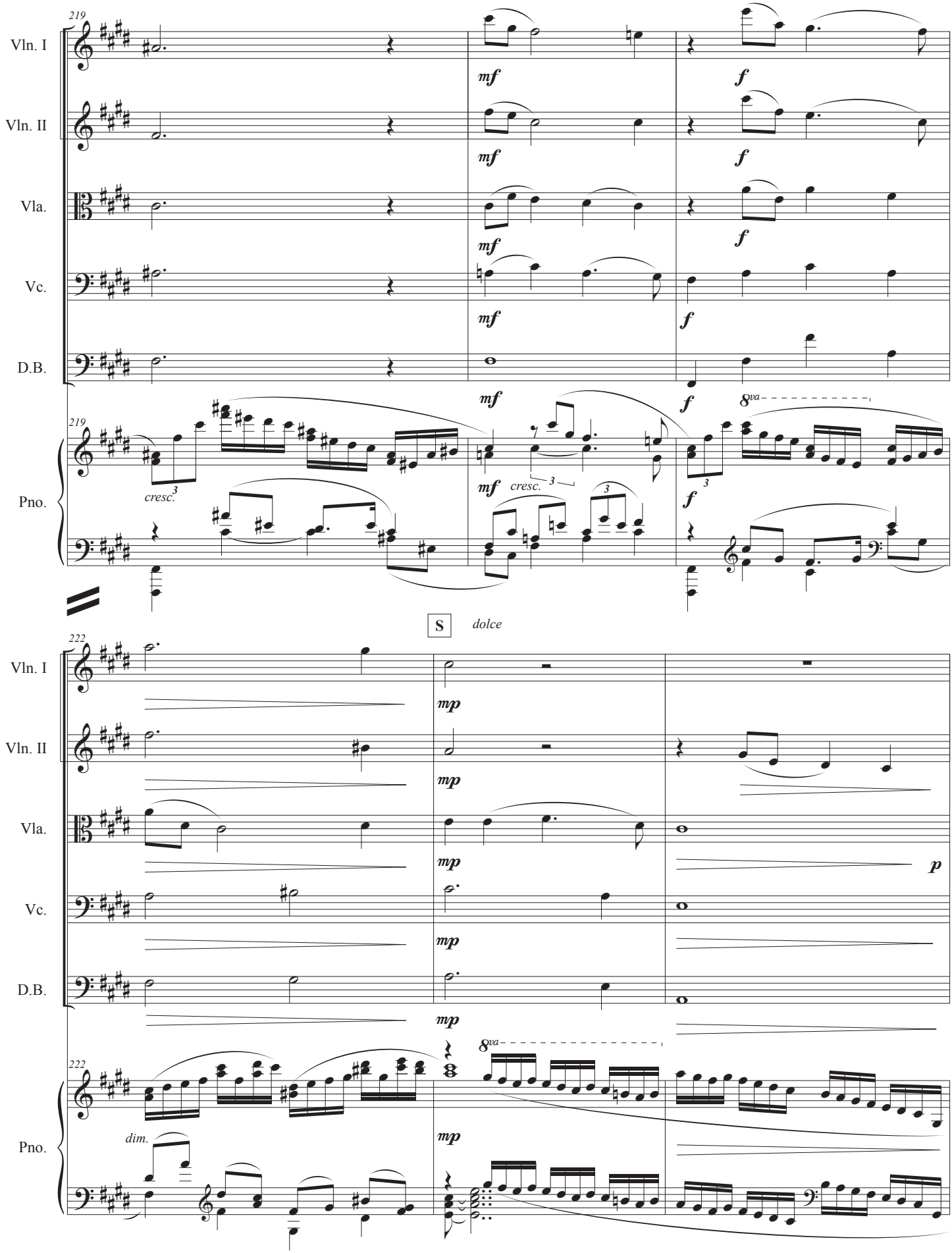

O
185
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
mf
cresc.
188
f
appassionate
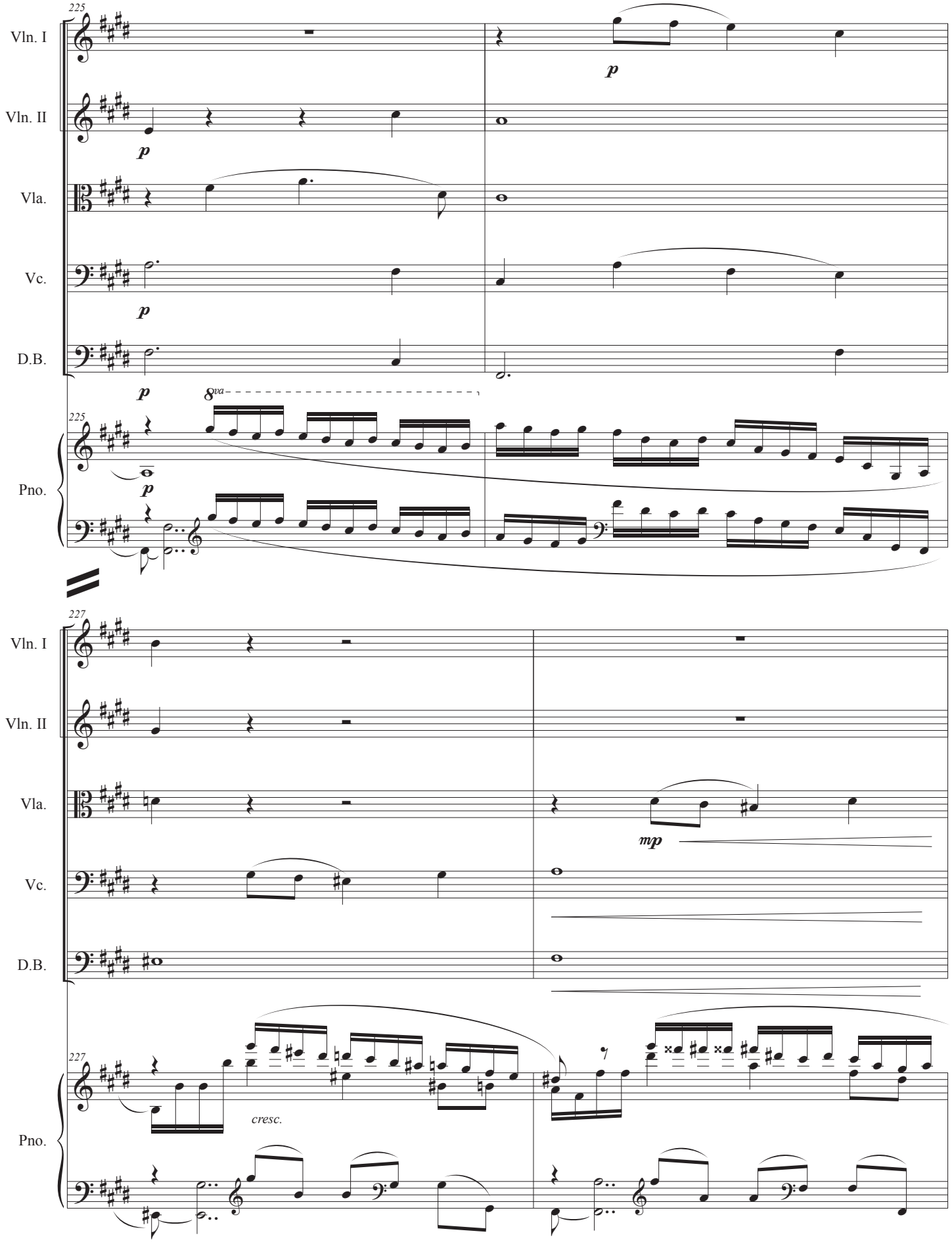

191
rit.
a tempo
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
mp
cresc.
194
mf
ff
motto rit.
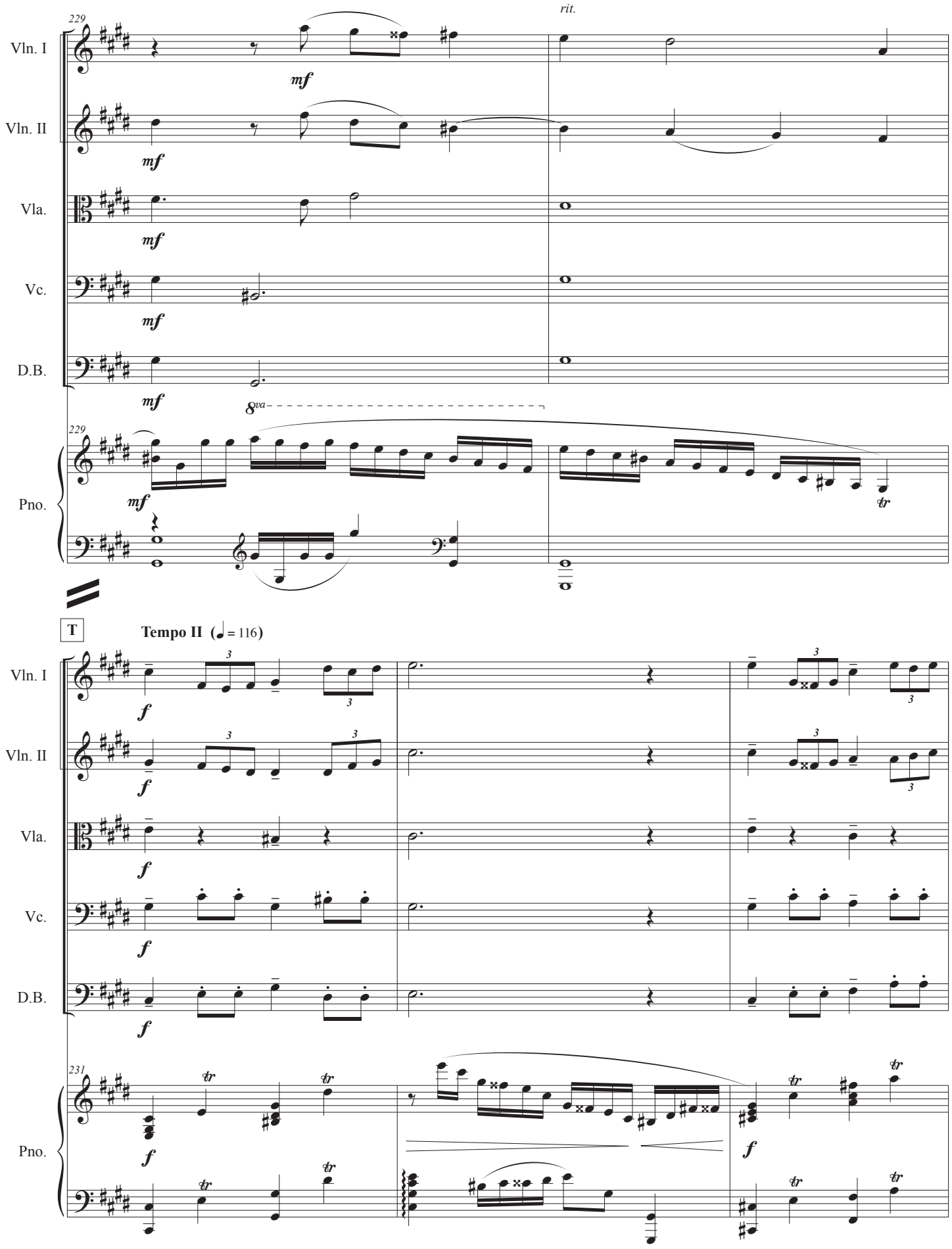

P
Tempo II (♩ = 116) eroico, grandioso
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
197
200
f
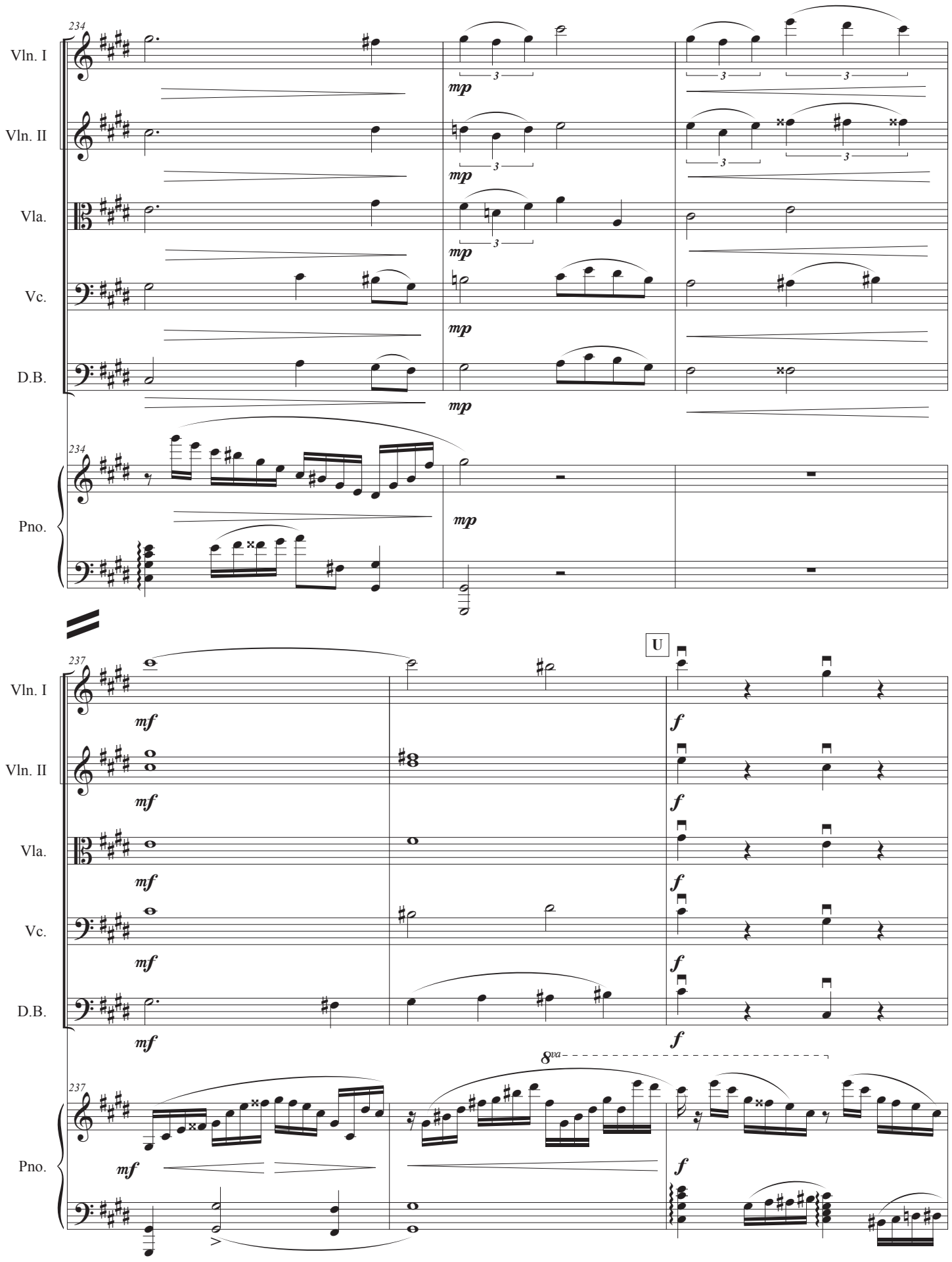

Q
203
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
8va
Pno.
mp
f
207
espressivo.
rit.
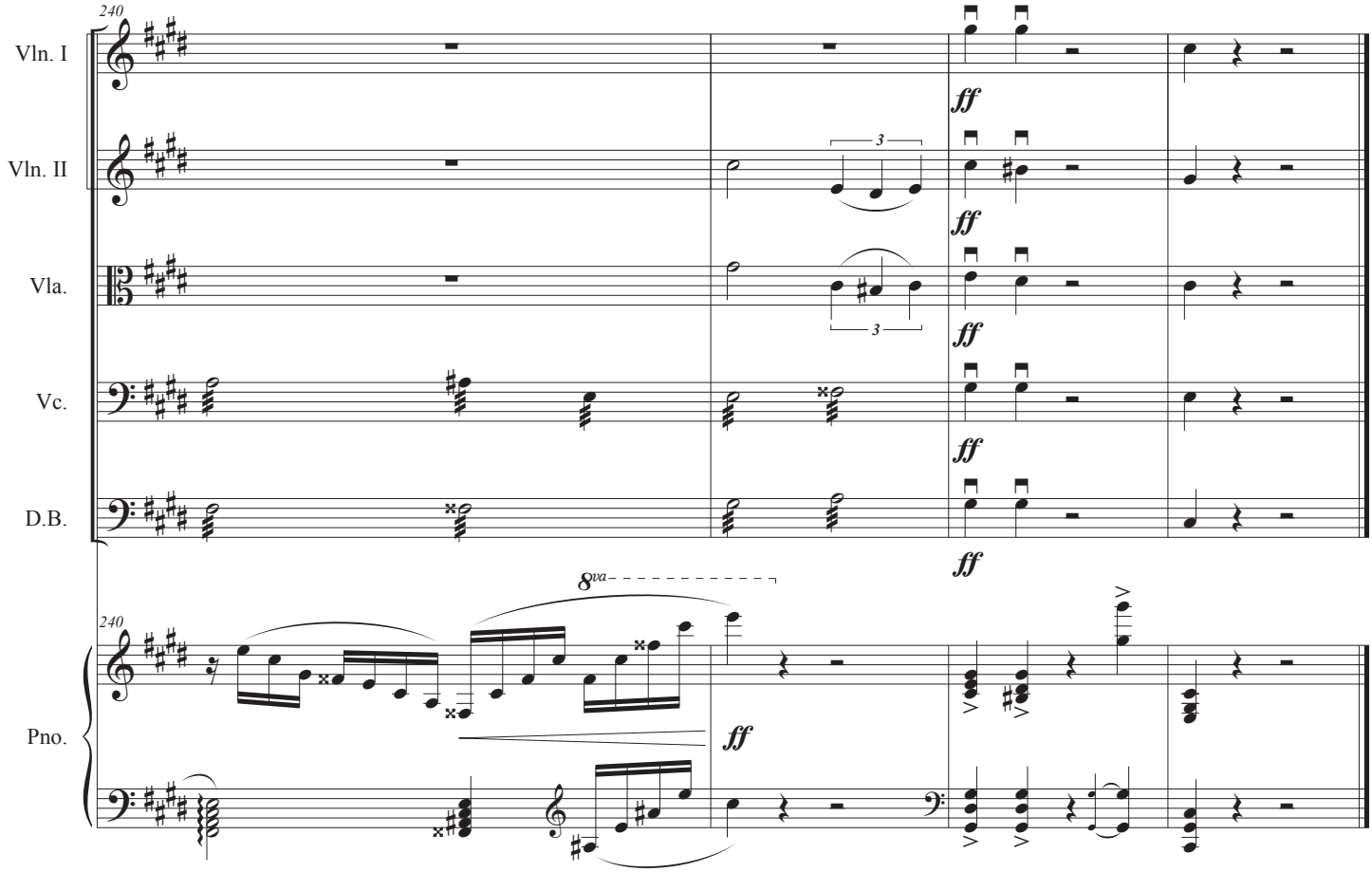

Tempo I (♩ = 85)
R
dolce
211
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
mf
mp
215


219
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
mf
f
cresc.
8va
S
dolce
222
mp
p
dim.
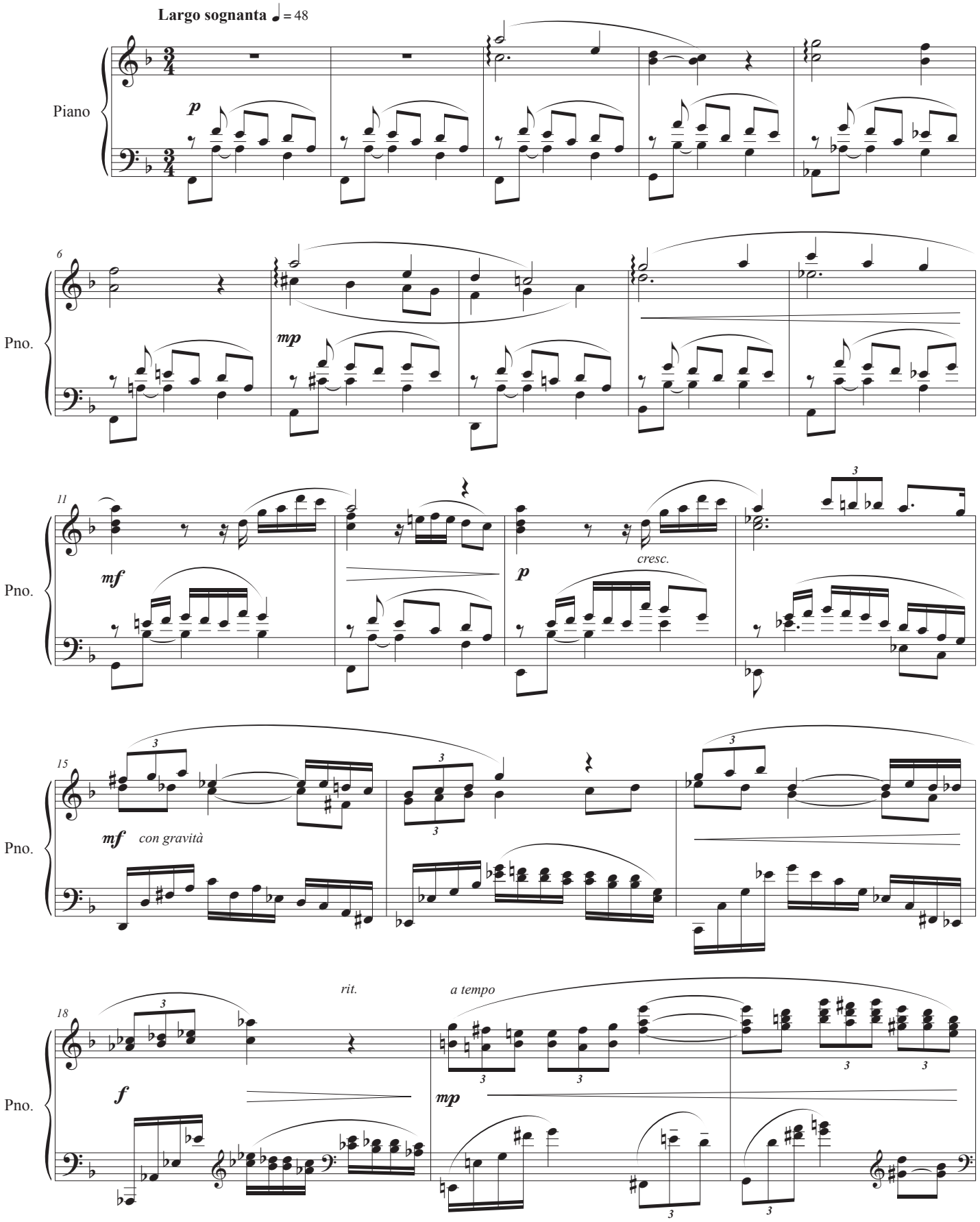

225
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
p
8va
227
mp
cresc.
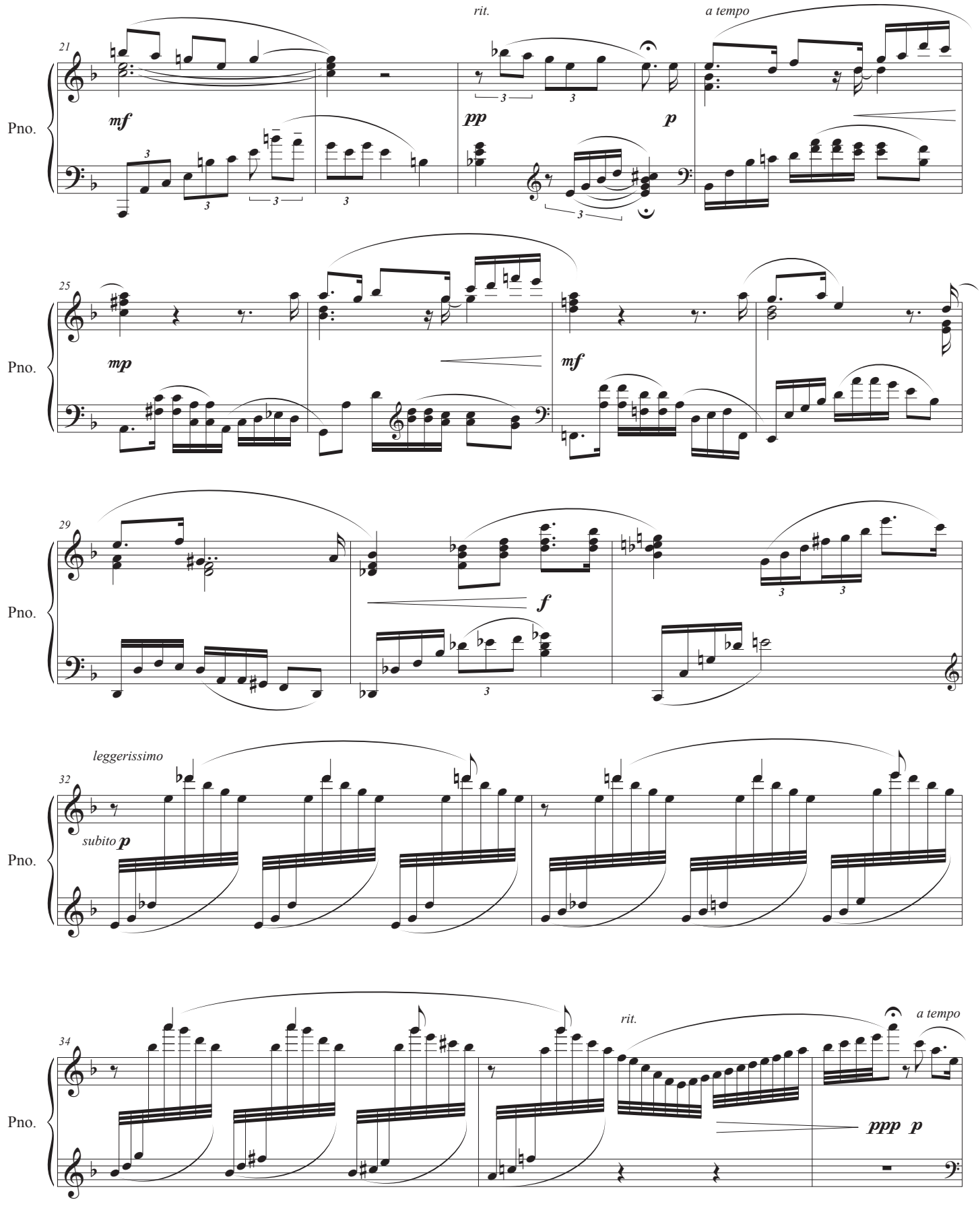

229
rit.
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
mf
8va
Pno.
tr
T
Tempo II (♩ = 116)
f
231


234
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
mp
3
234
mp
U
237
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
mf
f
8va
237
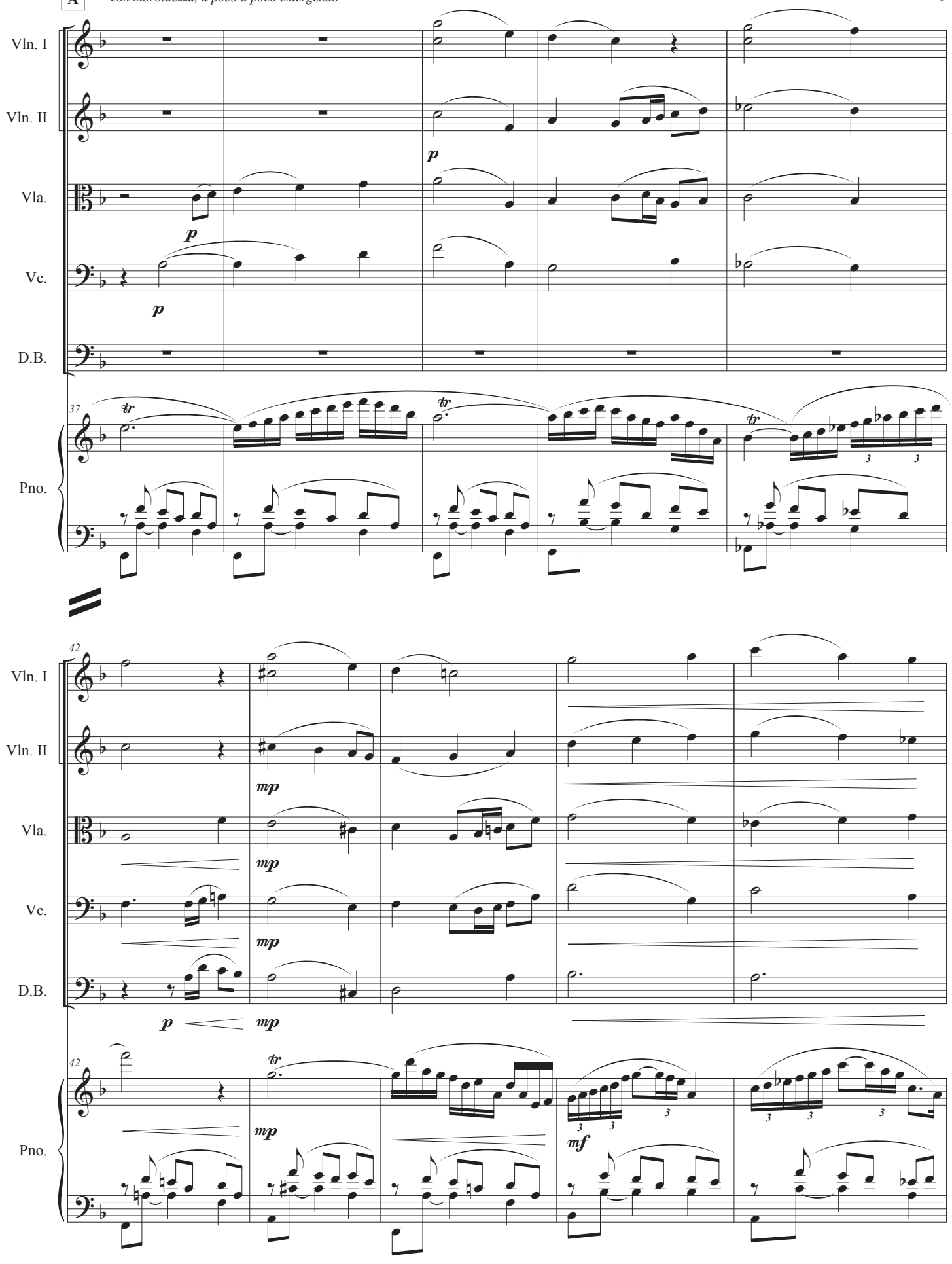

240
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
ff
3
8va
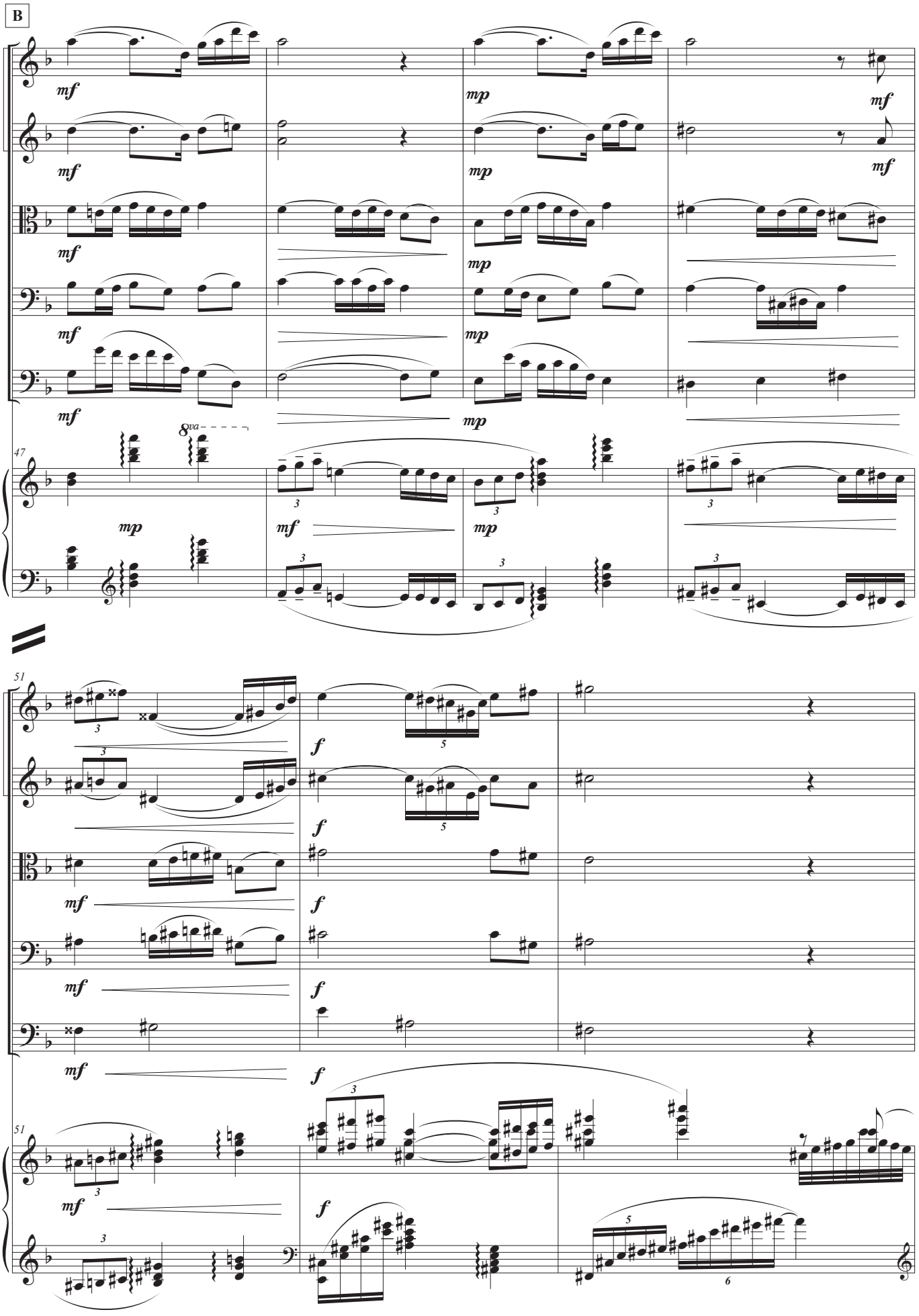
II
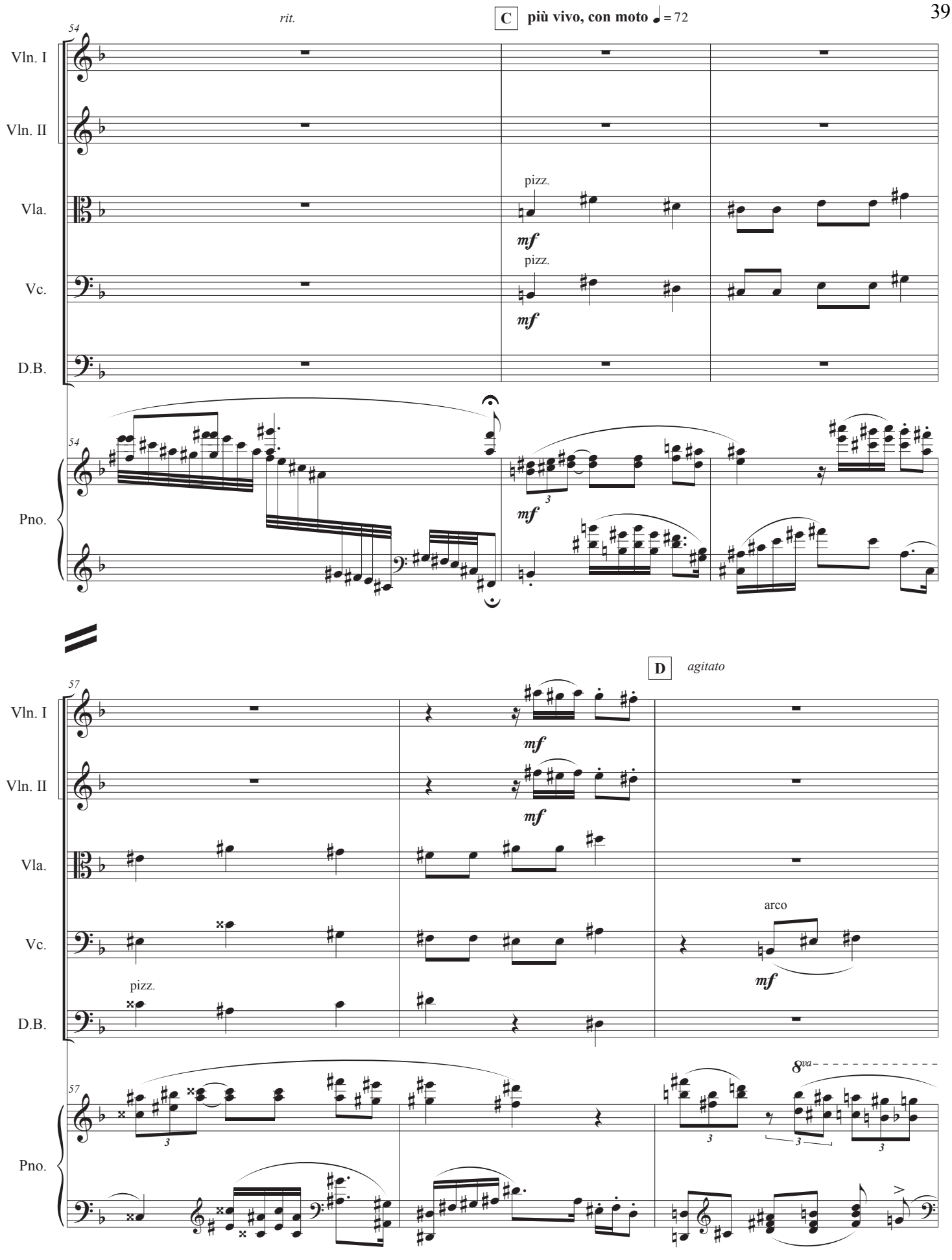

Largo sognanta ♩ = 48
Piano
p
6
Pno.
mp
11
Pno.
mf
p
cresc.
15
Pno.
mf
con gravità
18
Pno.
f
rit.
a tempo
mp
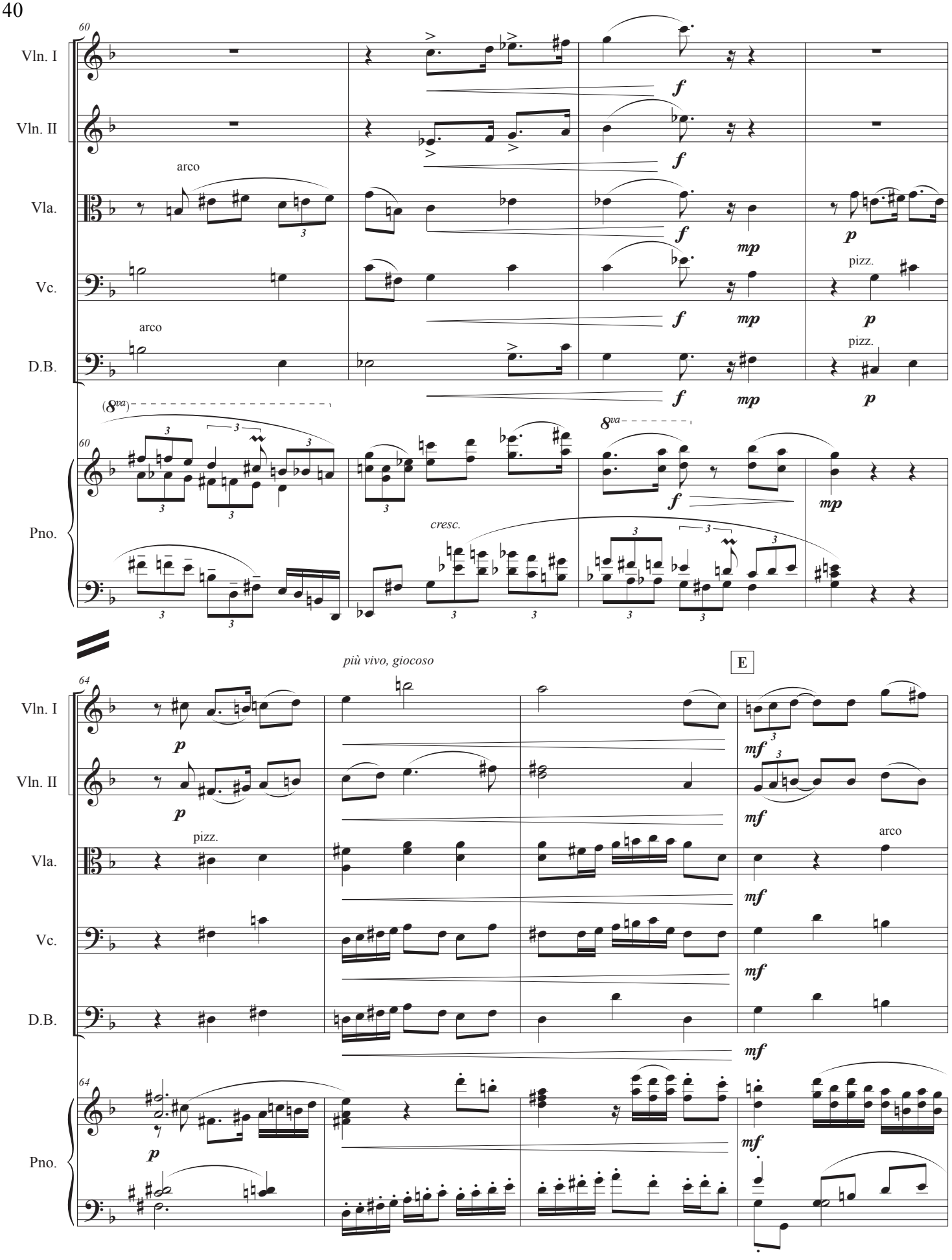

21
rit.
a tempo
Pno.
mf
pp
p
25
mp
mf
29
f
32
leggerissimo
subito p
34
rit.
a tempo
ppp p
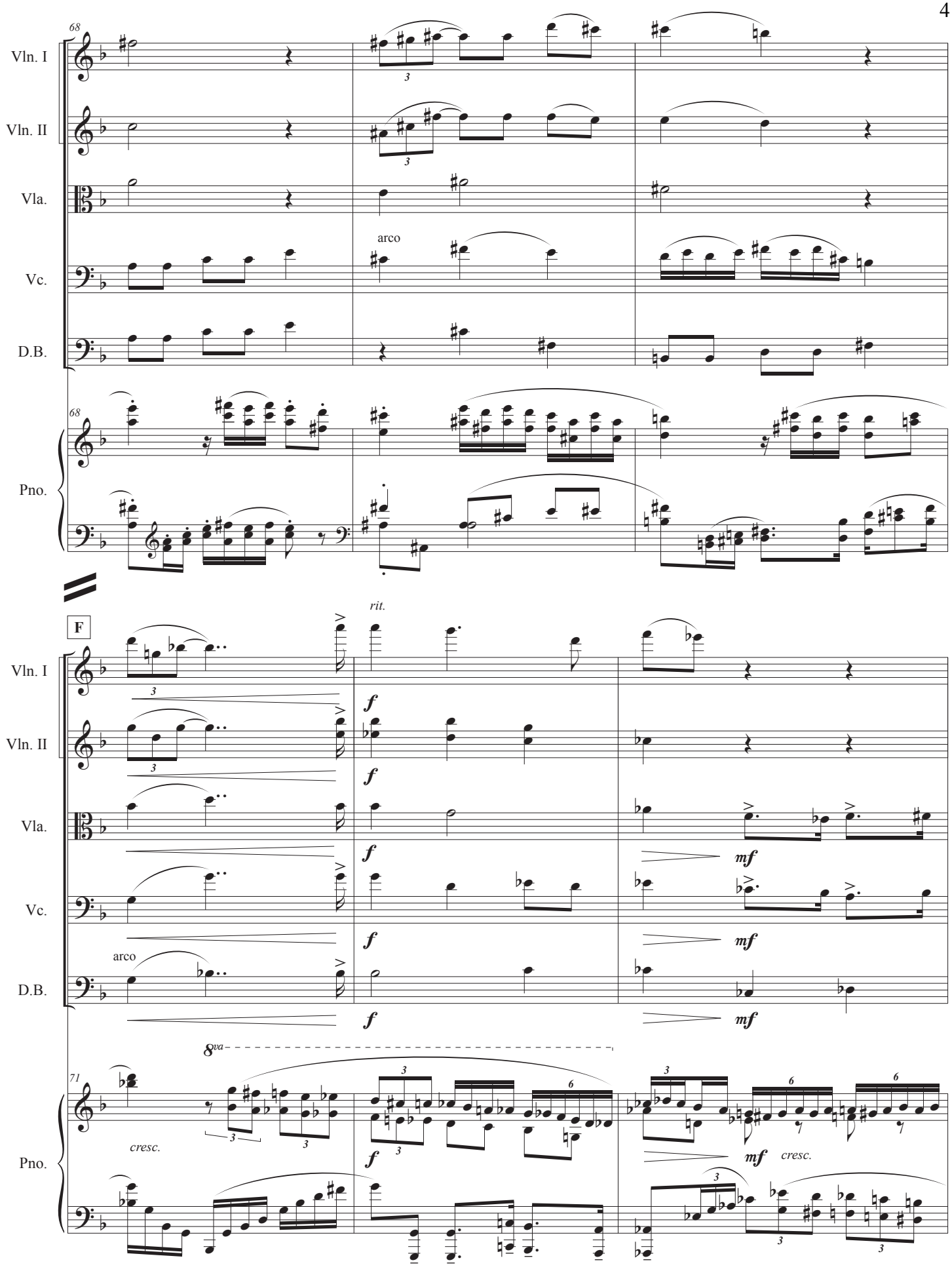
A *con morbidezza, a poco a poco emergendo*
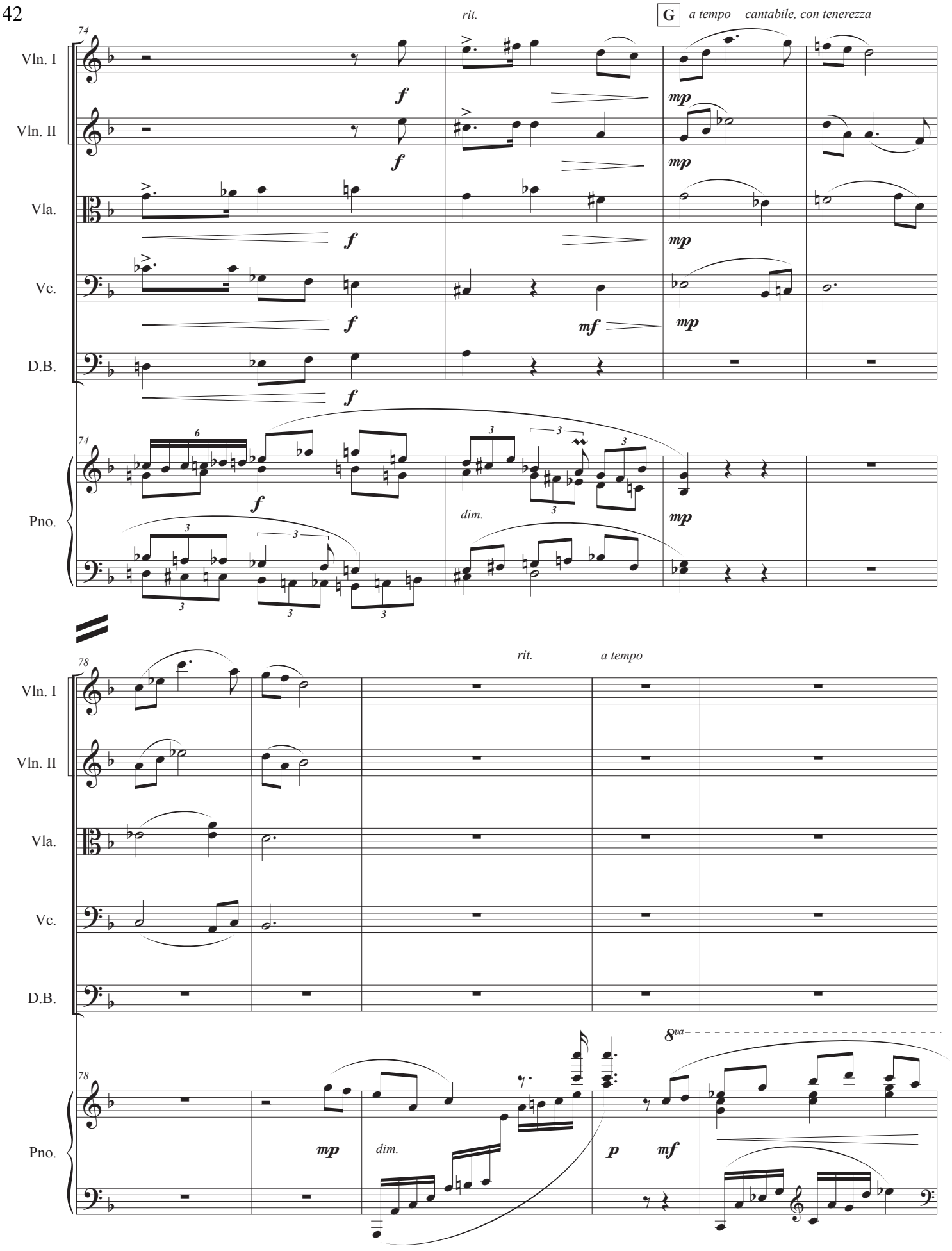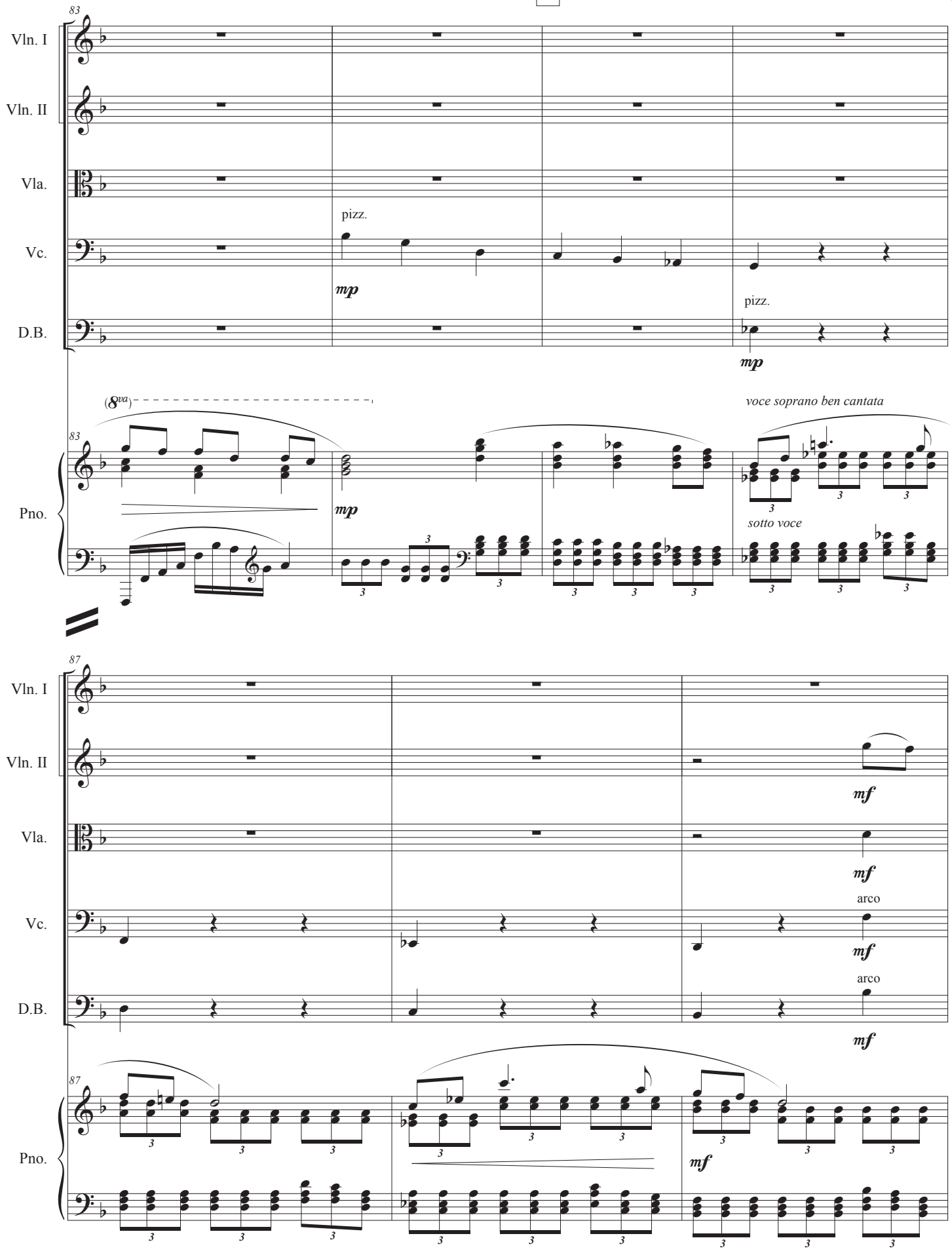



B
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
47
8va
51
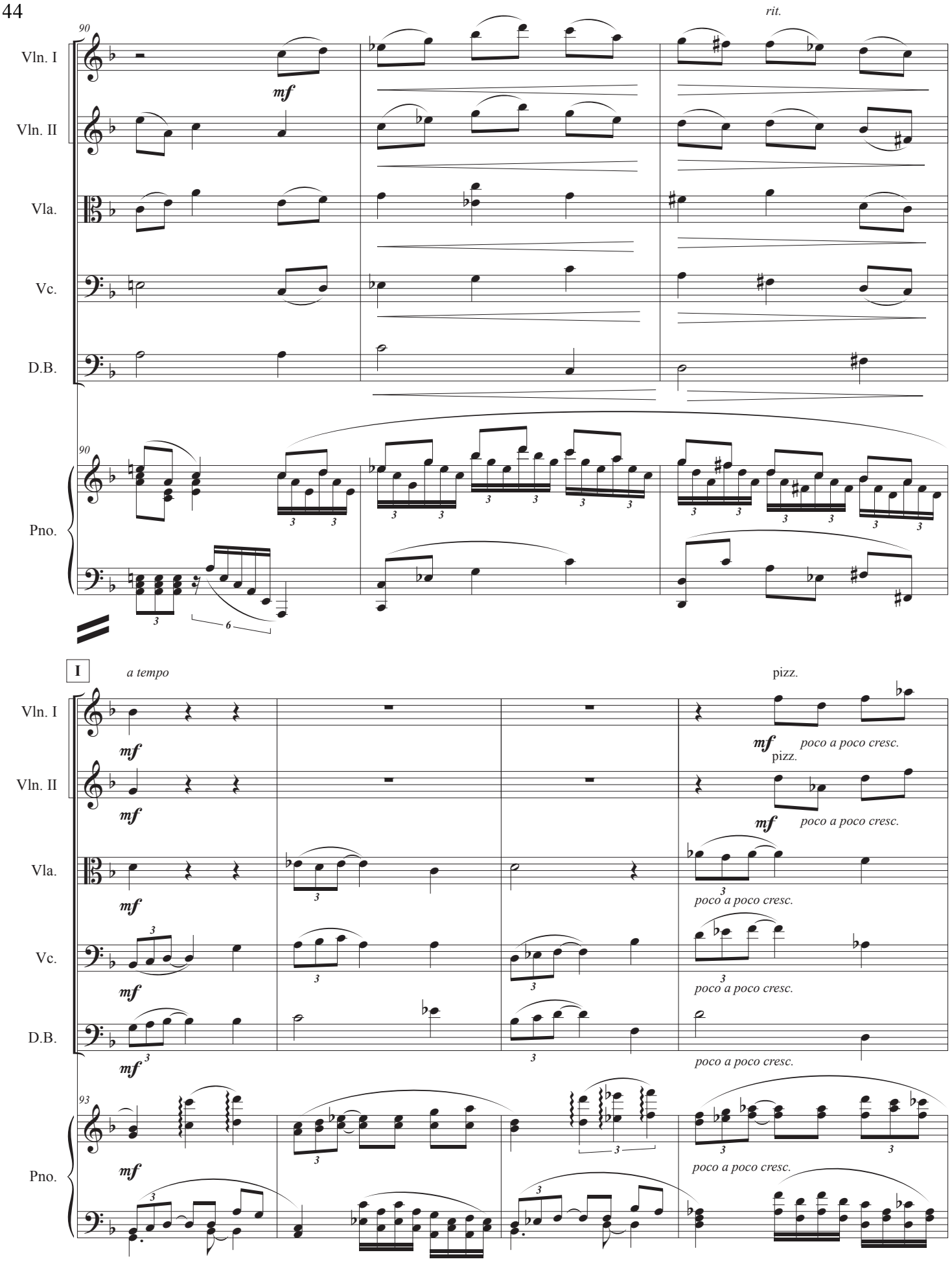

rit.
C
più vivo, con moto ♩= 72
54
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
pizz.
mf
pizz.
mf
54
3
mf
D
agitato
57
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
mf
mf
arco
mf
pizz.
57
3
3
3
8va
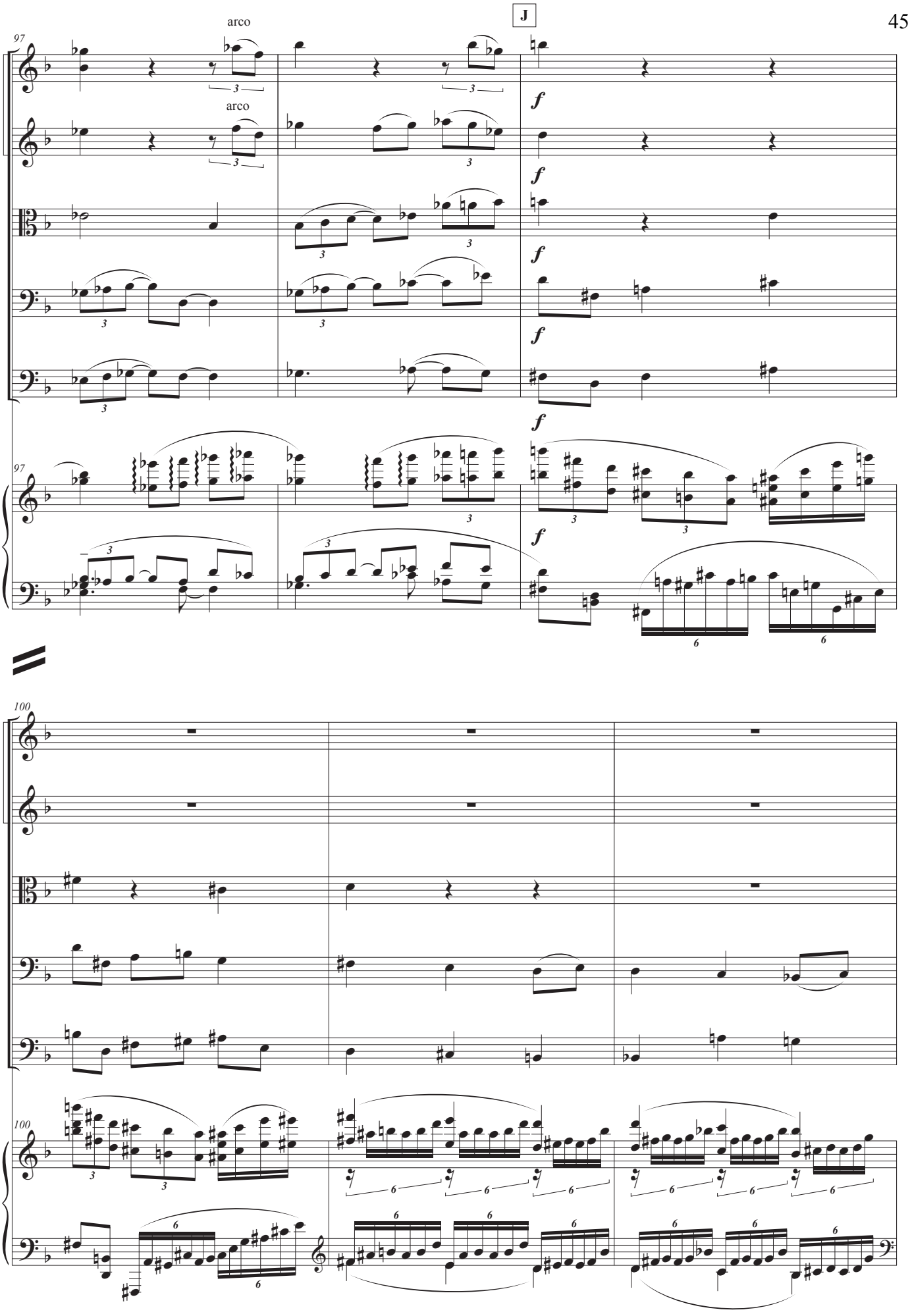

60
Vln. I
Vln. II
arco
Vla.
Vc.
arco
D.B.
pizz.
pizz.
(8va)
8va
Pno.
cresc.
più vivo, giocoso
E
64
pizz.
arco


68
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
arco
Pno.
F
rit.
f
mf
arco
8va
71
cresc.
cresc.
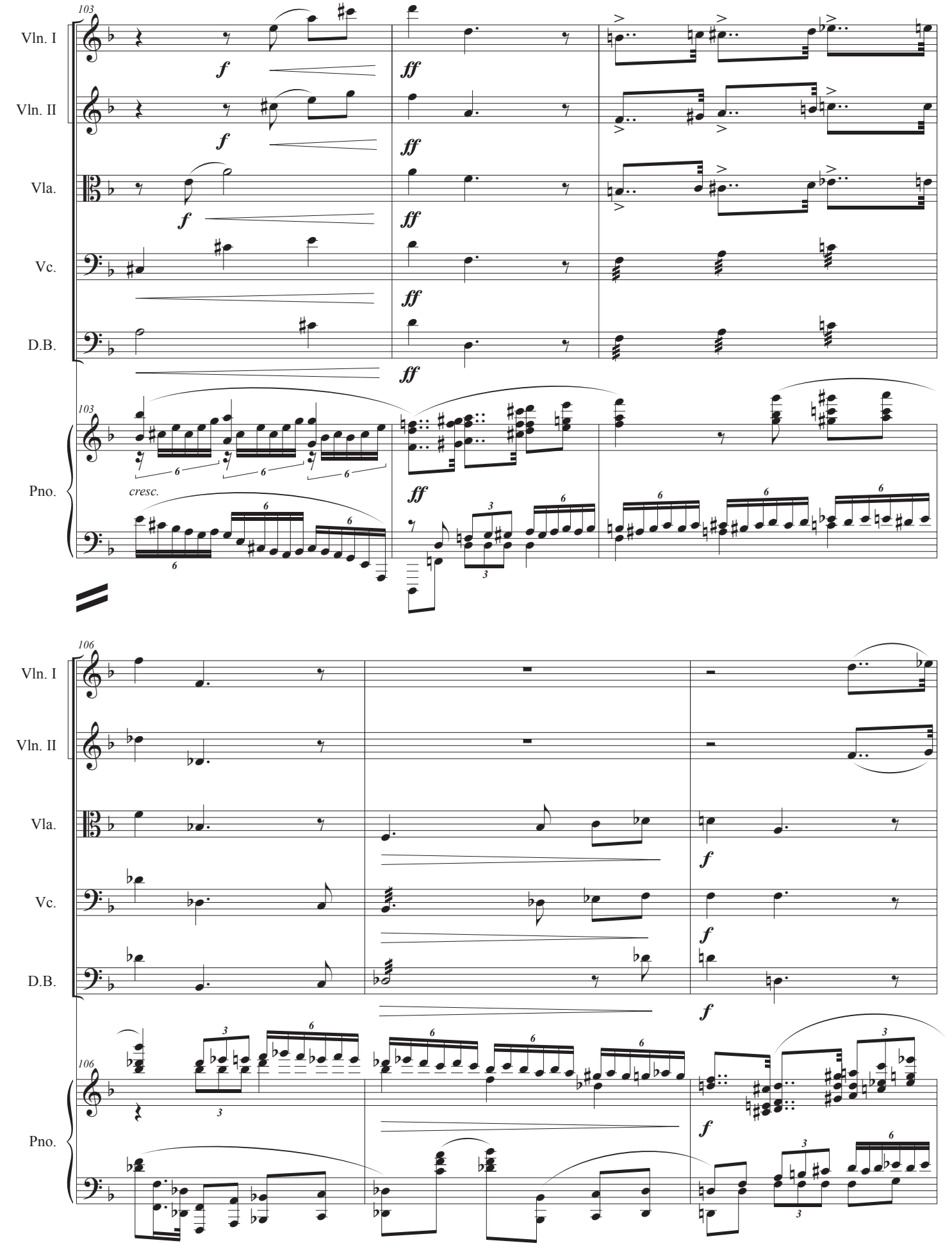

74
rit.
G
a tempo cantabile, con tenerezza
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
f
mp
mf
dim.
78
rit.
a tempo
8va
p
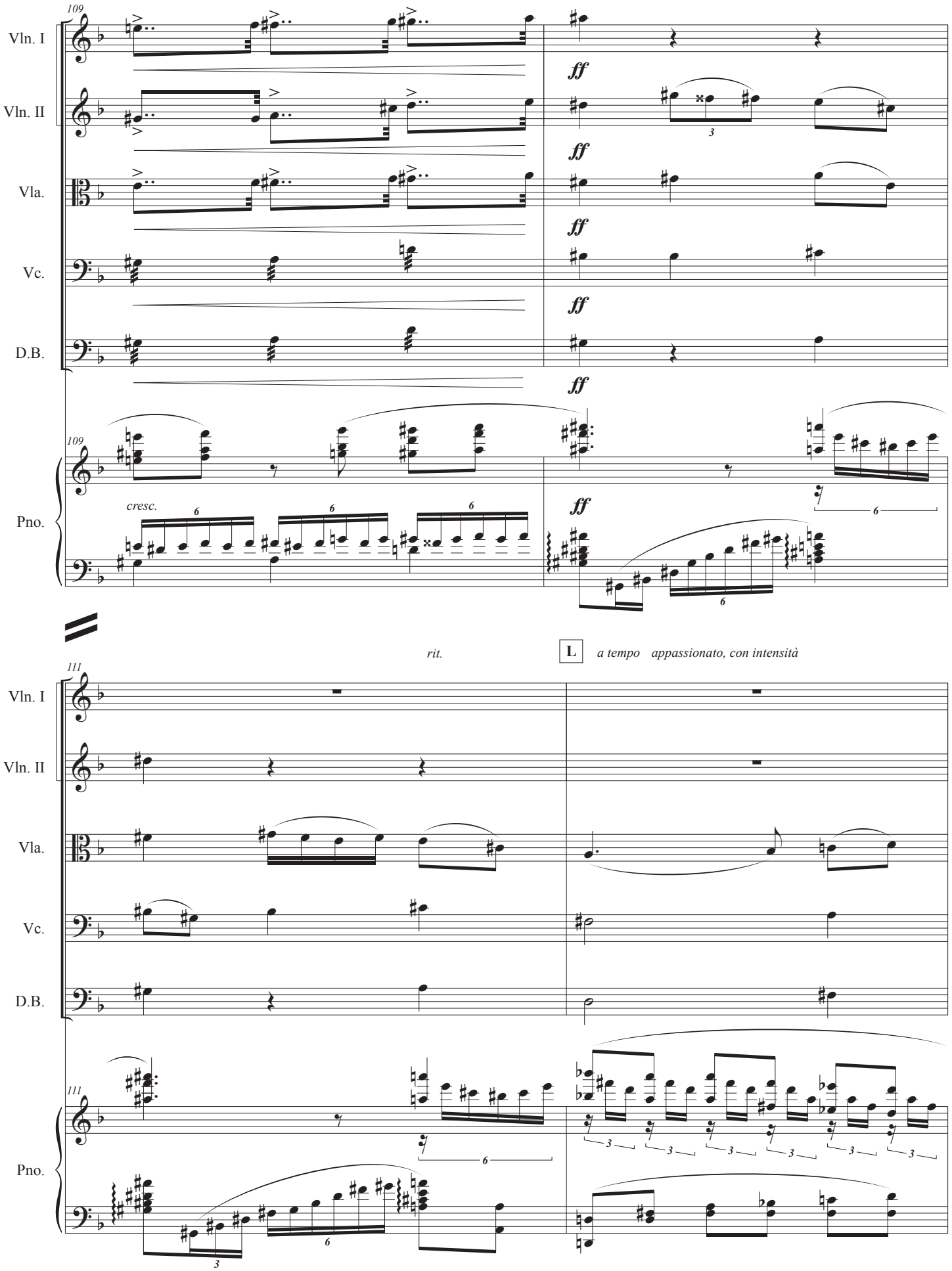

83
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
pizz.
mp
pizz.
mp
(8va)
voce soprano ben cantata
Pno.
mp
sotto voce
87
mf
mf
arco
mf
arco
mf
mf
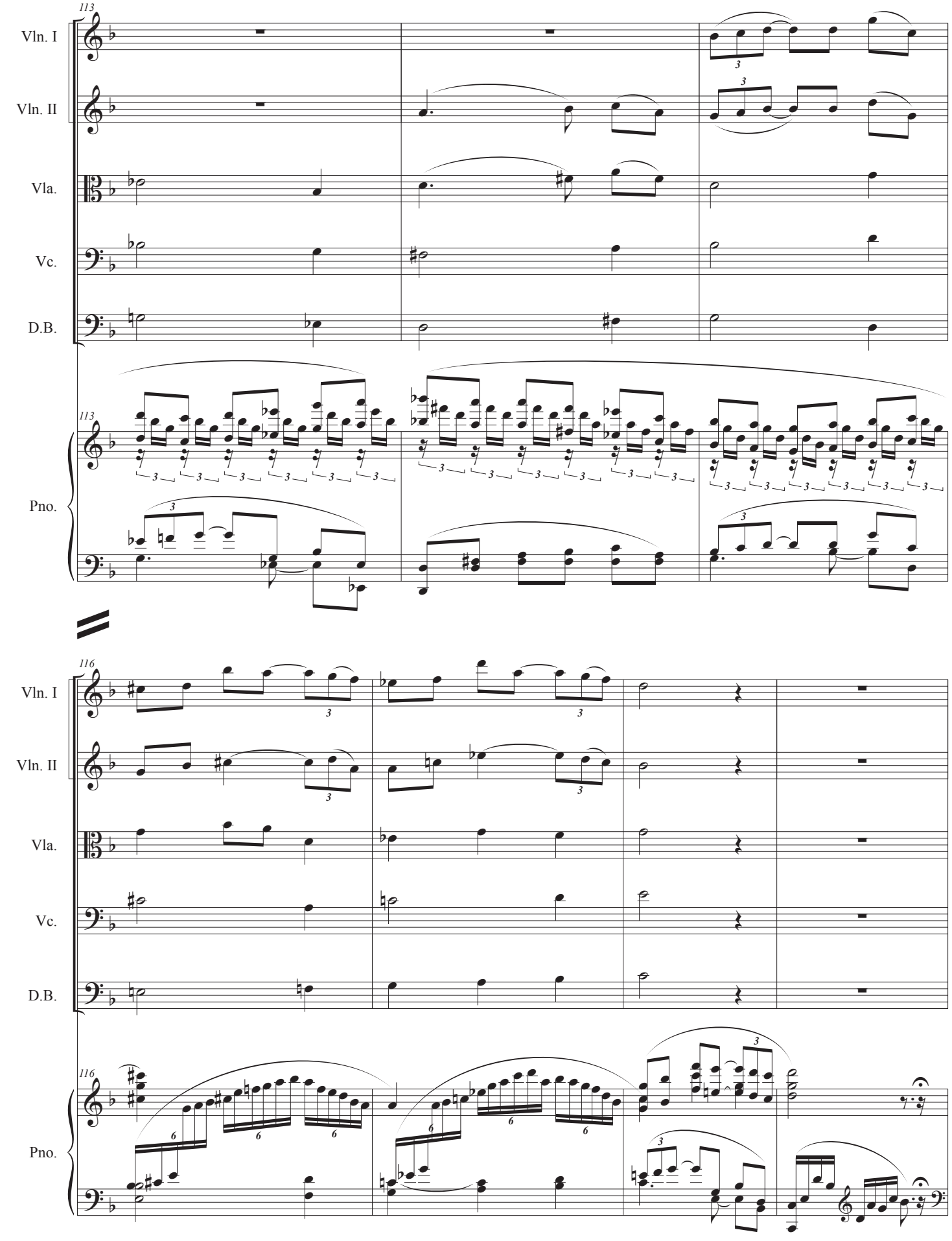

rit.
90
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
mf
I
a tempo
pizz.
poco a poco cresc.
93
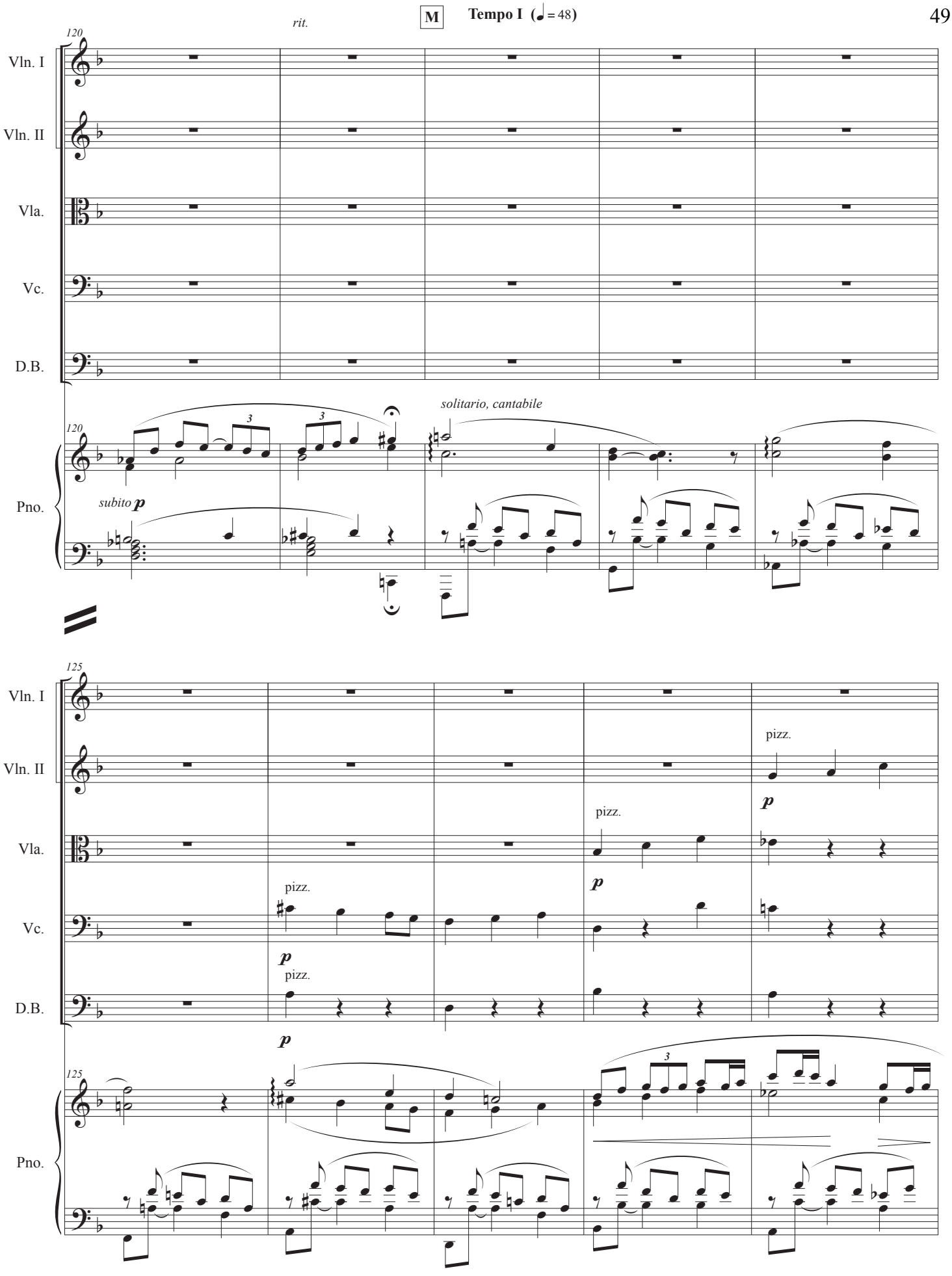

J
arco
arco
97
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
f
100

K *grandioso, ma non violento*




109
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
ff
109
Pno.
cresc.
6
rit.
L
a tempo appassionato, con intensità
111
3


113
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
113
Pno.
116
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
116
Pno.


rit.
M
Tempo I (♩= 48)
120
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
solitario, cantabile
subito p
125
pizz.
p

N

130

Vln. I

Vln. II

Vla.

Vc.

D.B.

Pno.

arco

mf
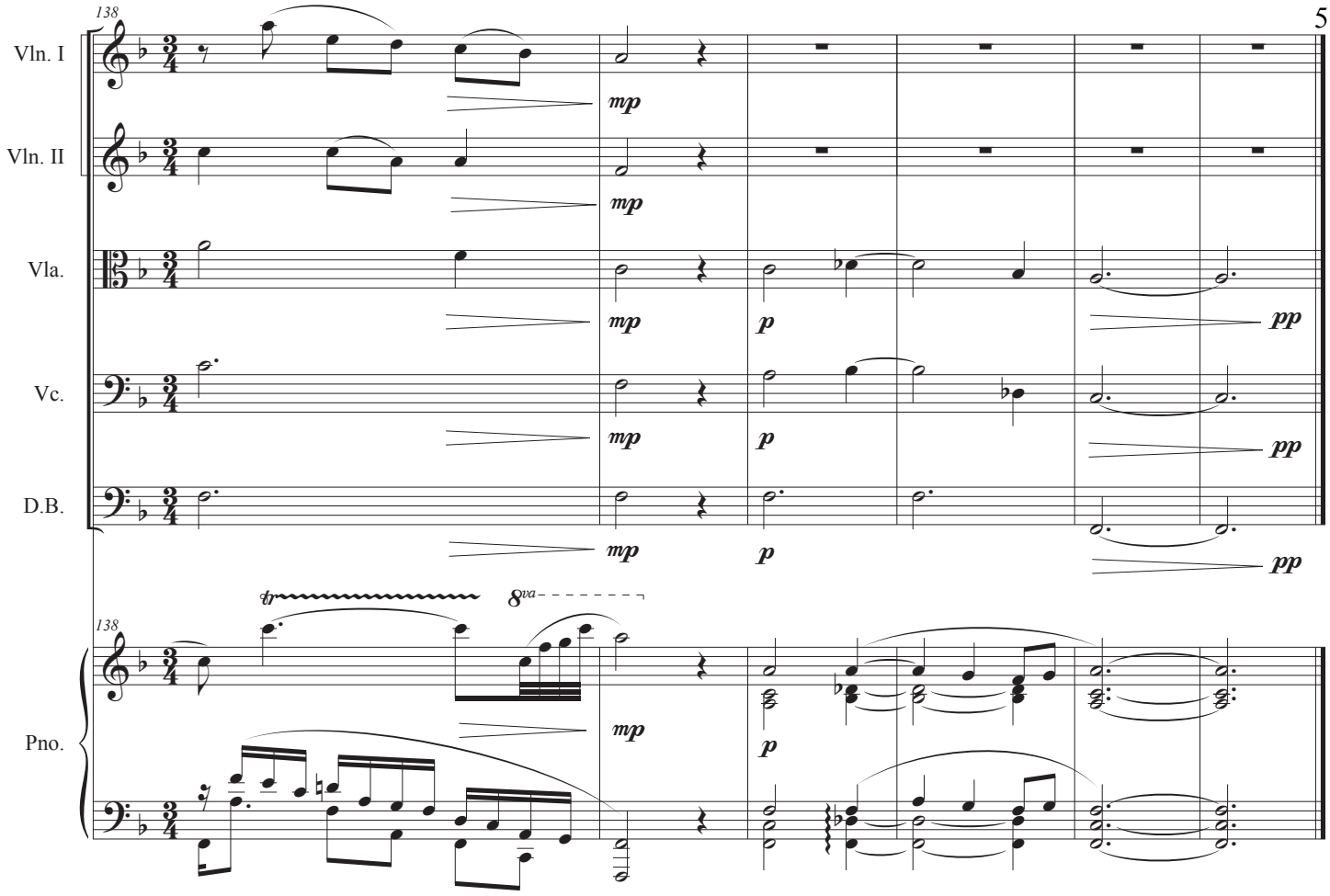
mp

cresc.

134
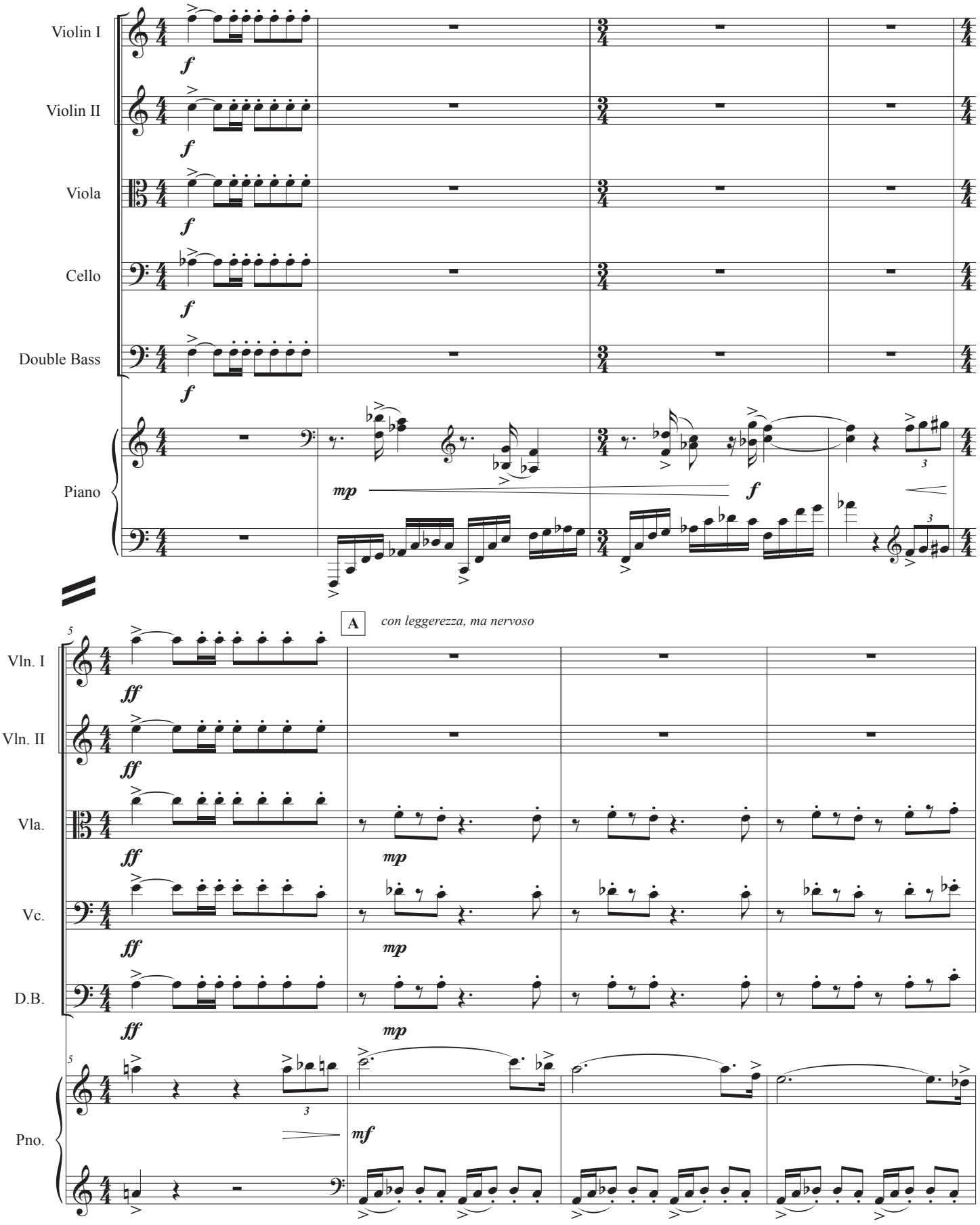
dolce.
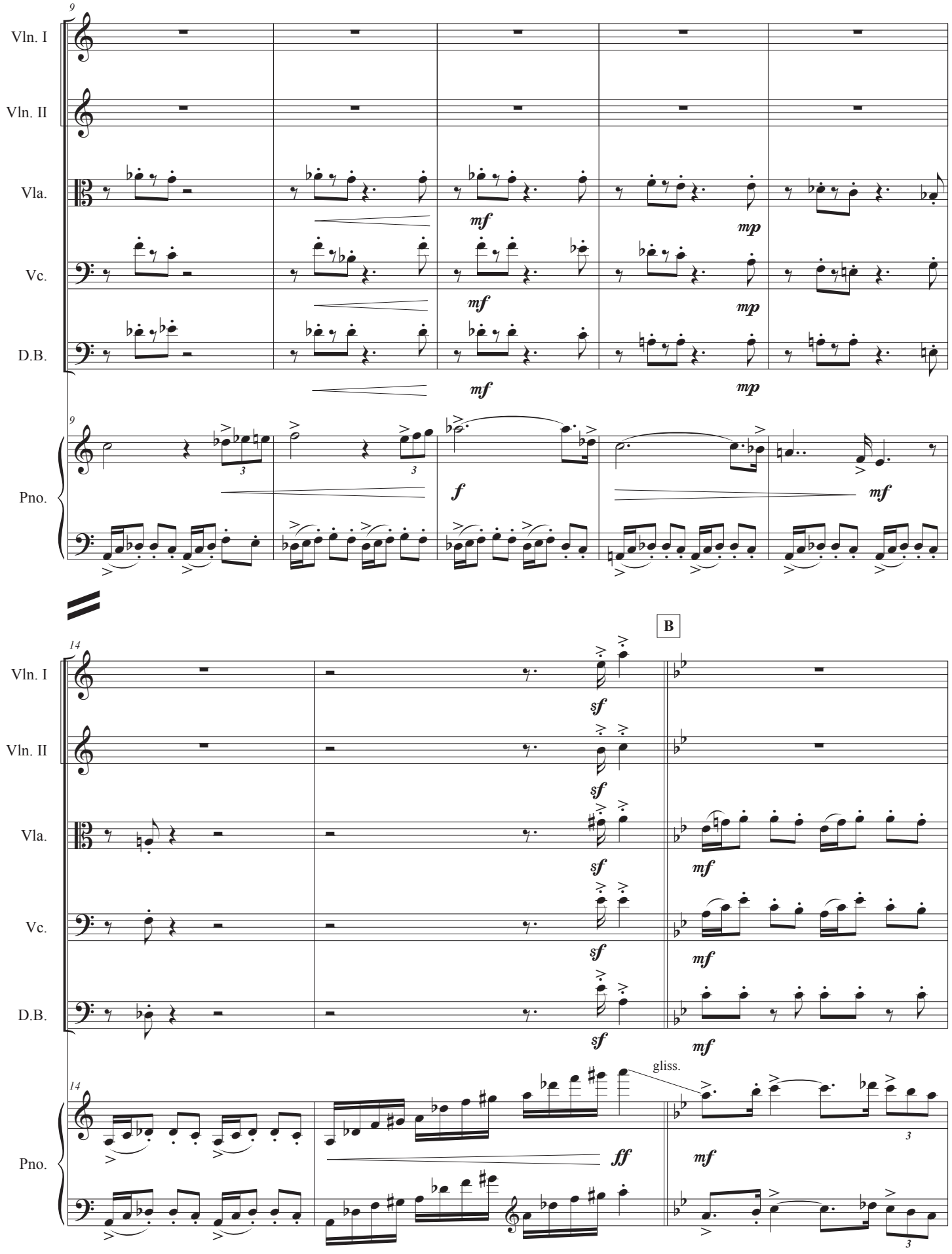
f
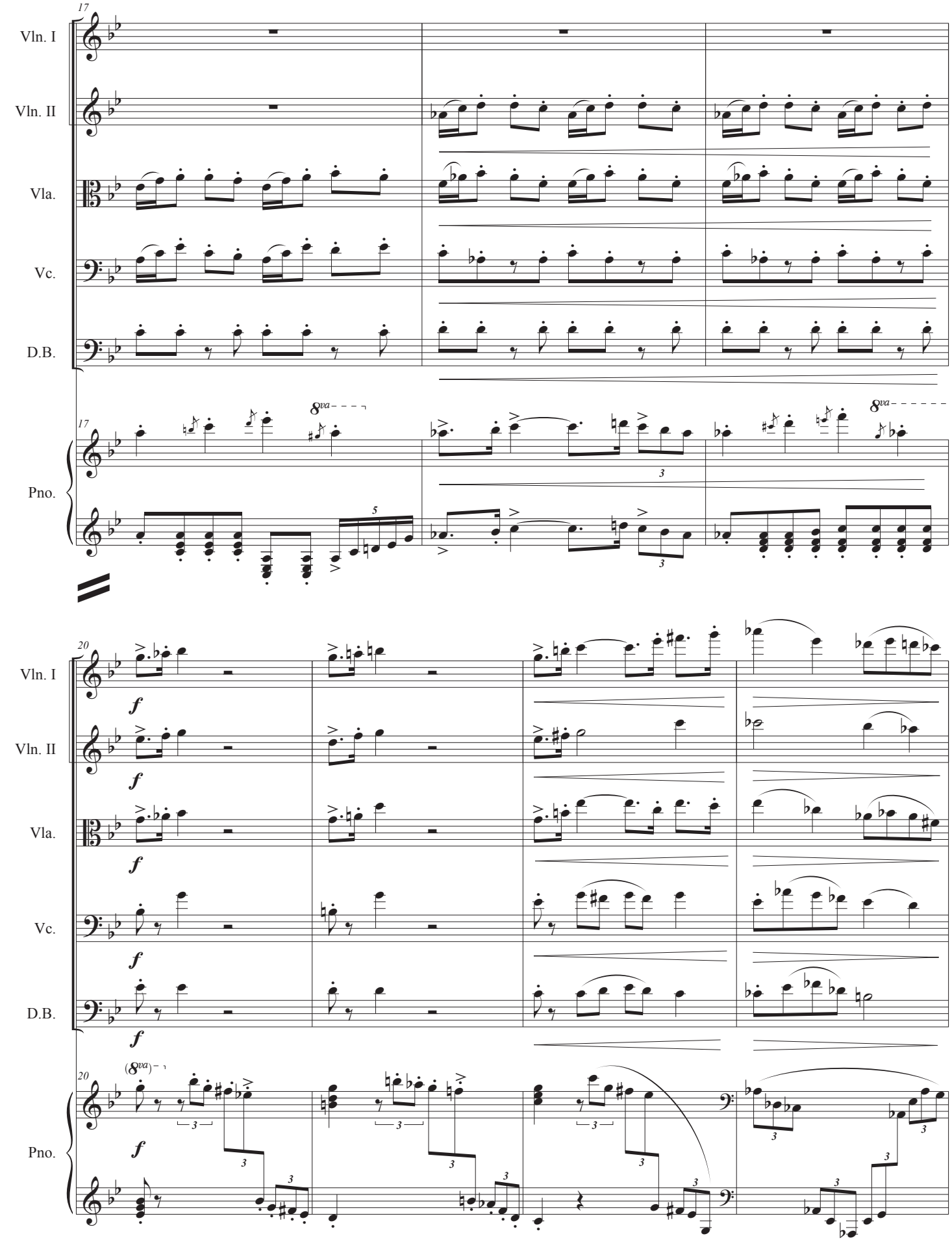

138
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
mp
p
pp
tr
8va
Pno.
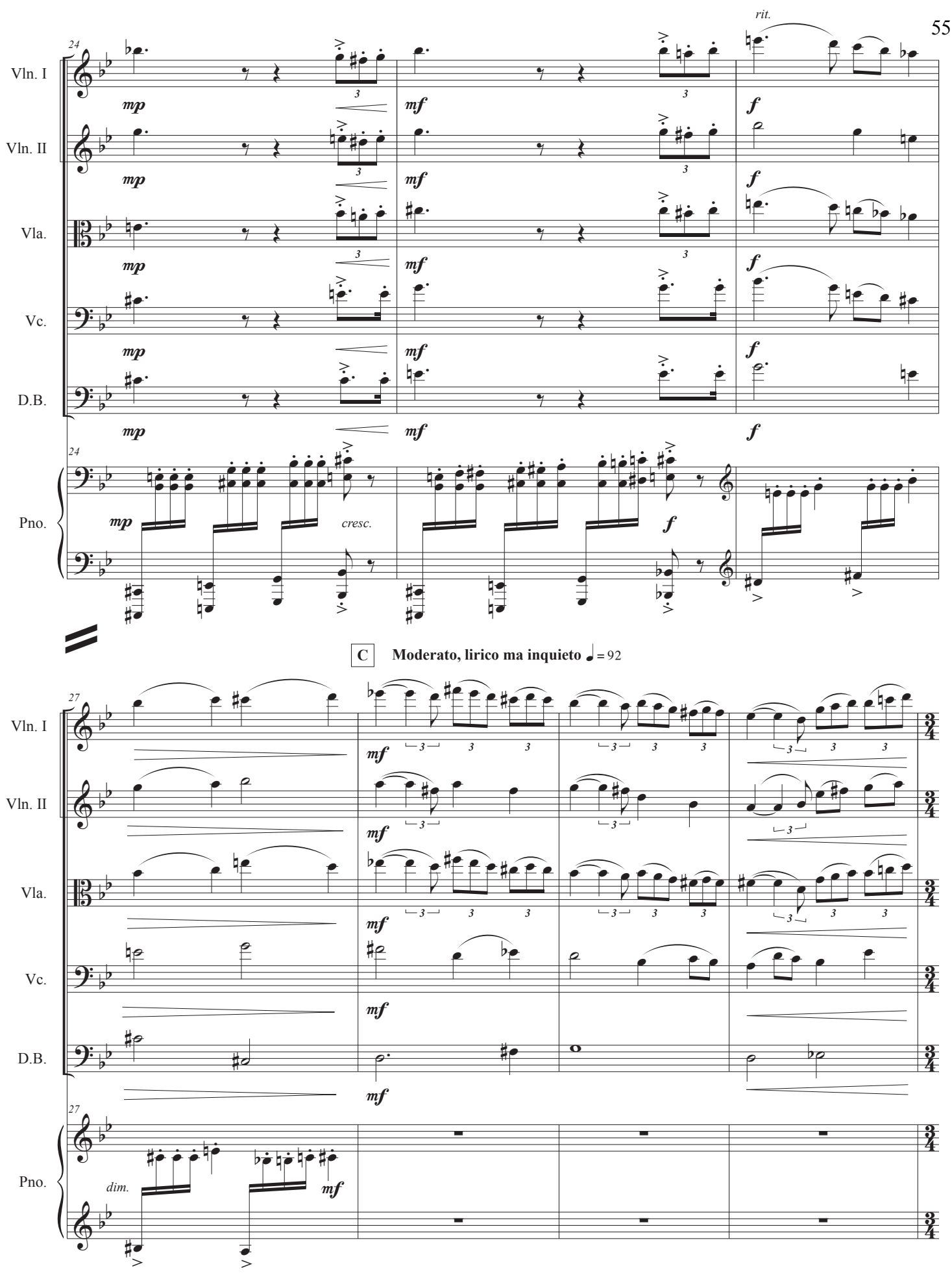
III
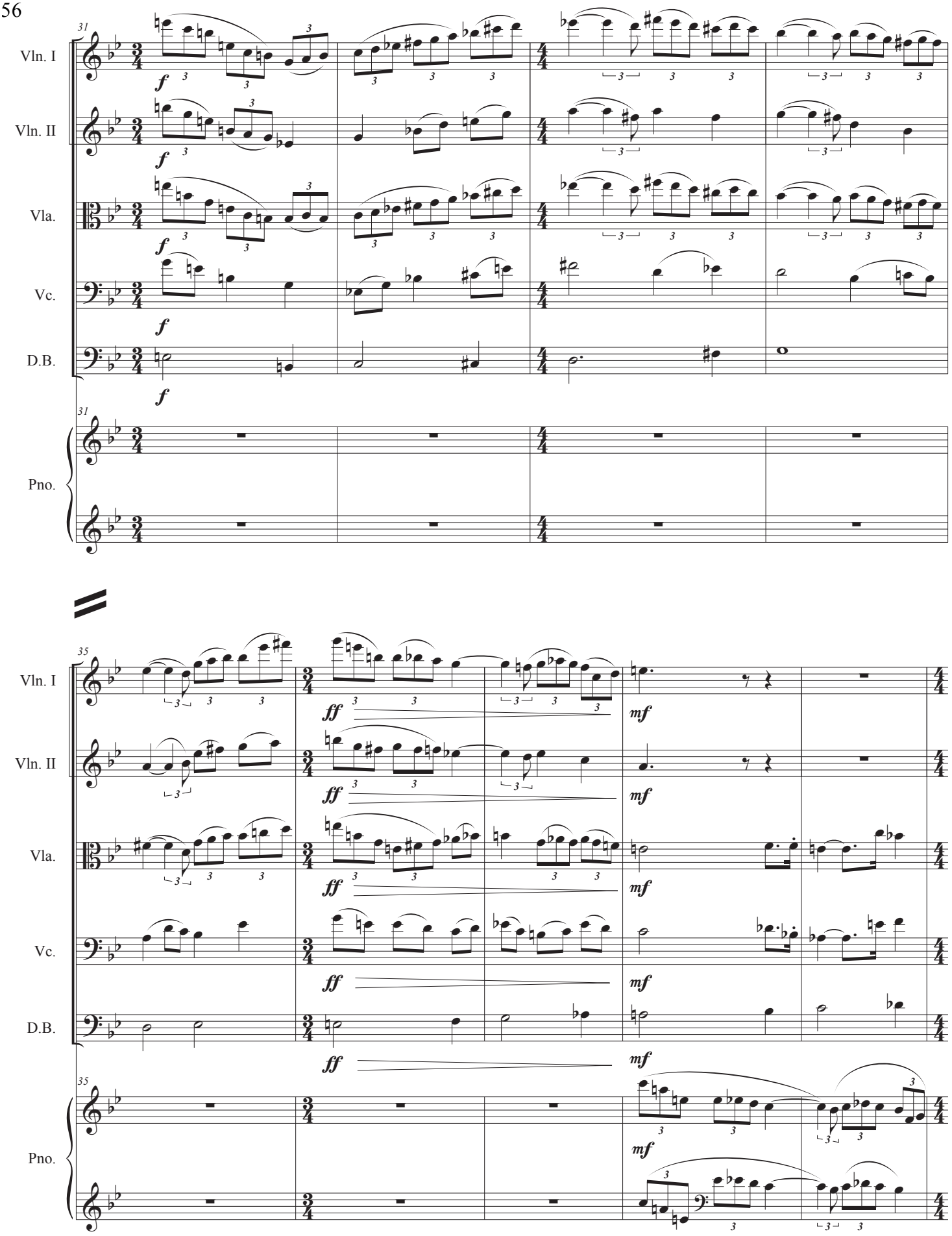
Allegro scherzando ♩ = 136
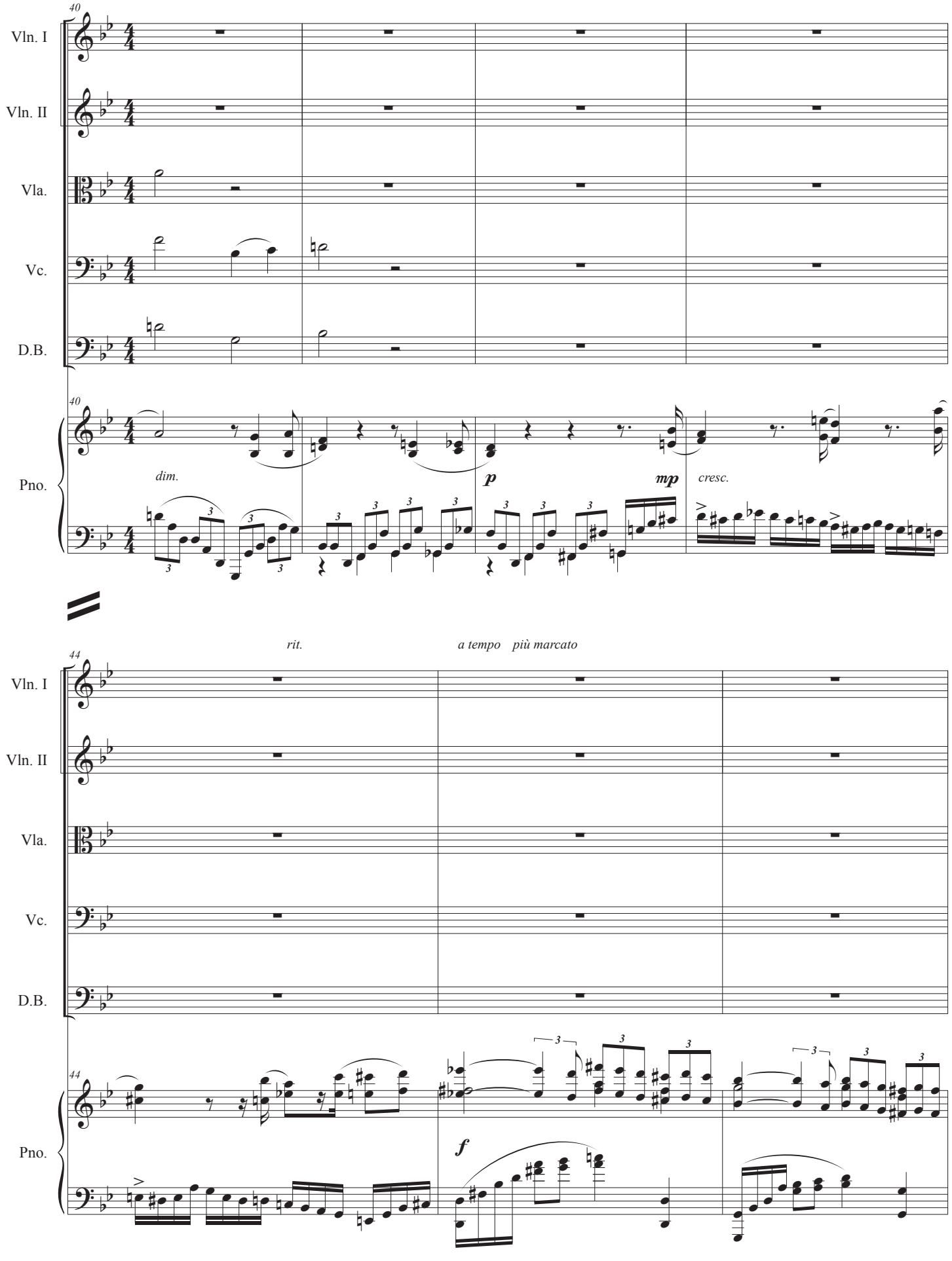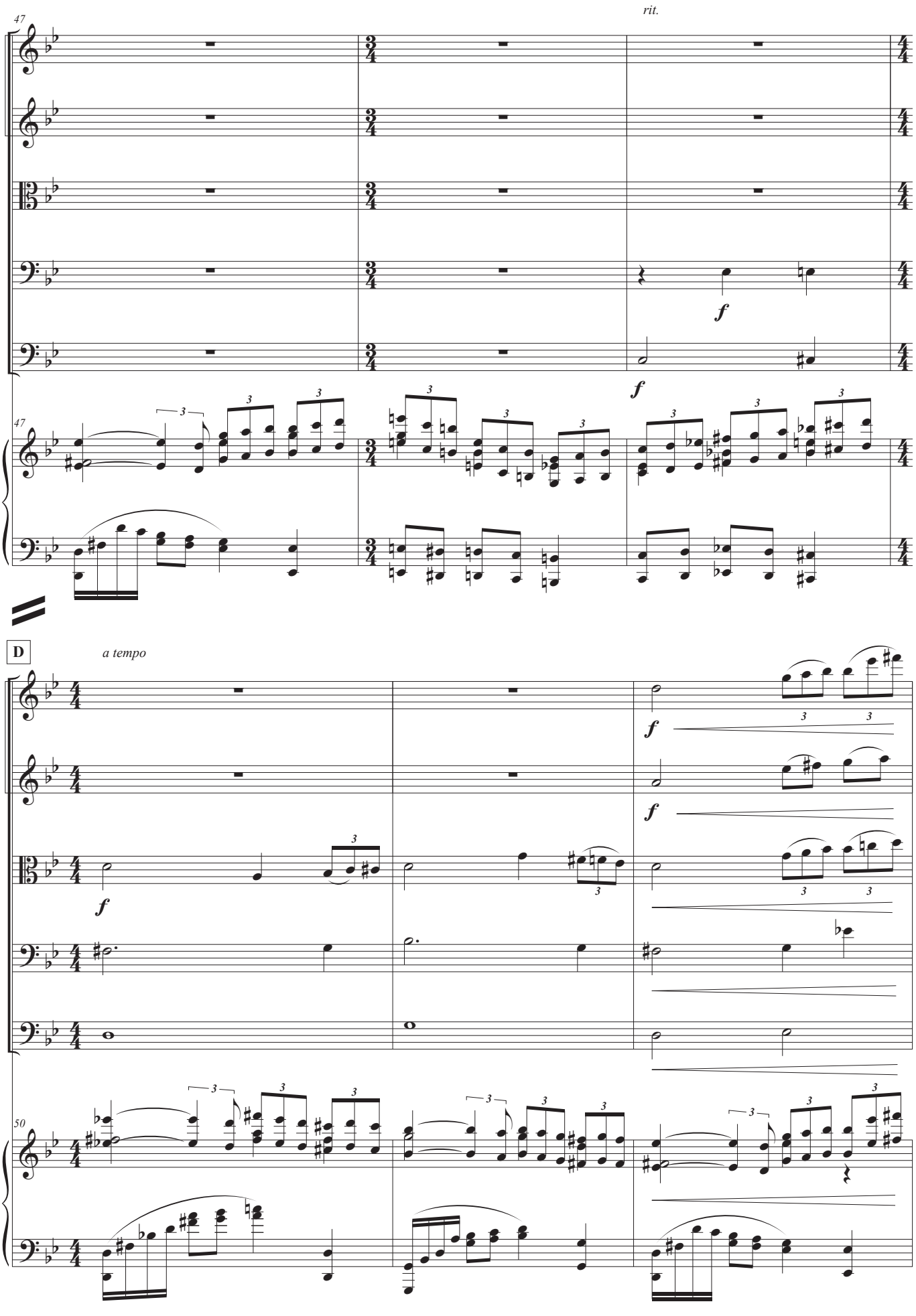



9
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
mf
mp
f
mf
B
14
sf
mf
ff
gliss.
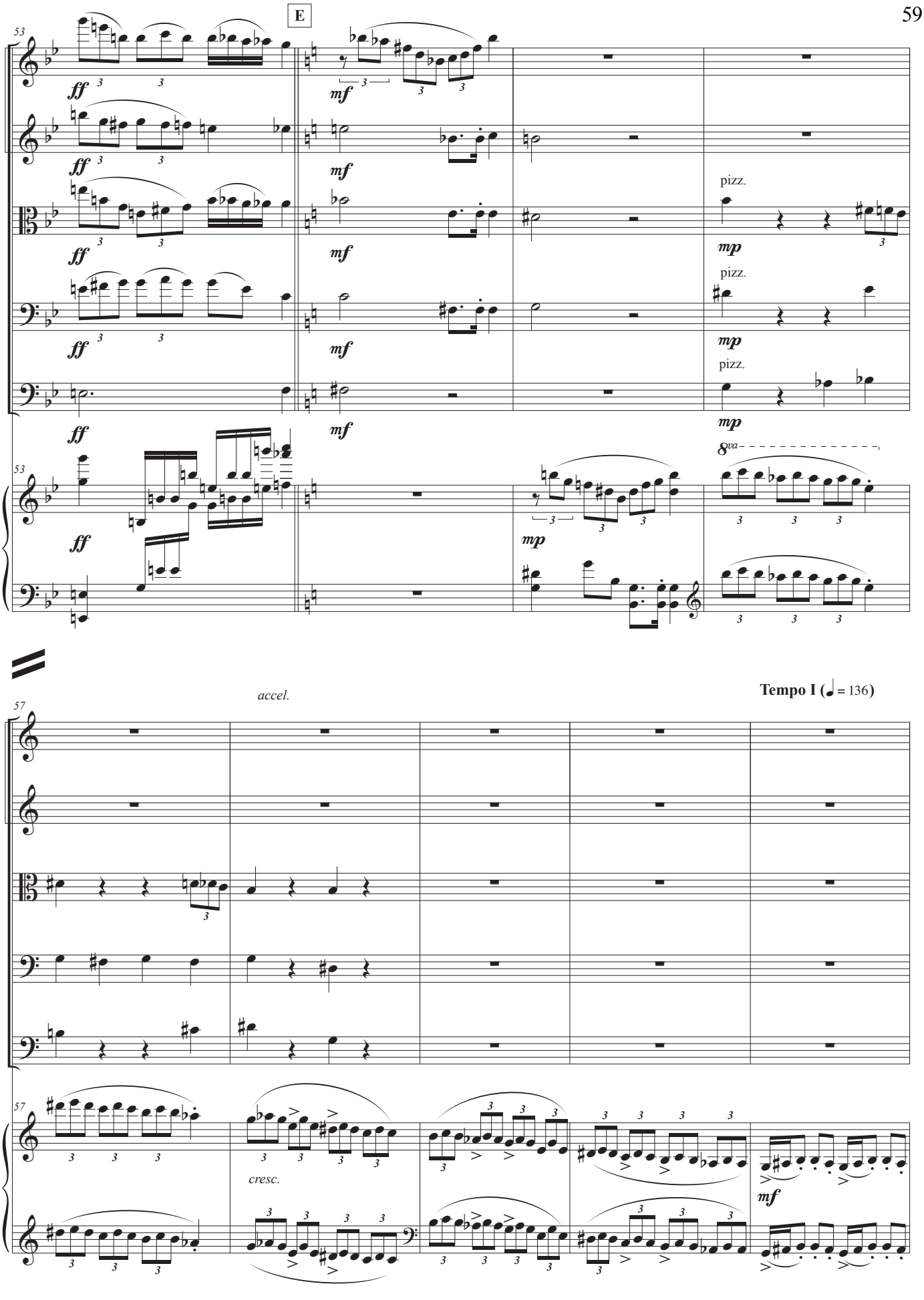

17
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
8va
20
f
(8va)
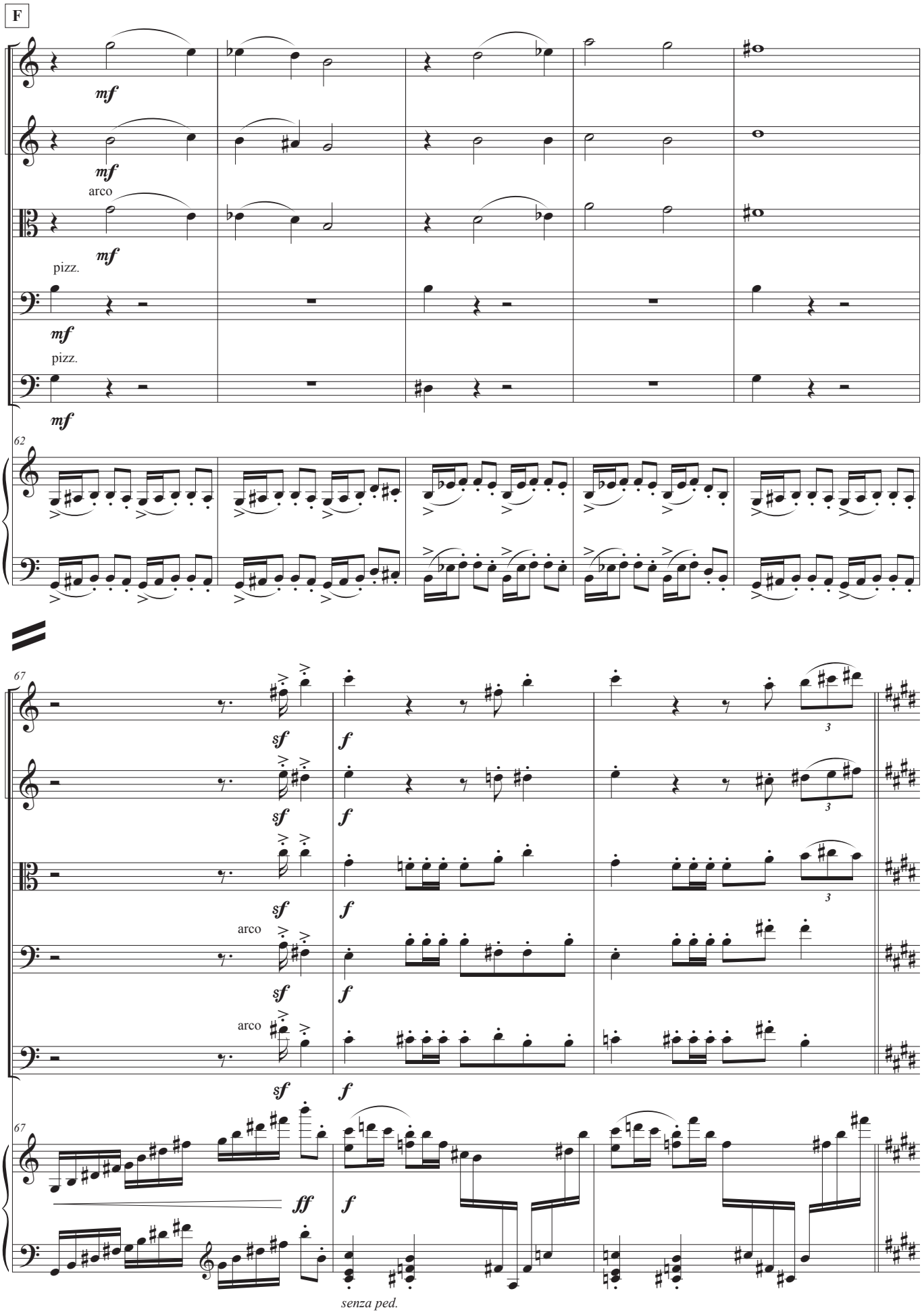

rit.
24
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
mp
mf
f
cresc.
C
Moderato, lirico ma inquieto ♩= 92
27
dim.
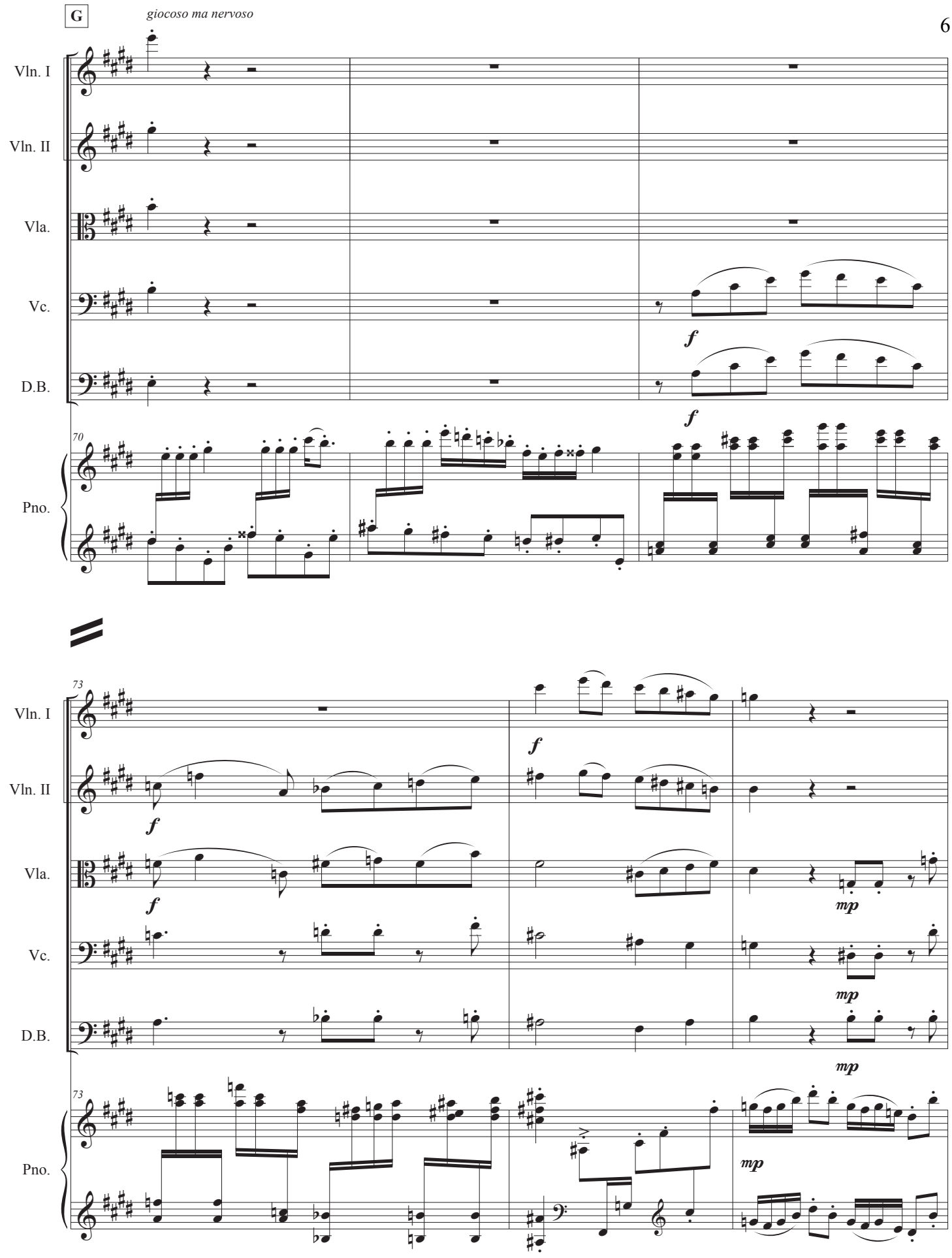

31
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
f
35
ff
mf
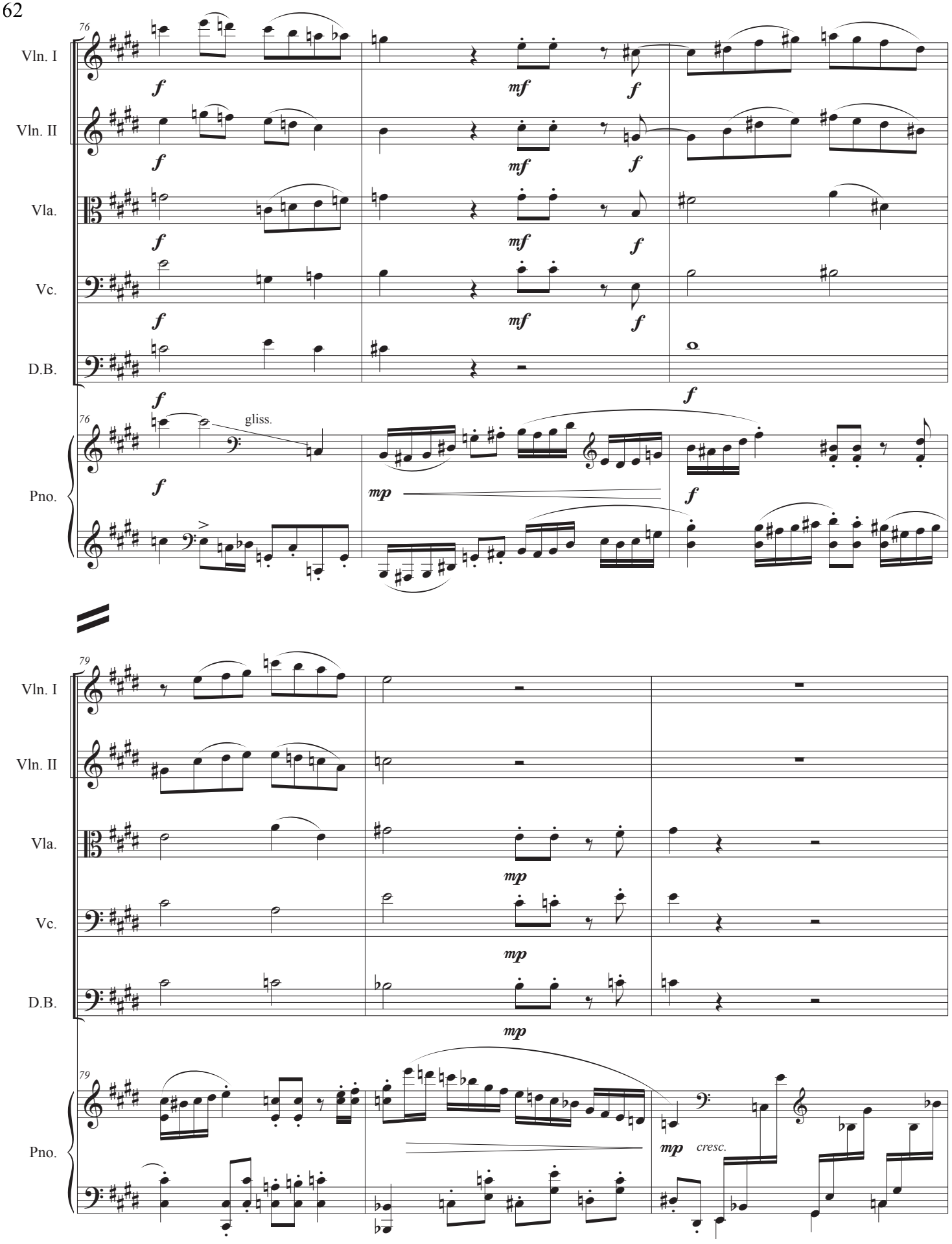

40
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
dim.
p
mp
cresc.
rit.
a tempo più marcato
44
f
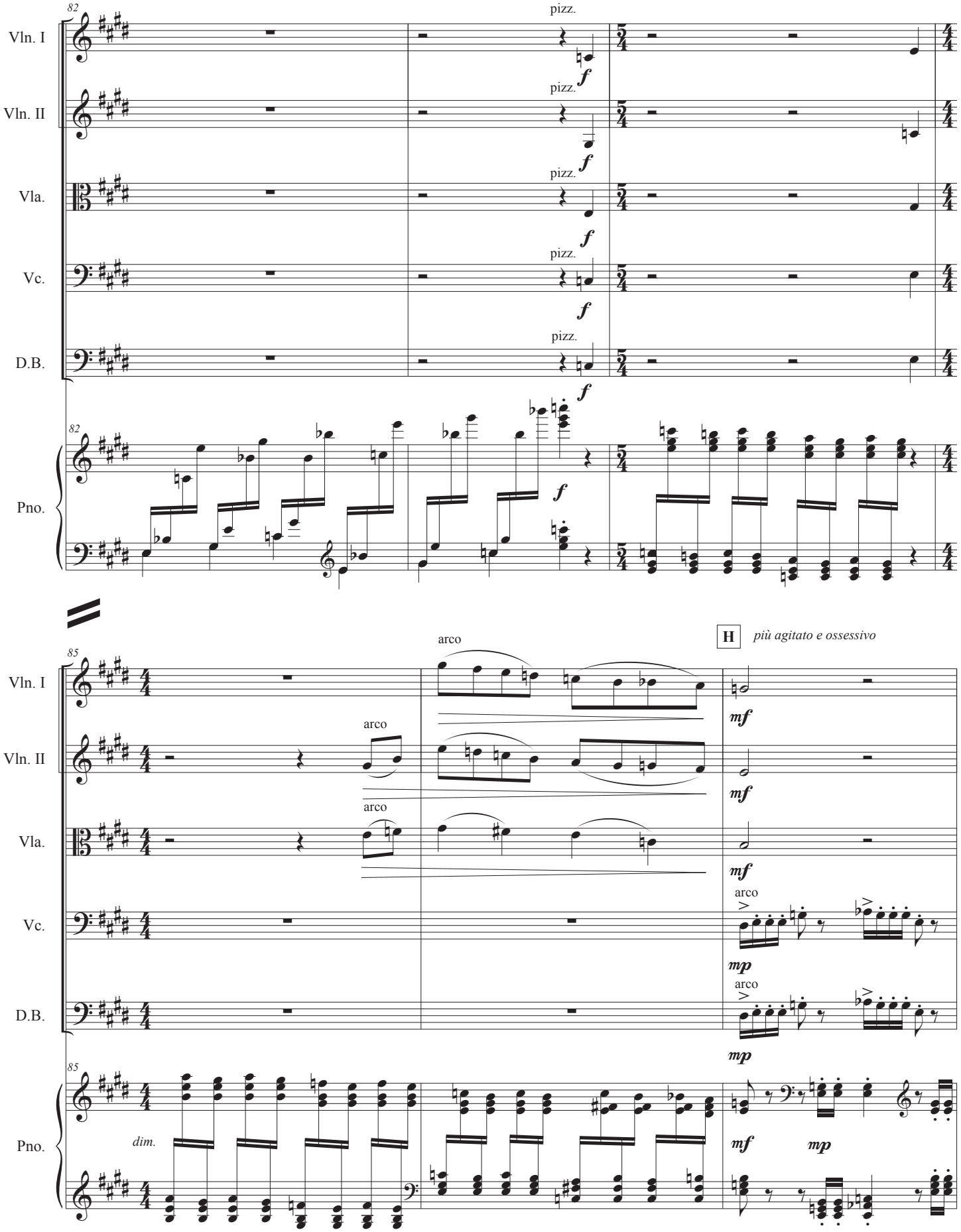

47
rit.
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
f
Pno.
D
a tempo
50
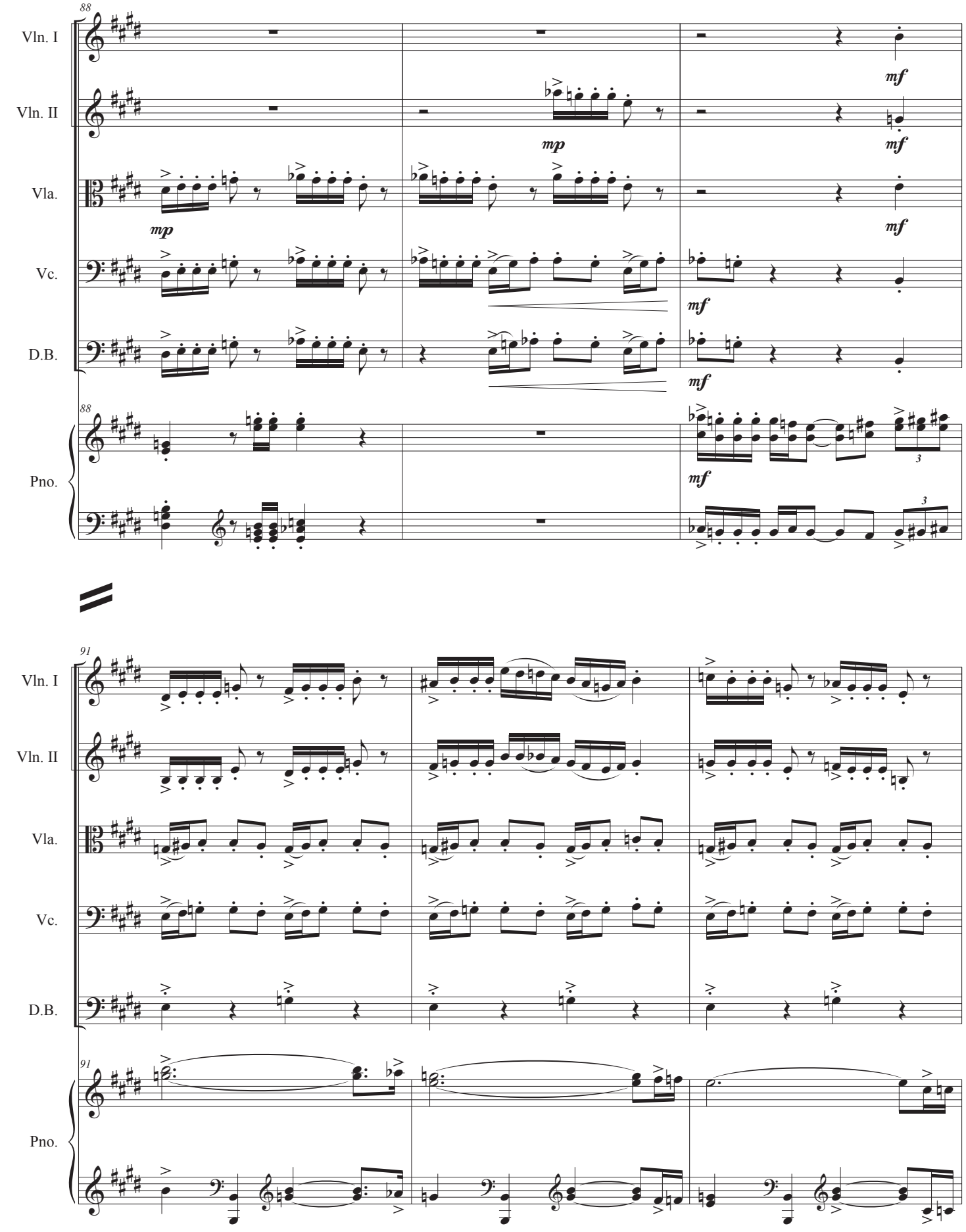

E
53
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
ff
mf
mp
pizz.
8va
accel.
Tempo I (♩ = 136)
57
cresc.


F
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
mf
arco
pizz.
62
67
sf
f
ff
3
senza ped.
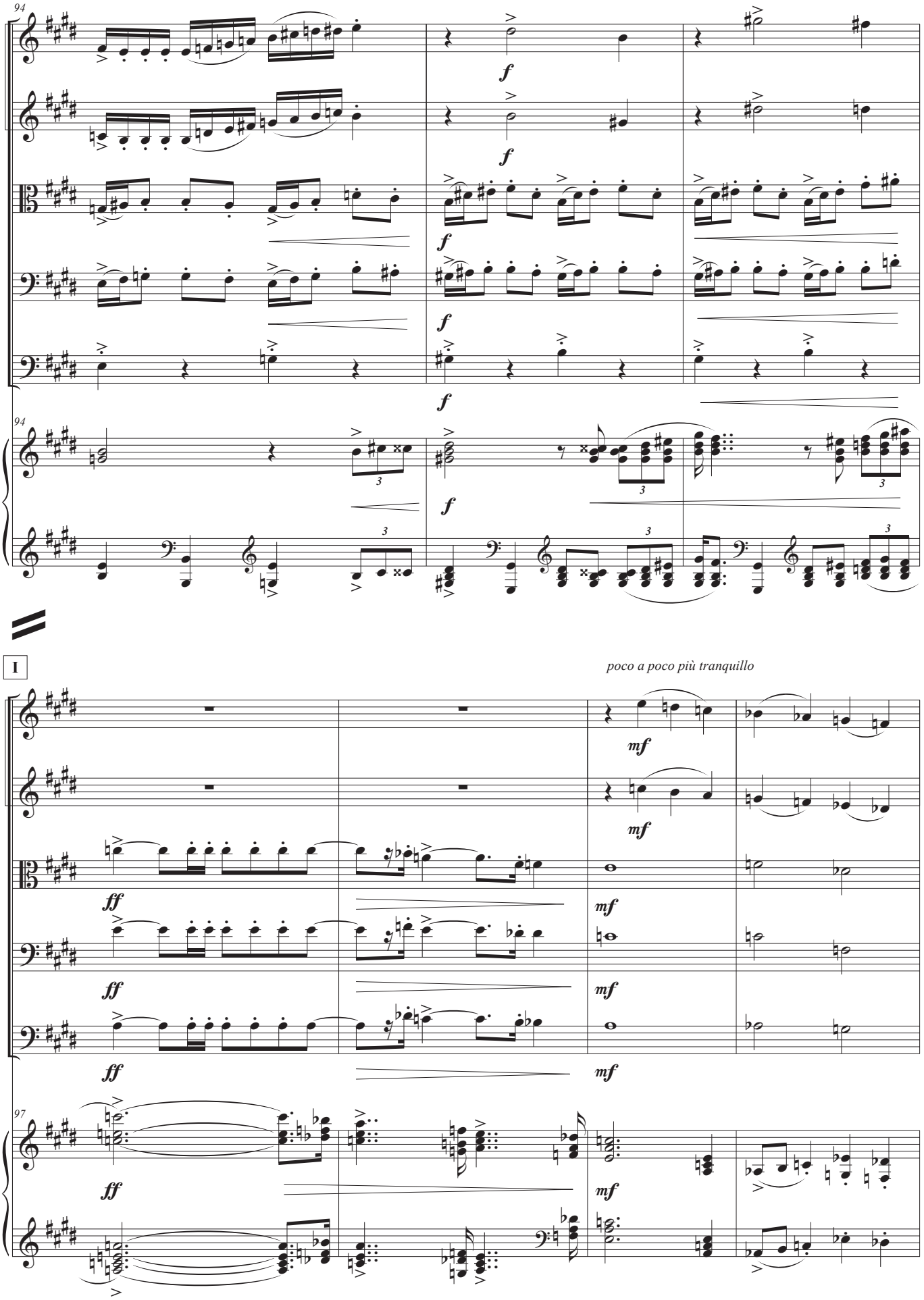

G
giocoso ma nervoso
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
70
f
f
73
f
f
f
mp
mp
mp
mp
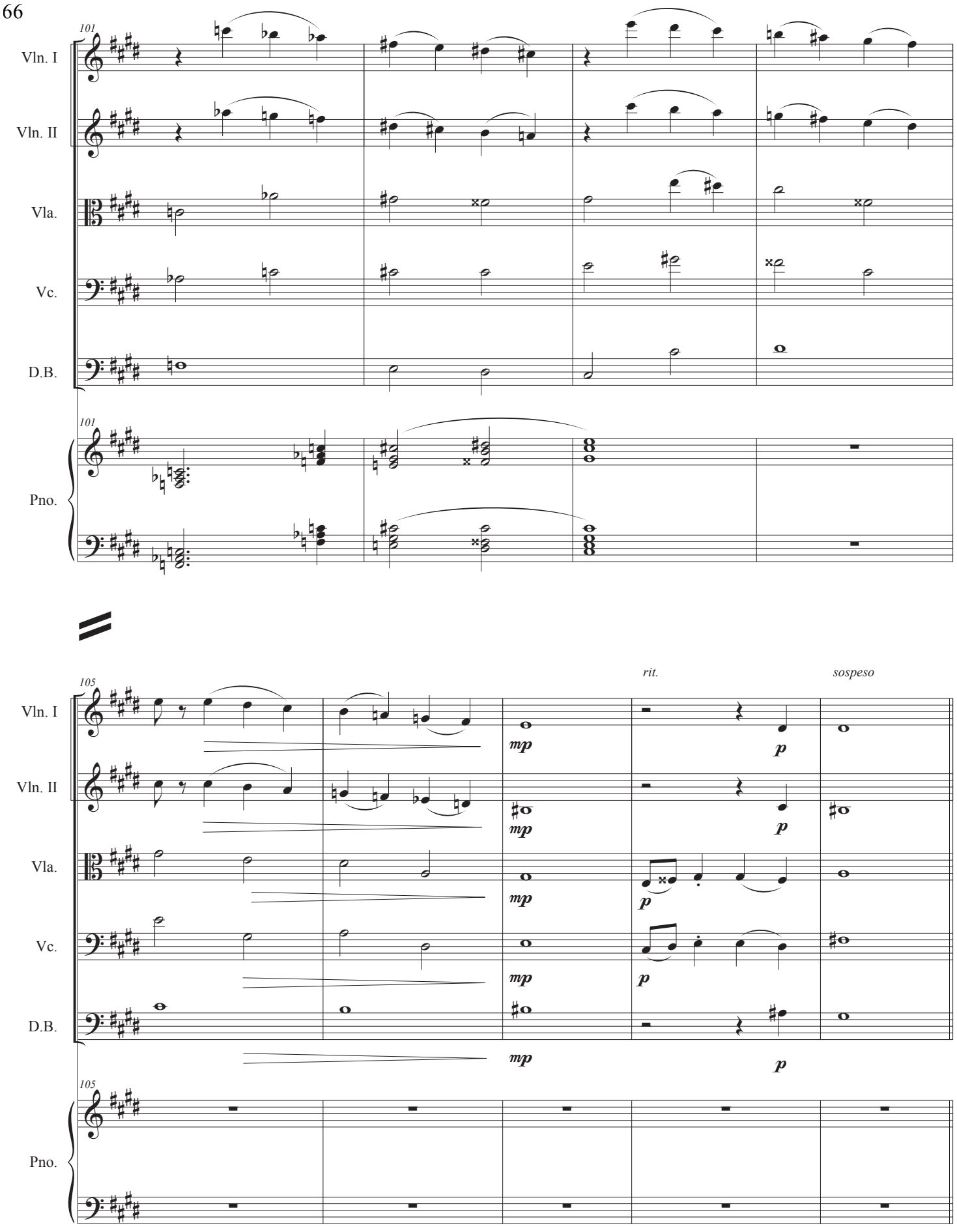

76
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
f
mf
gliss.
mp
79
cresc.
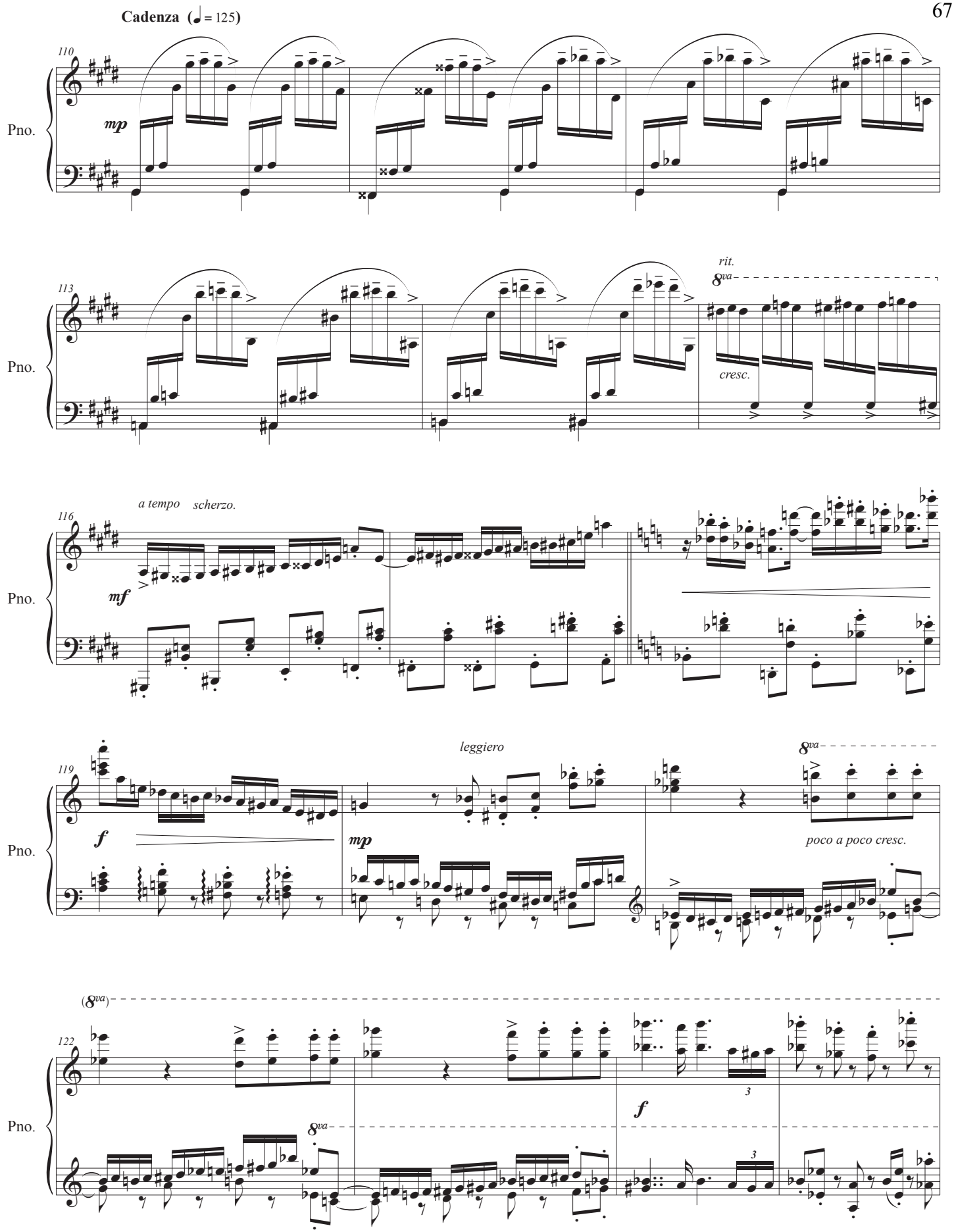

82
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
pizz.
f
85
arco
H
più agitato e ossessivo
mf
mp
dim.
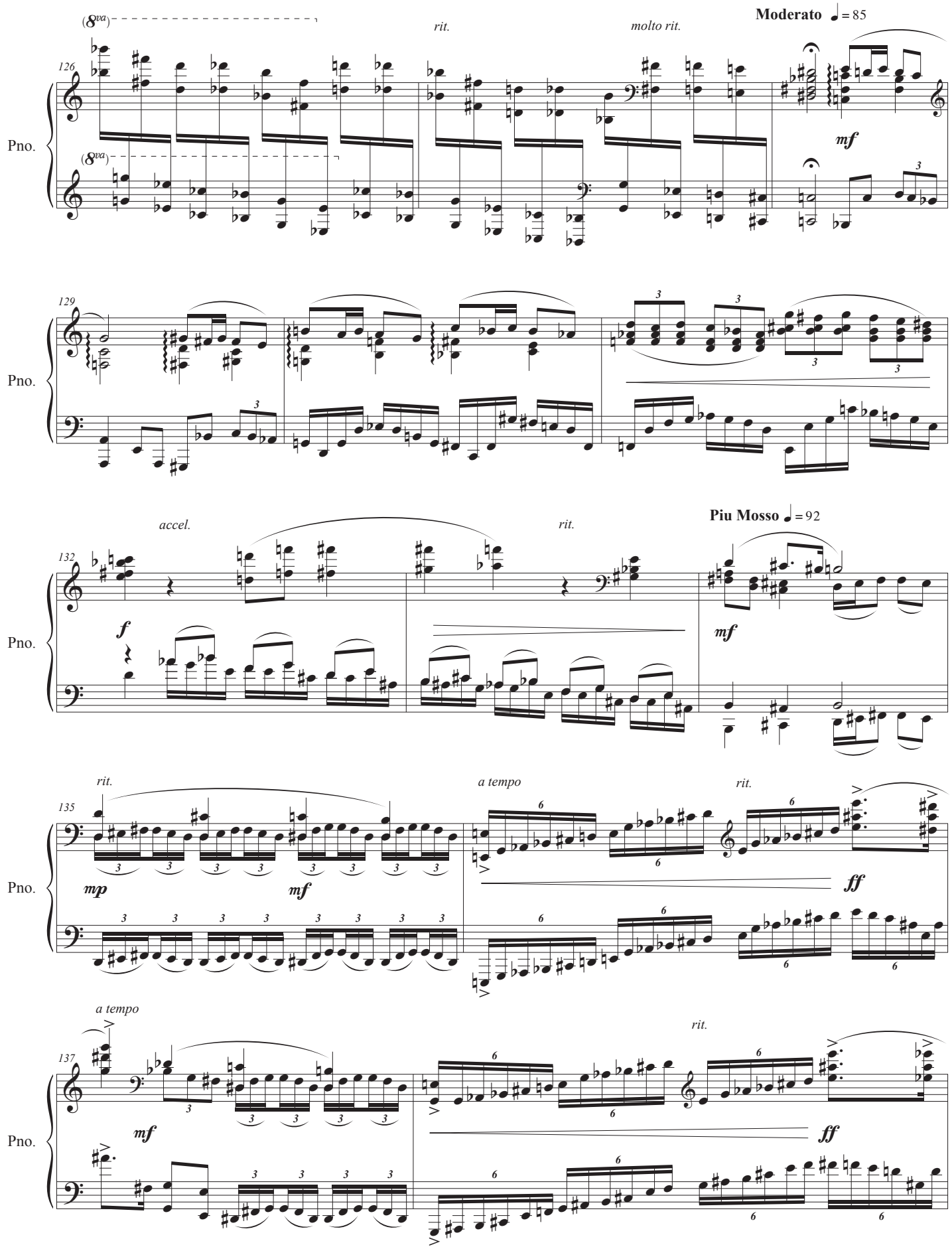

88
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
mp
mf
3
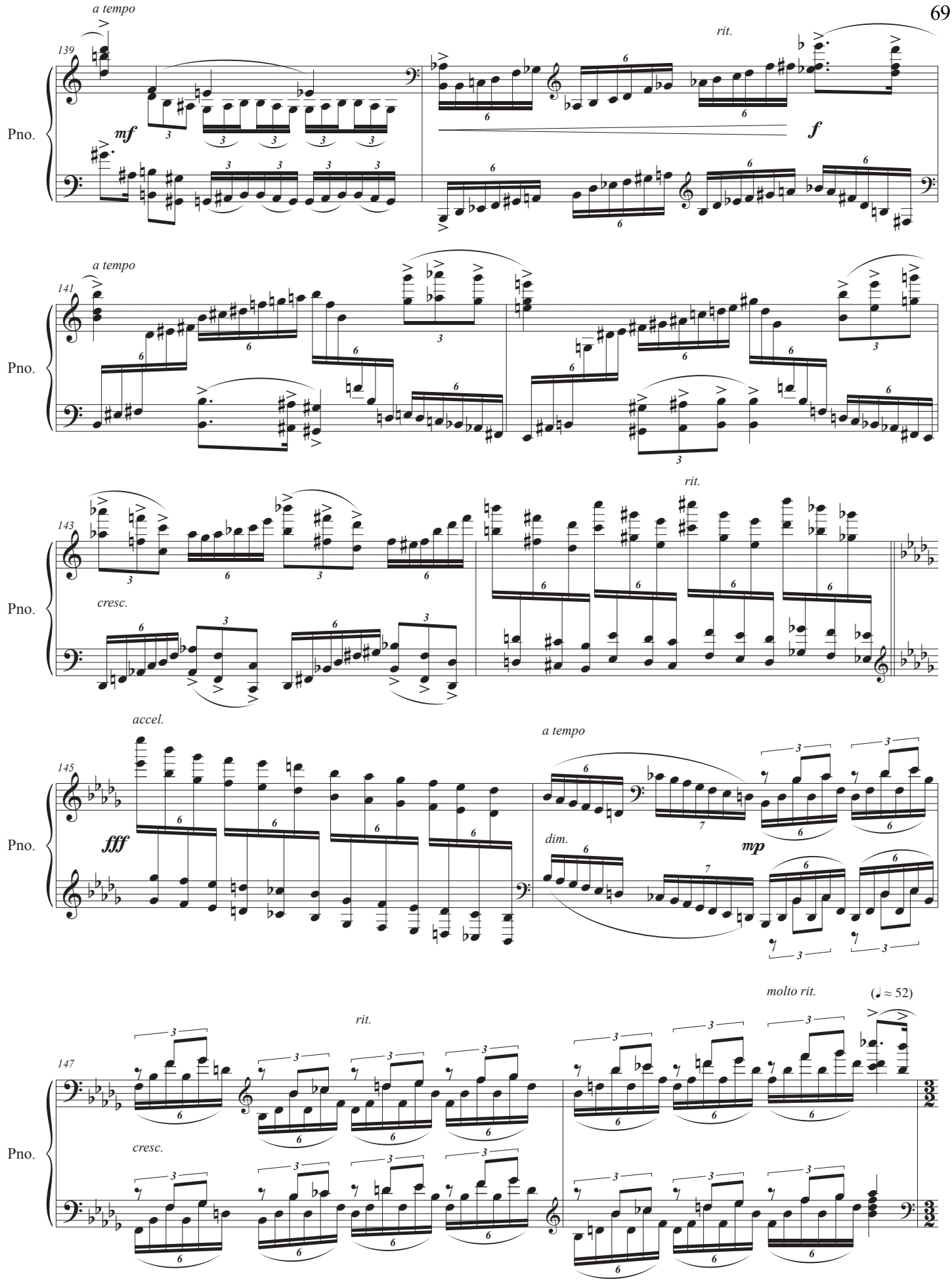
91
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.


94
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
f
I
poco a poco più tranquillo
mf
ff
97


101
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
101
Pno.
105
rit.
sospeso
mp
p
105


Cadenza (♩ = 125)
110
Pno.
mp
113
rit.
8va
cresc.
116
a tempo
scherzo.
mf
119
leggiero
f
mp
poco a poco cresc.
(8va)
122
3
3


Moderato ♩ = 85
(8va)
rit.
molto rit.
126
Pno.
mf
129
Pno.
accel.
rit.
Piu Mosso ♩ = 92
132
Pno.
f
mf
rit.
a tempo
rit.
135
Pno.
mp
mf
ff
a tempo
rit.
137
Pno.
mf
ff


a tempo
139
rit.
Pno.
mf
f
a tempo
141
Pno.
143
rit.
Pno.
cresc.
accel.
a tempo
145
Pno.
fff
dim.
mp
molto rit.
(♩ ≈ 52)
rit.
147
Pno.
cresc.

J

Allegretto, dolente ma contenuto ♩ = 52 (♩ = 104)

Vln. I

Vln. II

Vla.

Vc.
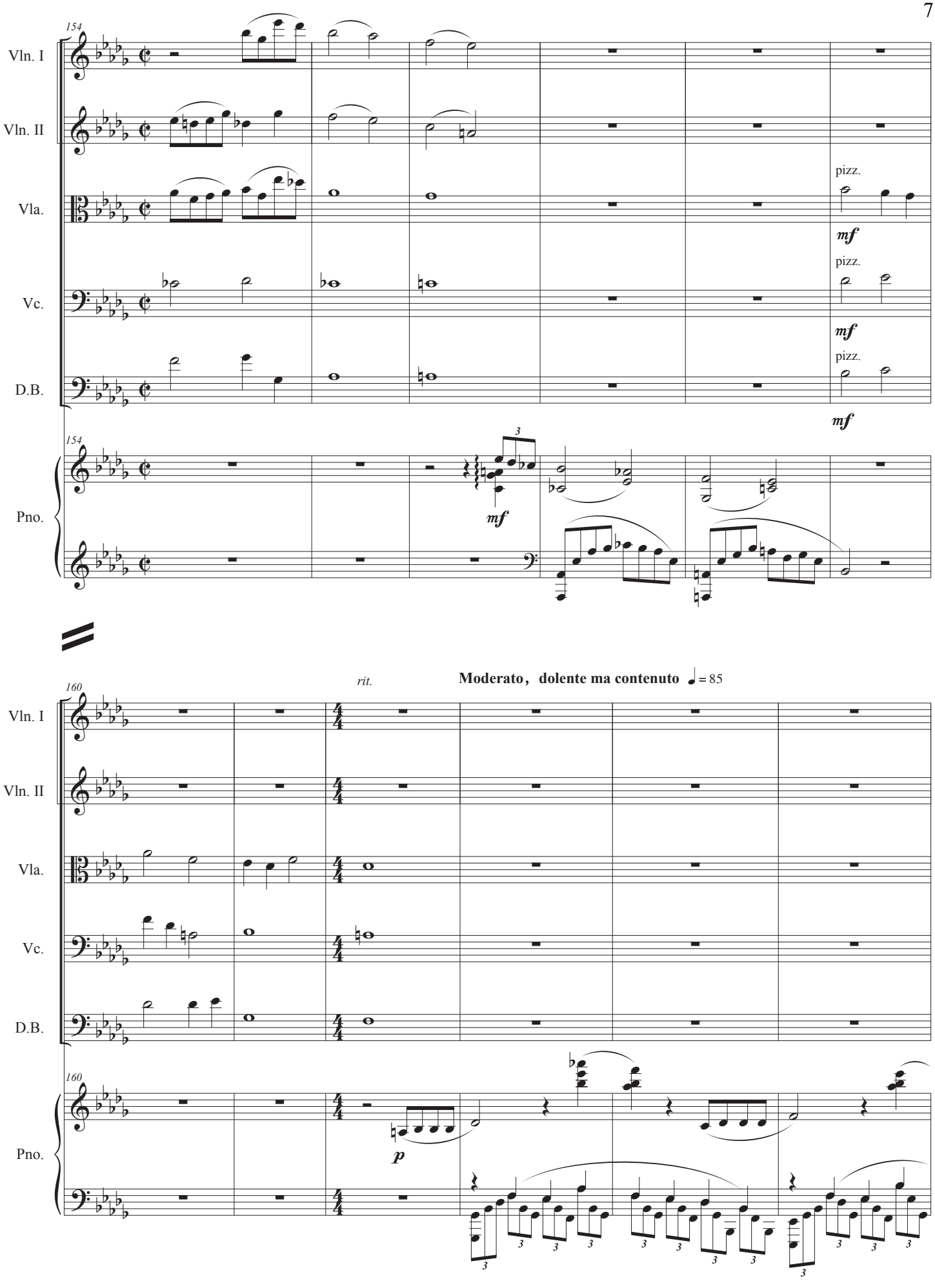
D.B.
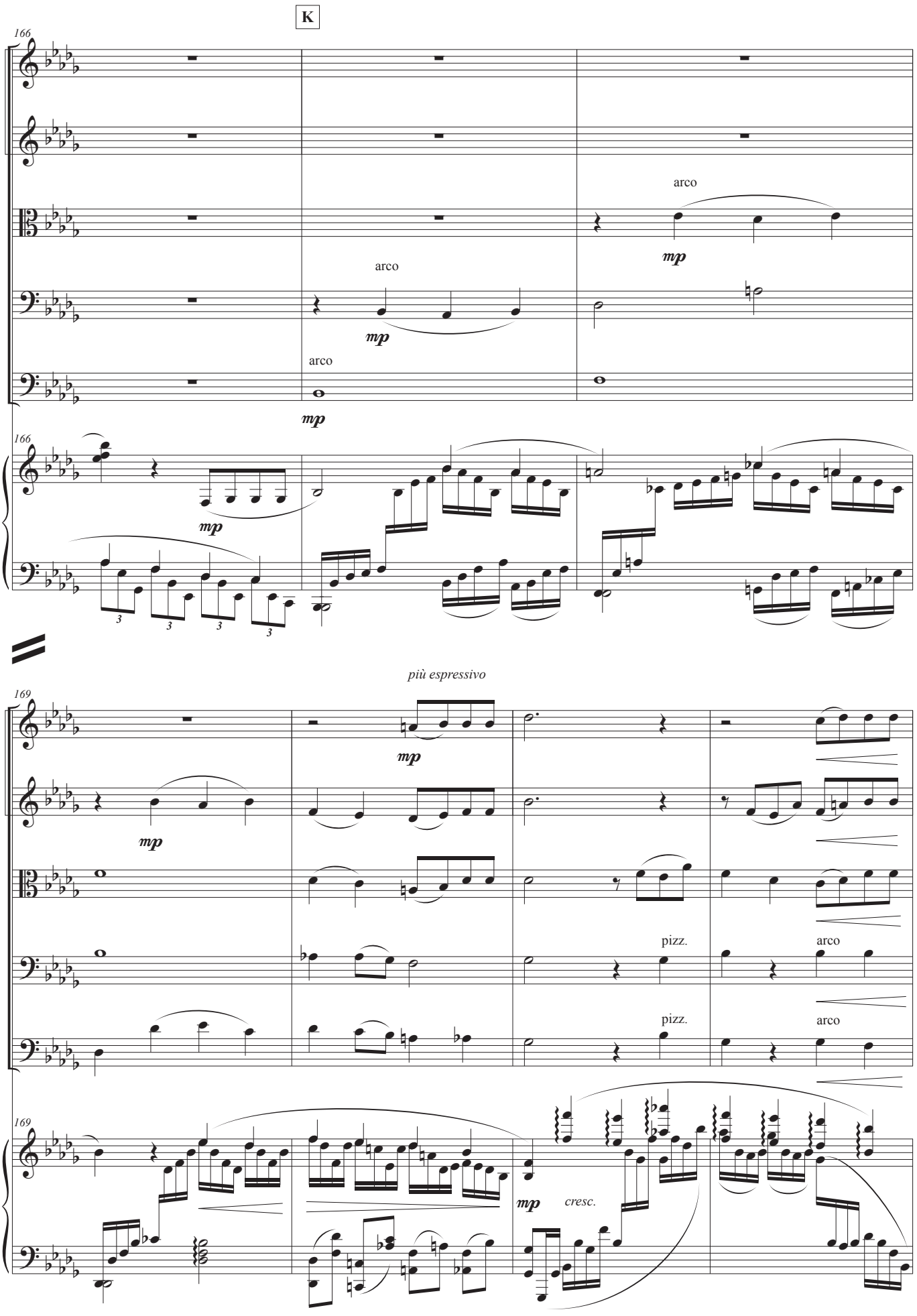
Pno.

149

151

151


154
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
pizz.
mf
3
rit.
Moderato, dolente ma contenuto ♩= 85
160
p


K
166
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
arco
mp
166
169
più espressivo
pizz.
arco
cresc.
169

L

173

Vln. I

Vln. II

Vla.

Vc.

D.B.

Pno.

mf

f

pizz.
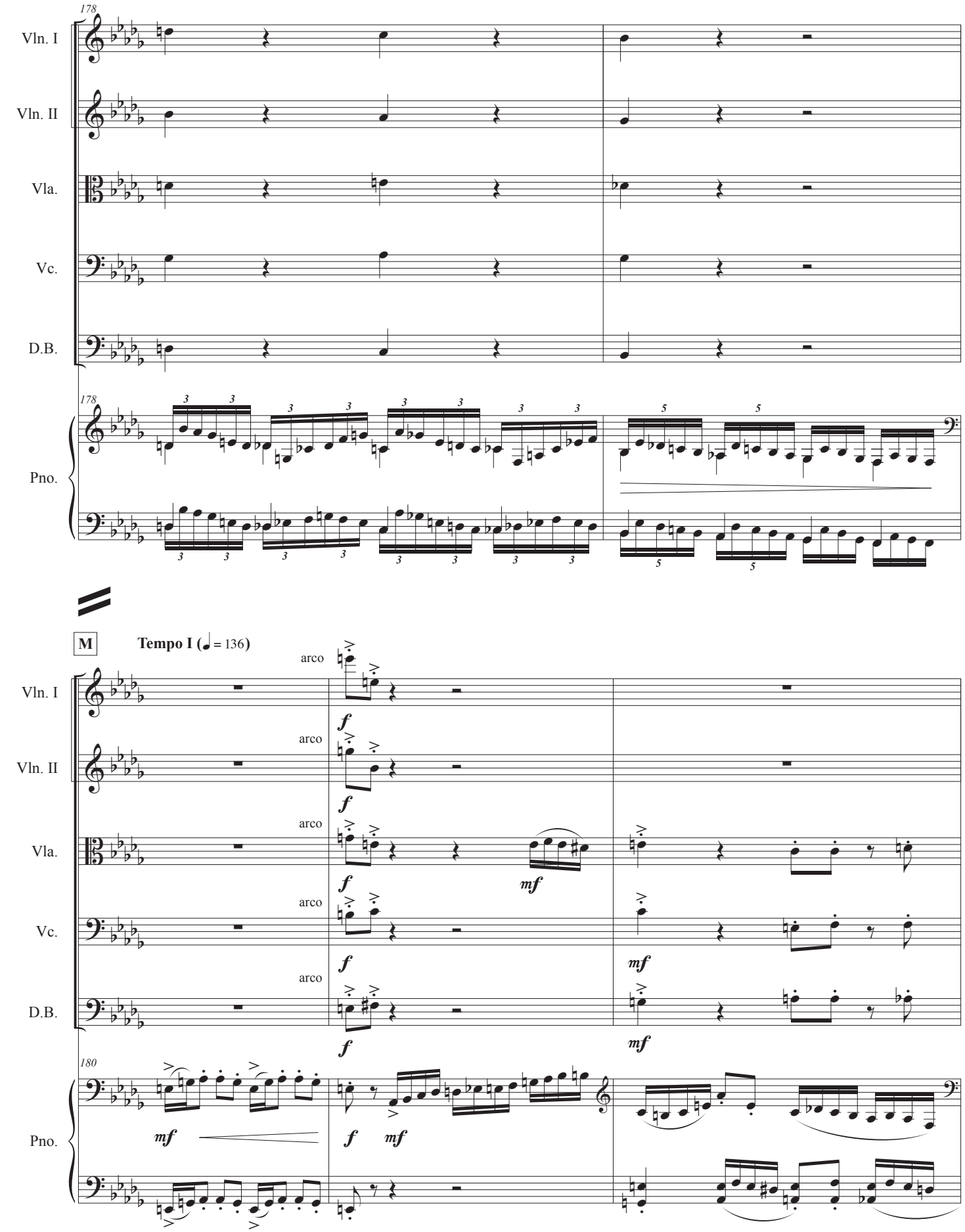
arco
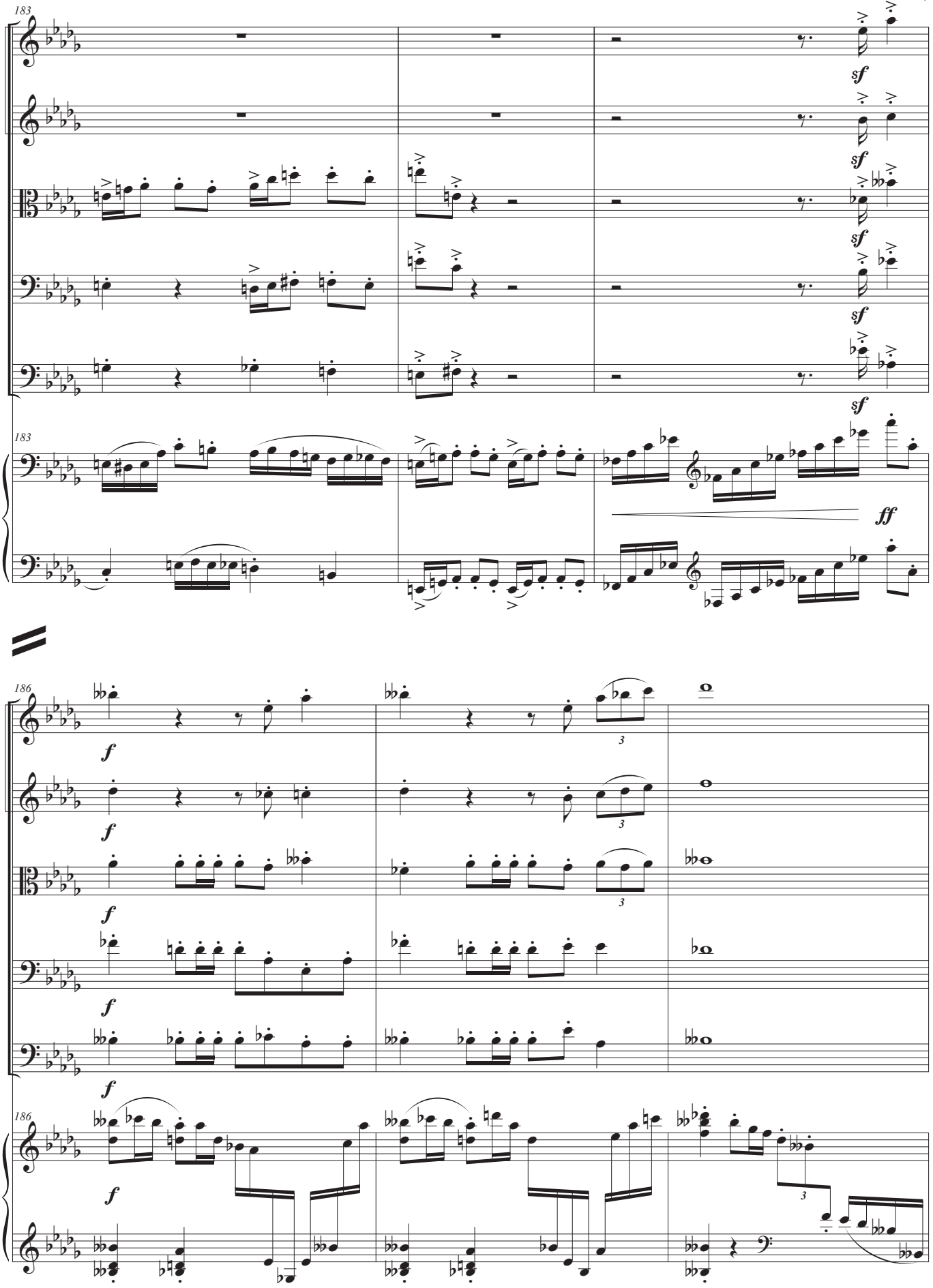
cresc.
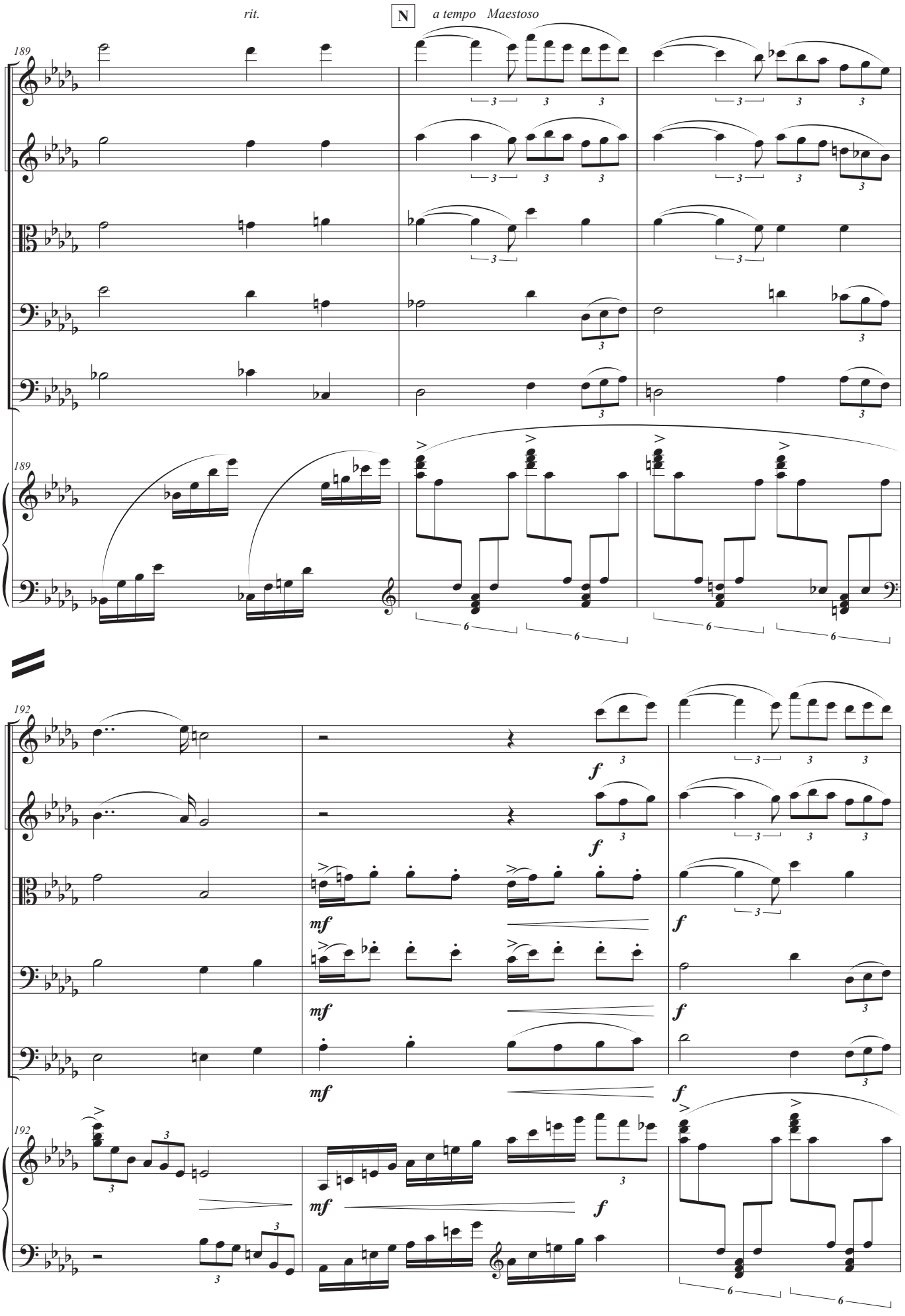
176
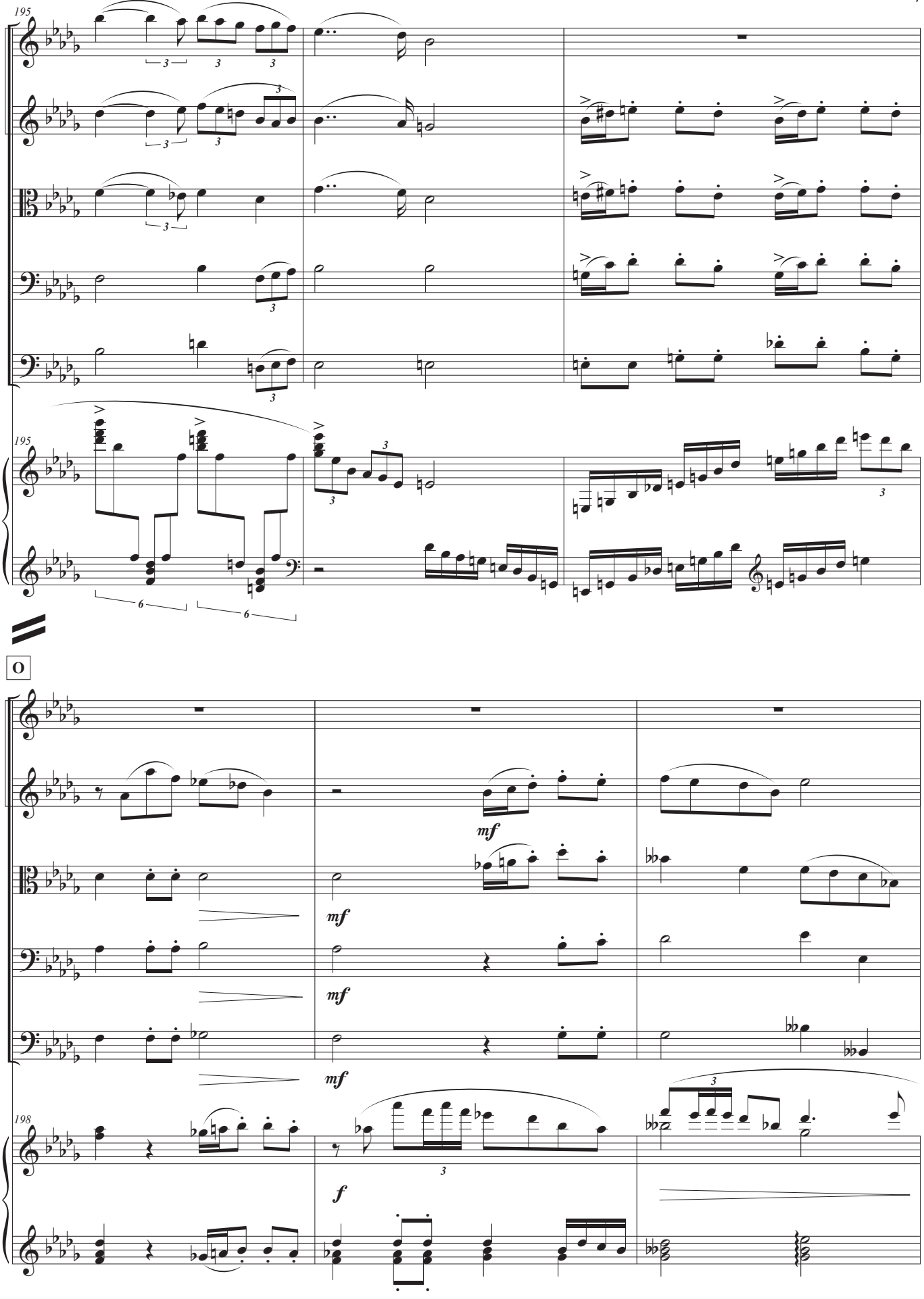
pizz.

3


accel.
178
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
M
Tempo I (♩ = 136)
arco
f
mf
180


183
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
sf
ff
186
f
3


rit.
N
a tempo Maestoso
189
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
192
f
mf


195
Vln. I
Vln. II
Vla.
Vc.
D.B.
Pno.
O
mf
198
f
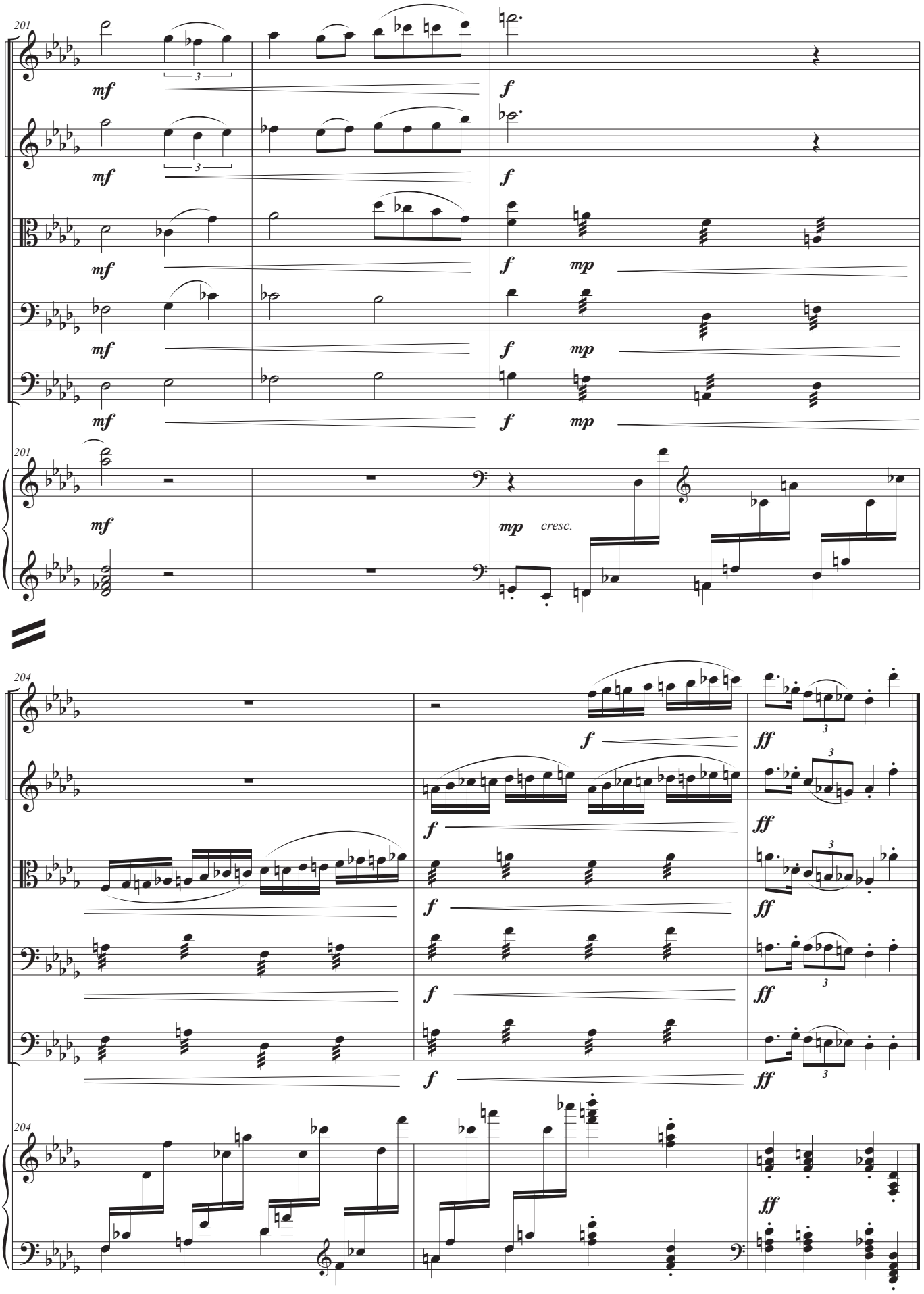
P *Stringendo, sempre più energico*

